MANAYUNK TOMORROW

MANAYUNK RESILIENCE PLAN

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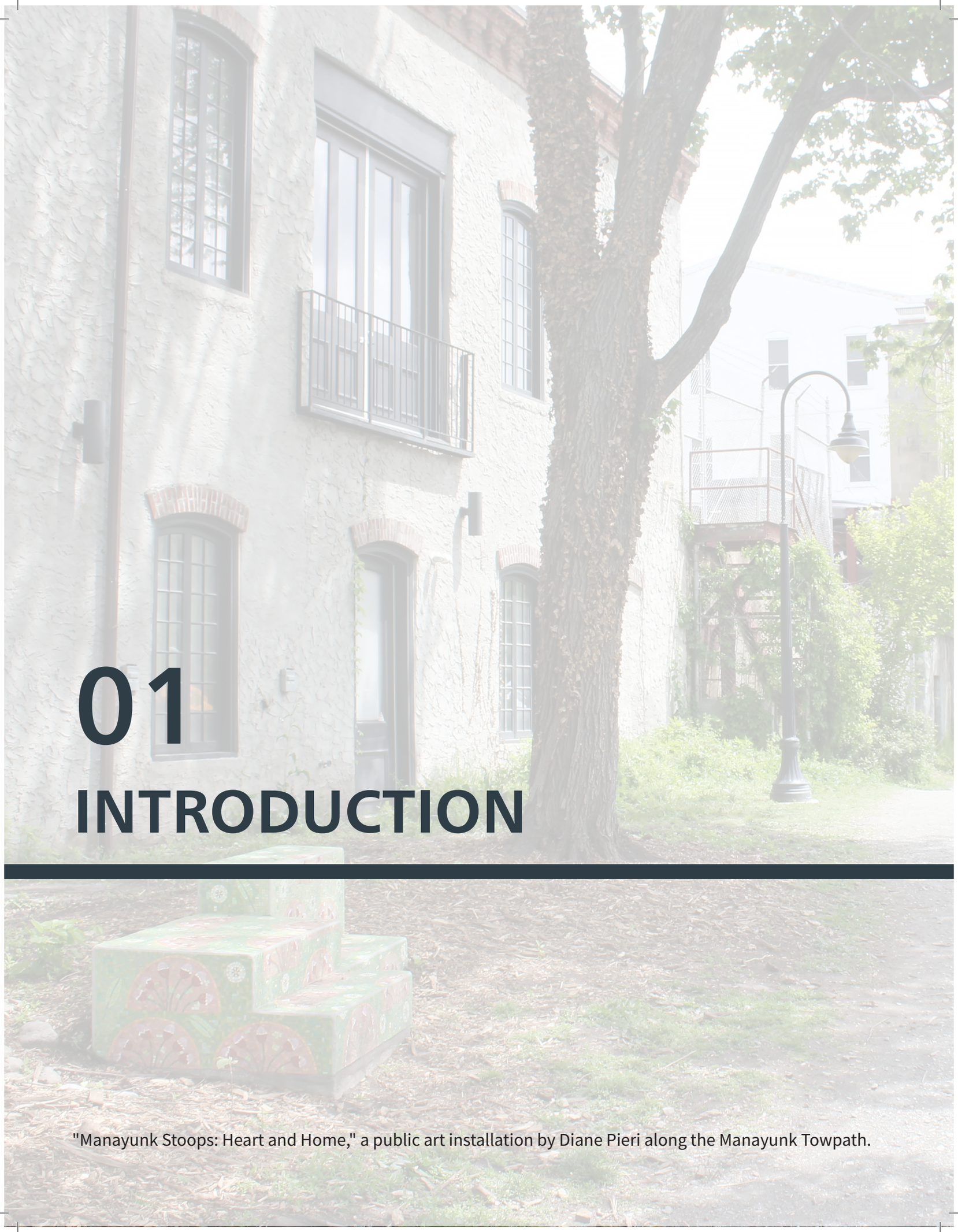
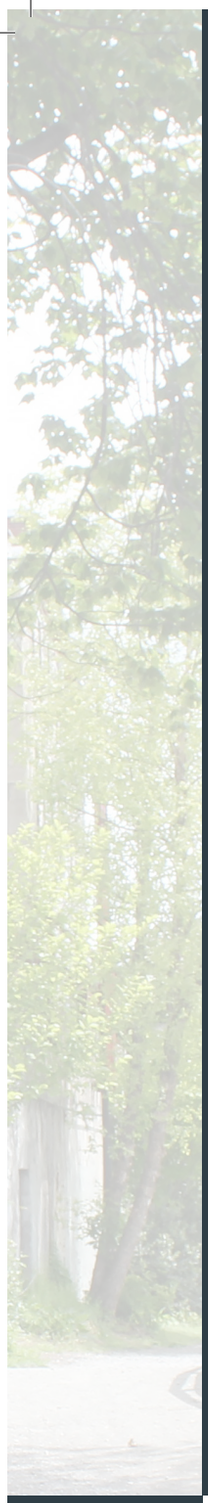
INTRODUCTION



"Manayunk Stoops: Heart and Home," a public art installation by Diane Pieri along the Manayunk Towpath.



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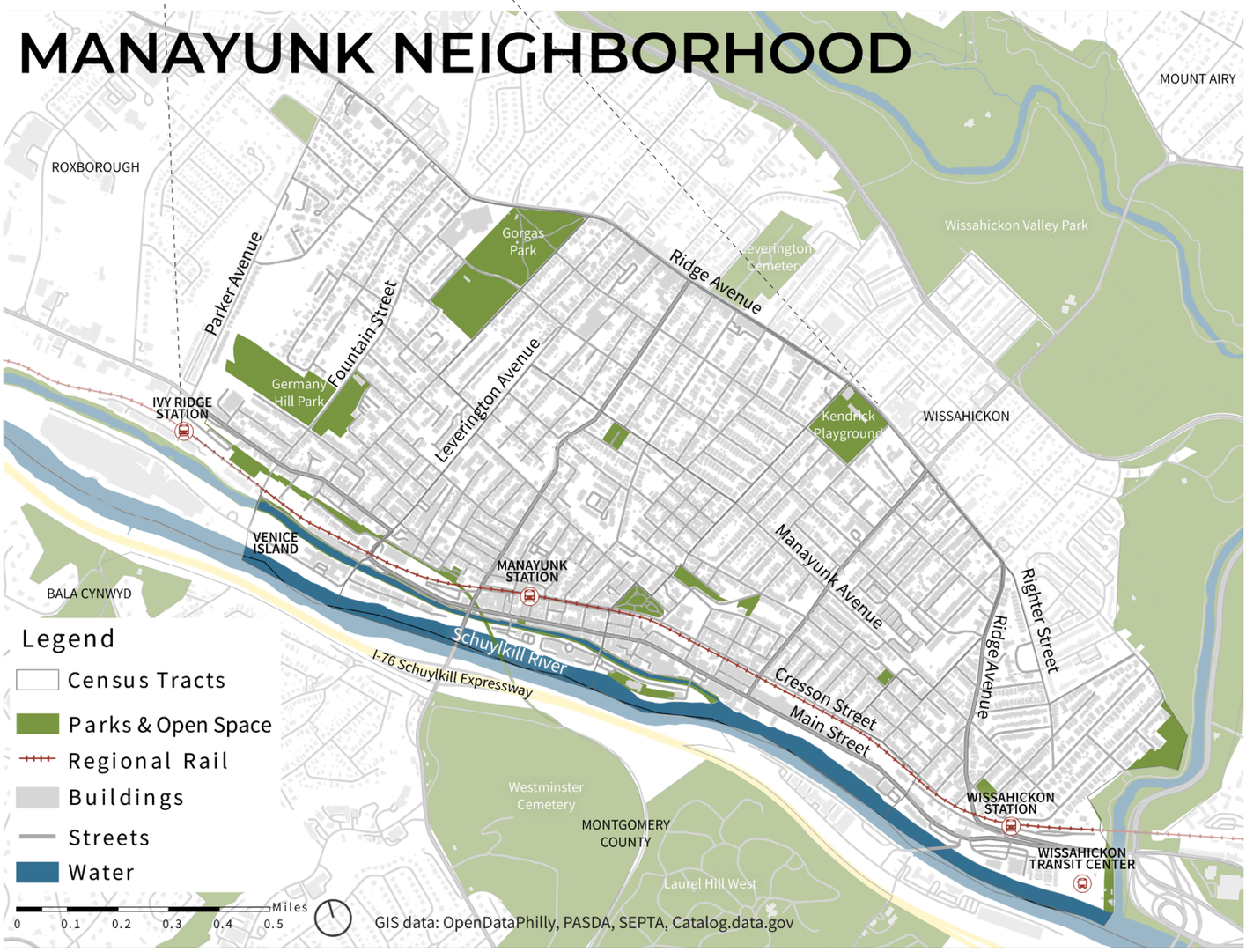
Introduction

About Manayunk

Manayunk is located on the banks of the Schuylkill River in northwest Philadelphia, bordering Montgomery County. Manayunk is accessible via SEPTA buses and the Regional Rail (Manayunk/ Norristown Line), with most vehicular traffic arriving on I-76, the Schuylkill Expressway, which passes just across the river from Manayunk.

Historically, Manayunk occupied a long stretch of the riverfront area. As industry declined, the neighborhood grew to include more uphill areas. Roxborough is the adjacent neighborhood to the north; due to the way these communities developed over time, there



are not clear boundaries between them. The two neighborhoods share many connections and several community organizations work with both areas. The study area for this plan includes the quintessential areas of Manayunk as contained within the Census tracts 209, 210, 213, 214, and 215, which have been used for data analysis and to delineate the boundaries of Manayunk.

Why Resilience?

Manayunk stands at a crossroads. After experiencing a recent rebound following decades of post-industrial decline, there is optimism for Manayunk to continue in an upward trajectory. However, as part of that forward momentum, Manayunk is vulnerable to risks that threaten neighborhood prosperity. Specifically, changing socioeconomic forces, disinvestment in infrastructure, and climate disasters are key challenges for Manayunk to overcome in the future.

Under a resiliency framework, this plan proposes solutions to address these concerns while leveraging Manayunk's existing strengths to create a climate-friendly, equitable, and connected neighborhood. The recommended solutions span a 20-year horizon, both proposing neighborhood-specific solutions and building upon established plans for the Philadelphia region. This plan creates a long-range vision for Manayunk, while also acknowledging the neighborhood's immediate needs.

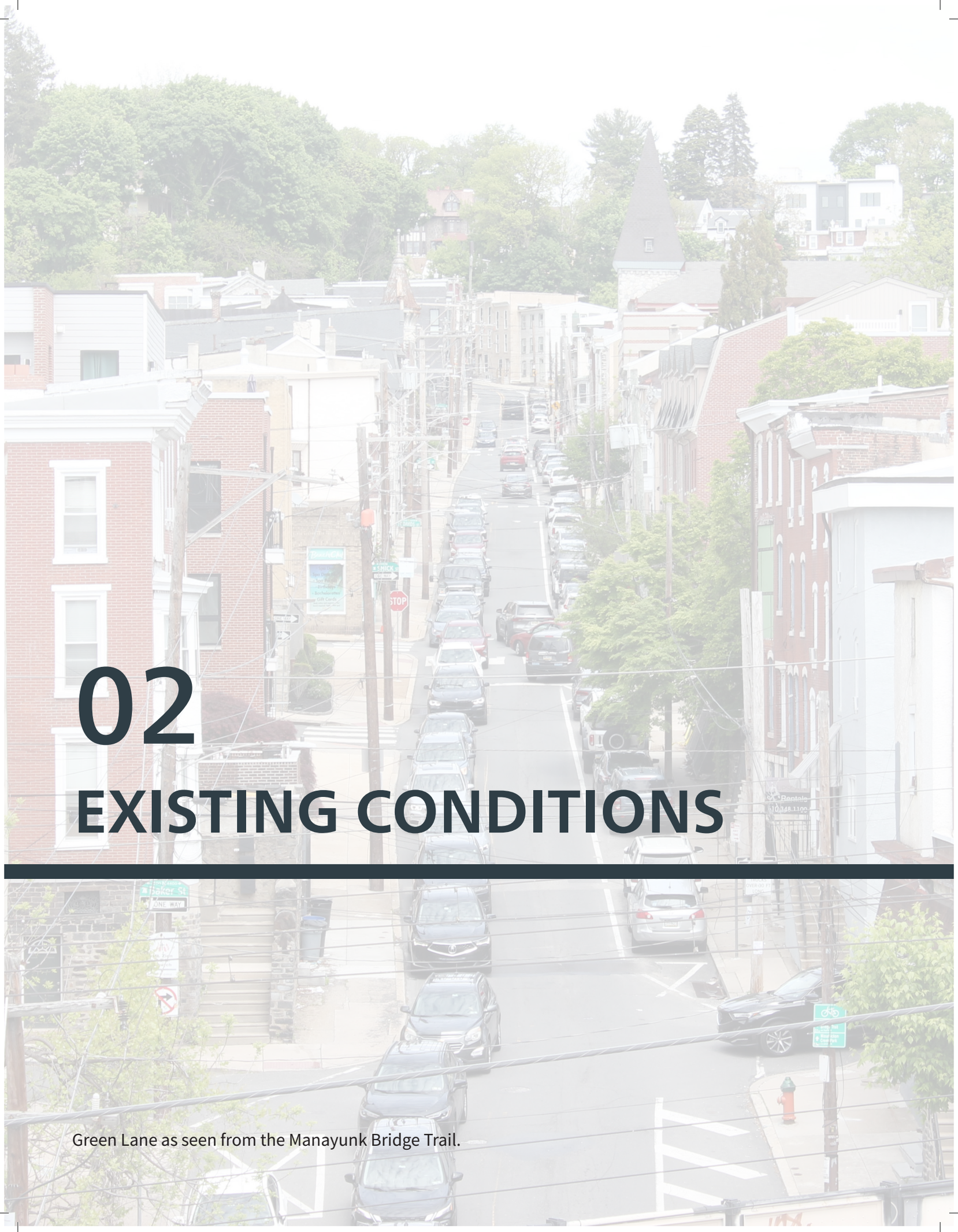
This plan has been organized into four resilience themes: community, economic, environmental, and infrastructure resilience. Through a holistic and interdisciplinary approach to resilience, this plan prepares Manayunk for social, economic, and climate changes.

The "Manayunk Tomorrow" plan begins with an overview of various socioeconomic, environmental, and policy trends that have shaped the neighborhood. Following that, this plan identifies the pressing neighborhood issues as well as Manayunk's strengths that provide opportunities to further improve neighborhood conditions. The next chapter outlines the vision and goals for Manayunk based on the four resilience themes. Each recommendation supports one or more goals, often across multiple themes. The last chapter includes details on implementation of the plan, including phasing for the major steps of each recommendation.

Disclaimer

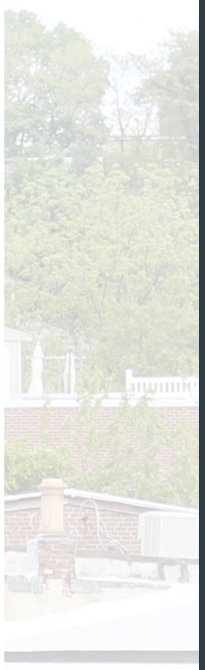
This plan was produced as a student learning exercise for the City Planning 6000: Studio I course at the University of Pennsylvania's Weitzman School of Design. This is not an official planning document and should not be used for any legal, financial, zoning, or policy decisions. This plan does not represent the views or policies of the University, Manayunk's community organizations, or the City of Philadelphia. The creation of this plan involved limited outreach to residents and other stakeholders in Manayunk; however, it is not a substitute for a comprehensive public engagement process. The authors and the University assume no responsibility for any use of the plan's content beyond its academic purpose.

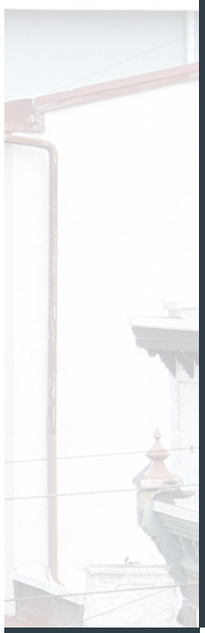
The data and analyses reflect the information available at the time, and some may be outdated for use in an official plan. All American Community Survey data used was from the 2023 5-year dataset, which was the data most recently available and is referred to in the present tense in the plan text. Any maps or graphics are illustrative only and not based on professional surveys. If a map, figure, or image has no source listed, it was created by one of the authors of this plan.

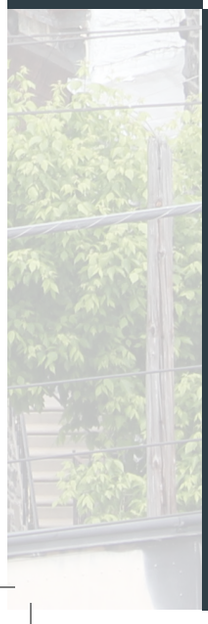


02
EXISTING CONDITIONS

Green Lane as seen from the Manayunk Bridge Trail.







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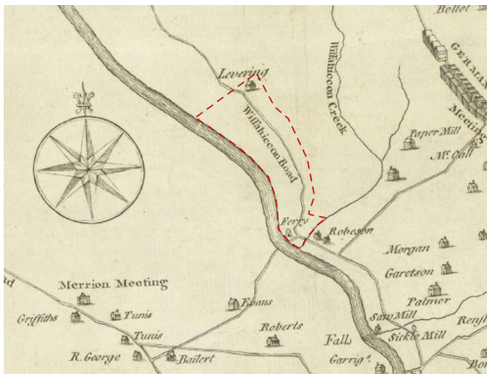
History of Manayunk

Indigenous era (Pre-1682)

Before 1682, the Manayunk area was part of the Lenape homeland along the Schuylkill River and Wissahickon Creek. Communities lived and traveled along these waterways for over 10,000 years before Europeans arrived. The later name “Manayunk” is drawn from the Lenape phrase “Manaiung” which translates to ‘a place to drink,’[3,4] and reflects this long-standing connection to the river landscape.

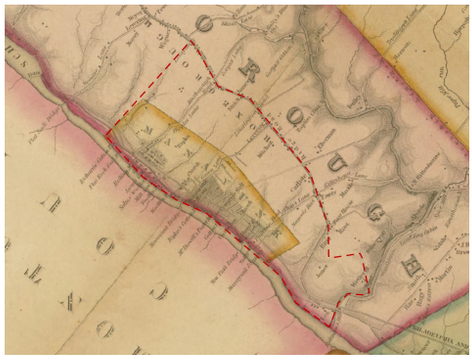


1750 Map[1]
Rural Schuylkill River valley, farms and crossings, the building "Levering" shows the land owner.

Origin and Early Settlement (1682 - 1818)

The growing town was known as Flat Rock in 1810. The settlement got its nineteenth-century identity from the construction of the dam, canal, and locks by the Schuylkill Navigation Company. The Manayunk section was constructed by late 1818, and from that point on, the fate of this small village changed dramatically. Around 1819, Manayunk emerged as a mill village within Roxborough Township along the Schuylkill River.

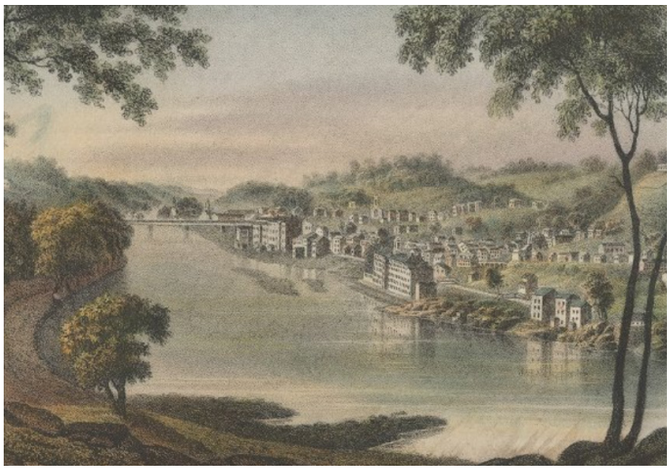
1843 Map[5]
Manayunk began to take shape; Buildings cluster densely along the Manayunk Canal.



Canal Development and Industrial Formation (1818 - 1840)

In the 1820s, Schuylkill Navigation Company leased out water power, rapidly transforming the small valley into a manufacturing village. In 1824, residents voted to replace “Flat Rock” with “Manayunk,” a name derived from a Lenape term associated with the river. By March 1827, an early local census recorded 1,098 residents, reflecting a shift from a small riverside node to a sizable community. Textile manufacturing expanded further in the 1830s.[6]

1682 — 1818 — 1840



1838: Manayunk near Philadelphia[2]

Incorporation and Expansion (1840 - 1870)

In 1840, Manayunk was incorporated as a borough. By the 1840s, supported by waterpower, the canal, and lock system, mills and factories continued to expand, and a more defined industrial corridor took shape along the Schuylkill River and canal. The artwork on the left depicts an emerging industrial concentration on Venice Island, while streets and low-rise residential areas extend inland up the hillside. An early spatial division between production along the water and living areas on the slope had begun to take shape.

1910 Map[12]

Around 1910, Manayunk's developed area had largely stabilized, and the primary street framework and the boundary of the neighborhood are clearly legible on the map.

Industrial Development and Prosperity (1870 - 1940)

After 1870, as commercial shipping on the canal receded, Manayunk's industrial system continued to mature under the combined support of rail connections and water power. Venice Island continued to host an intensive concentration of mills and factory buildings; meanwhile, Main Street gradually emerged as the area's commercial and retail center. Manayunk's prosperity as a manufacturing hub persisted into the 1930s.[7]

Deindustrialization and Economic Restructuring (1940 - 1980s)

Closure of mills during the Great Depression and the relocation of many wartime industries drove further industrial decline in Manayunk from the 1940s to the 1980s. Many mills and factories along the canal and Venice Island were abandoned.[11]

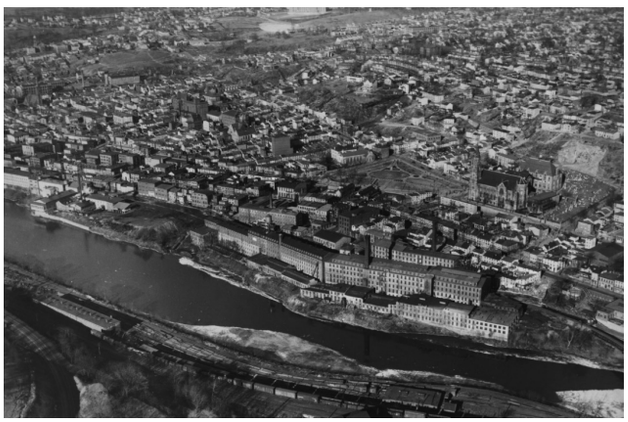
1947: View of a run-down street in Manayunk[10]

This 1947 street shows signs of under-maintenance , reflecting the decline of Manayunk's industrial community.

Revitalization and Preservation (1980s - now)

From the 1980s to the present, Manayunk shifted from a declining industrial corridor to a lifestyle-oriented district. Investment returned to Main Street, historic preservation helped stabilize the streetscape, and many former industrial buildings entered adaptive reuse. Public-space improvements and trail-oriented connectivity reinforced a new identity centered on retail, dining, and recreation.[9]

1870 — 1940 — 1980



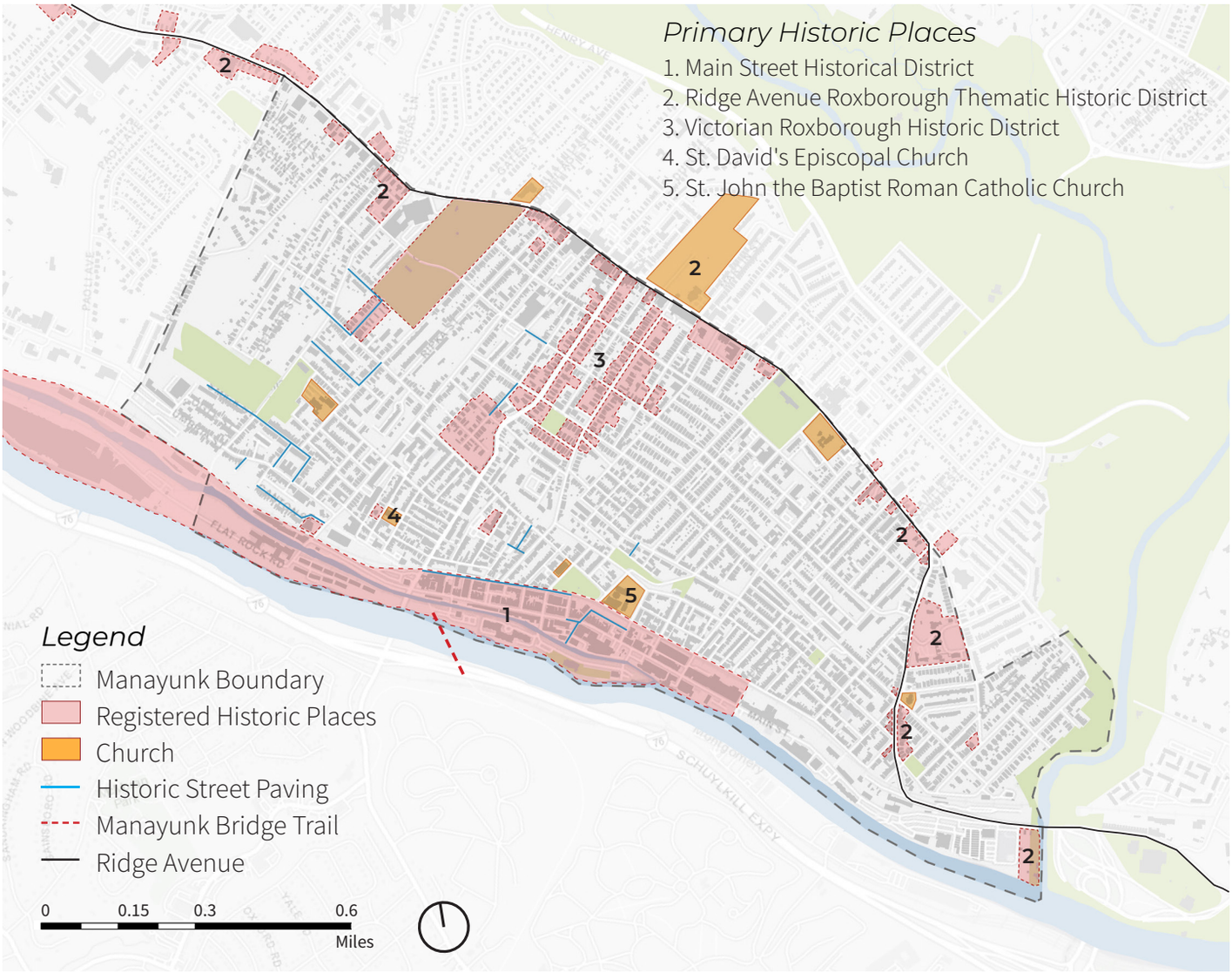
1926: Manayunk and Venice Island[8]

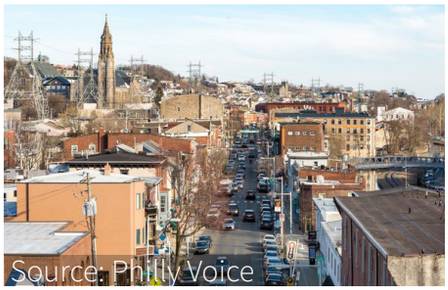
In 1926, industrial buildings on Venice Island formed a continuous belt along the river.

1995 Philadelphia Marathon on Main Street[13]

The marathon and retail storefronts along the street reflect the neighborhood's revitalization and transformation.

Historic Properties





Main Street Historic District[14]

Main Street is the neighborhood's commercial spine, where shops and restaurants sit alongside the Canal and former mill landscape.

St. John Church[15]

This prominent hilltop parish church was completed in 1894, and serves as a long-standing landmark and community anchor.

Manayunk Bridge Trail

This repurposed railroad bridge is now a multi-use path, offering panoramic river-valley views and linking the area's trail network.

Community Organizations

Main Street and the Manayunk Development Corporation logos

Manayunk Development Corporation

Manayunk Development Corporation (MDC) is a nonprofit that has managed and promoted the Manayunk Main Street commercial district since 1992. It supports local businesses and new openings, builds the district brand through marketing and signature events, and works closely with the Manayunk Special Services District (MSSD) to deliver business-district services such as sidewalk cleaning, maintenance, and public-space improvements funded through district assessments.[19]

Pretzel Park

Ridge Park Civic Association

Ridge Park Civic Association (RPCA) has been active in the Roxborough and Manayunk area since 1995. As a registered RCO, it receives official notices during zoning and development reviews, convenes public community meetings, and compiles resident feedback. It also leads volunteer-driven efforts such as tree planting, neighborhood cleanups, historic preservation, and support for zoning compliance and enforcement.[16]

Manayunk Neighborhood Council

Manayunk Neighborhood Council (MNC) is a nonprofit civic association in Manayunk, formed in the 1950s and incorporated in 1970. As a RCO recognized by the Philadelphia City Planning Commission, it receives official notices during zoning and development reviews, convenes public community meetings, and compiles resident feedback to bring local priorities (such as responsible development and quality of life) into the review process. It also continues to advocate on broader neighborhood issues, including quality-of-life and public space improvements.[18]

Source: North Light Community Center

North Light Community Center[17]

North Light Community Center

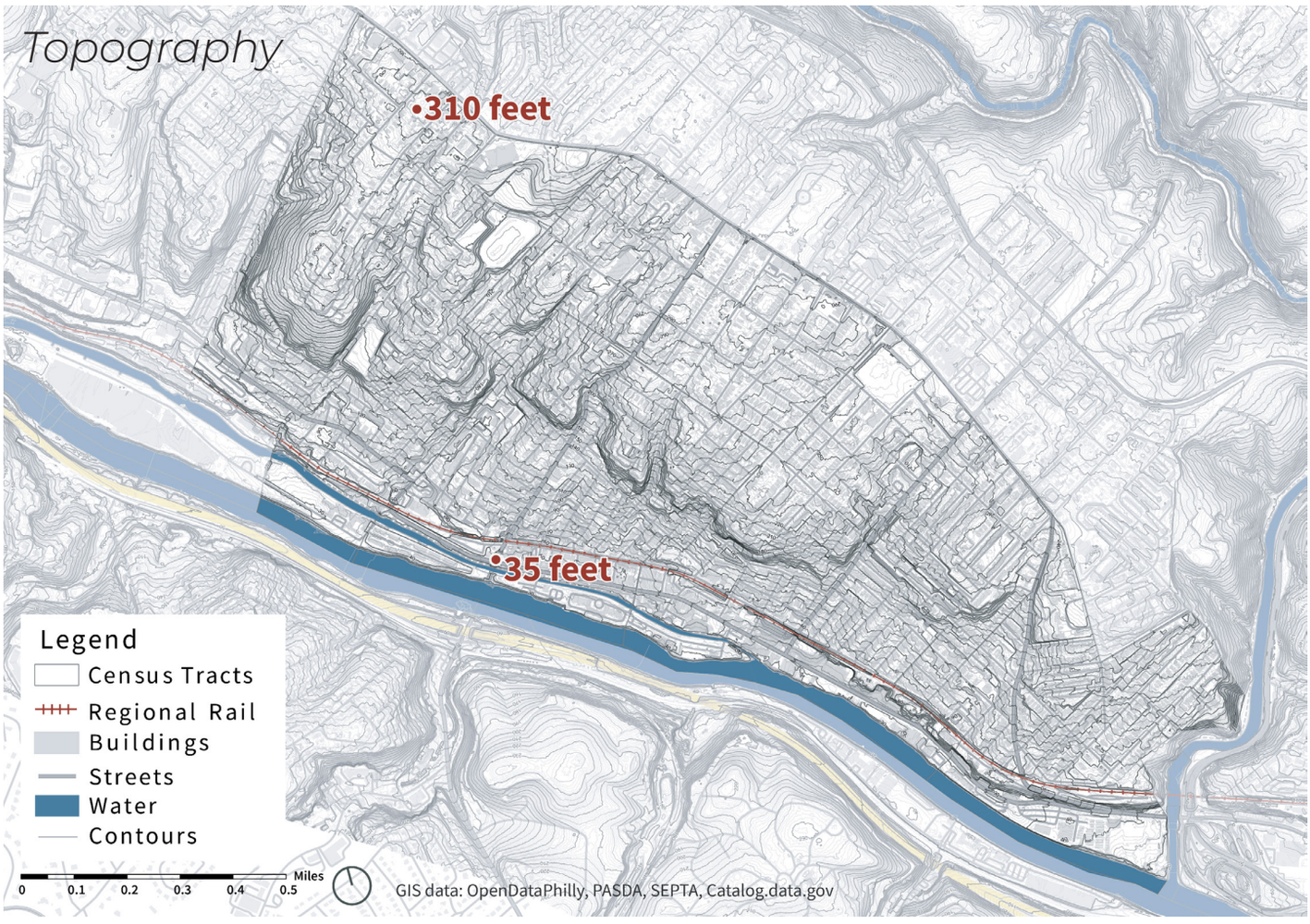
In 1936, the North Light Community Center, originally the North Light Boys' Club, began as a drop-in center for local youth, aiming to reduce juvenile delinquency and social marginalization. Today, the center's core work focuses on children and family services such as after-school care and transportation, youth development through college and career readiness, mentoring, and application support, and emergency assistance programs.[20]

Environment

Steep Terrain

Manayunk is characterized by steep topography, moving from the Schuylkill River up to the Wissahickon Valley Park. There is a nearly 300-foot elevation gain from Main Street to the northern area of Manayunk.[21] The dramatic topography creates steep climbs on many residential streets and often requires stairs to connect areas of different elevations. This ridge runs north-to-south through the neighborhood and also separates much of the neighborhood from easily accessing transit and commercial activities closer to Main Street.

Steep stairs connecting the Wissahickon Regional Rail Station to Main Street

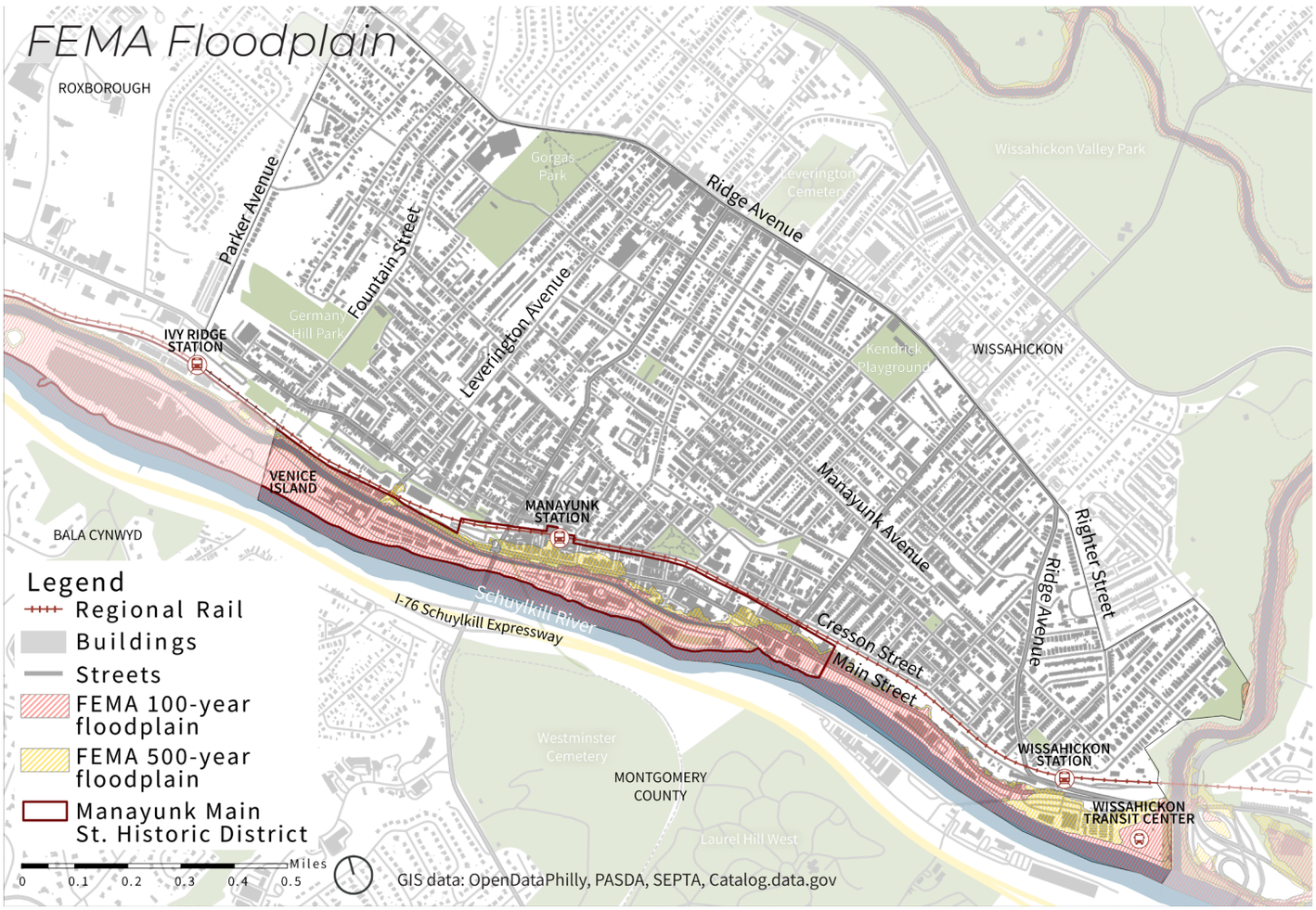


Flood Risk & History

Manayunk has experienced many devastating floods due to the neighborhood's proximity to the Schuylkill River. In 2021, Hurricane Ida caused the highest recorded flood levels since 1869 (16 feet in 2021, just one foot below 1869 levels).[22] Nearly all of Venice Island and Main Street are located in the floodplain.

Although there are additional building and zoning standards from the City of Philadelphia for new development in the flooplain, several projects have still been approved in the last 20 years. Overall, there are over 200 structures in Manayunk in the 100-year floodplain.[23] The greatest flood risks are in areas of repetitive loss, such as Main Street, and major transportation corridors along the River, which can impact flood evacuation.[24] The 2024 East Falls and Manayunk Flood Mitigation Study outlines potential flooding scenarios in 2050 and 2090 with strategies to address flood risk in the area.[25]

2021 flooding on Main Street and Venice Island

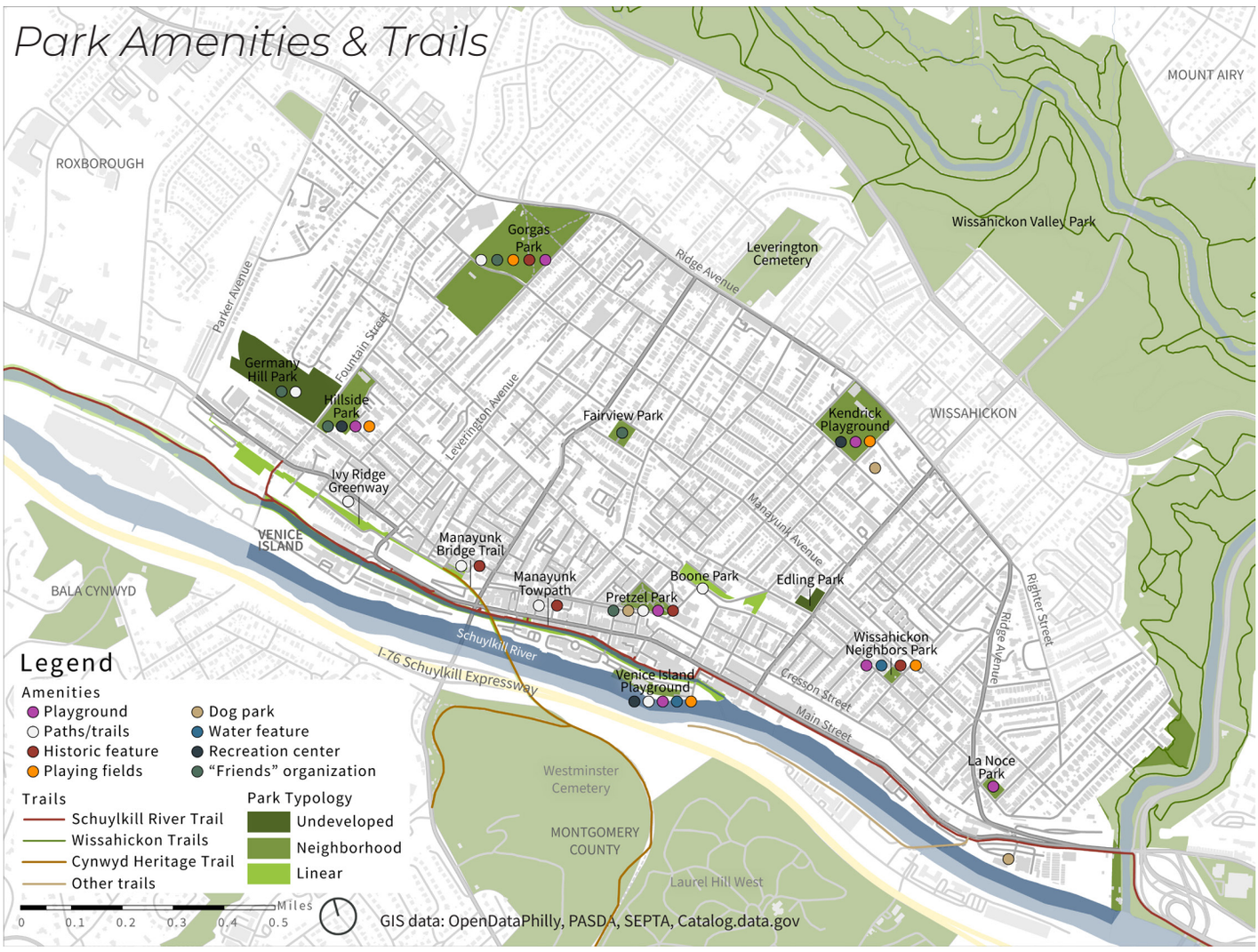


Parks, Trails, & Open Space

Manayunk has many neighborhood and pocket parks, with several larger parks including Gorgas Park, Pretzel Park, and Kendrick Playground. The neighborhood is also within walking distance of the Wissahickon Valley Park and trails. Some of the smaller neighborhood parks lack amenities or are in disrepair, while other parks are maintained by local "Friends of" parks organizations. The Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy is another important local partner for parks care and nature conservation in the Manayunk area.

Manayunk also has a strong network of local trails, many of which connect to regional destinations. The Manayunk Towpath follows the Manayunk Canal and honors the neighborhood's industrial history. It joins into the Schuylkill River Trail and connects to other trails in Philadelphia. The Manayunk Bridge Trail is elevated above the neighborhood and connects to trails in Montgomery County.[26,27] Manayunk is also part of the Schuylkill River Greenways National Heritage Area, a collaboration between the National Park Service, local jurisdictions, non-profits, and partner organizations.

Beyond the trail system, the Philadelphia Water Department recently completed the Flat Rock Dam project to restore freshwater flow to the Canal. This has improved water quality, decreased algal blooms, and restored habitat for native species.[28]



Demographics & Socioeconomics

Manayunk is becoming a young, professional, and education-focused neighborhood. Manayunk is home to a large share of residents aged 25 to 34, high levels of educational attainment, and strong employment in professional, education, and health-related fields.

Data Sources: 5-Year American Community Survey (2023), DP01 Profile of General Population and Housing Characteristics, DP03 Selected Economic Characteristics

Population and Race

Manayunk is home to approximately 18,486 residents as of 2023.[29] While the number of residents declined by 198 since 2013, the neighborhood is one of the largest in Philadelphia by population and has grown significantly since 1970.

Historically home to European immigrants, Manayunk has remained primarily White. About 80% of residents identified as White in 2023, a decrease from 89% in 2013.[30] Compared to Philadelphia, Manayunk has a low share of non-White residents, with five times less the number of Black or African American residents compared to Philadelphia.

Household Structure

Households in Manayunk are most often made up of married couples (30%).[31,32] However, this share has dropped by about 10% since 2013. Over a 10-year period, the number of people living alone has increased by 1,974 households, a 20% increase since 2013.

Compared to the rest of Philadelphia, Manayunk has a larger share of residents between the ages of 25 and 34. The smallest age groups in Manayunk are children under 18 (9%) and adults aged 65 or older (10%). These shares are lower than in Philadelphia overall, where 12% of residents are under 18 and 14% are 65 or older.

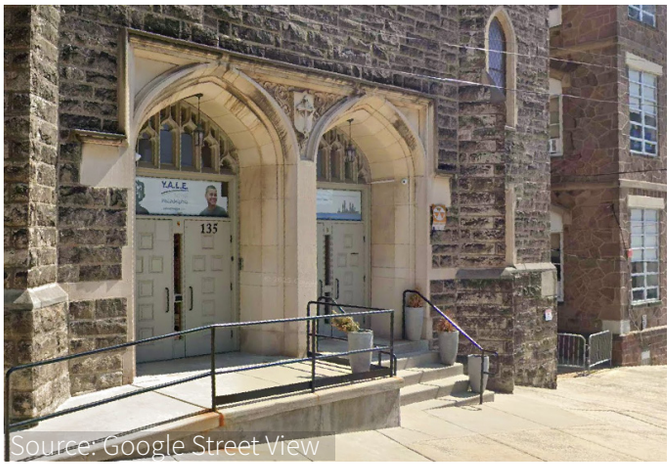
Education

Manayunk differs significantly from Philadelphia in educational attainment and school enrollment patterns. In 2013, 65% of Manayunk residents were enrolled in college or graduate school, compared to 33% citywide. By 2023, the share of resident enrolled in college or graduation declined to 59% in Manayunk, while Philadelphia remained at 33%. The absolute number of Manayunk residents enrolled in college or graduate school decreased from 2,390 in 2013 to 1,483 in 2023.

Consistent with the relatively small share of residents ages 5 to 19, enrollment in kindergarten through high school is low in Manayunk. In 2013, 17% of residents enrolled in school were in elementary school, rising slightly to 21% in 2023 compared to 38% in Philadelphia. Less than 1% of residents have not completed 9th grade, down from 2% in 2013. This is far lower than in Philadelphia overall, where 5% of residents have less than a 9th-grade education.[33]

Manayunk offers highly specialized schools for specific needs like the C.B. Community School and the Y.A.L.E. School, which provides special education.[34,35]

Manayunk functions largely as a neighborhood for college students, recent graduates, and young professionals. Among residents age 25 and older, the share holding a bachelor's degree increased from 30% in 2013 to 39% in 2023, and a substantial share also held graduate or professional degrees.[36,37]



Y.A.L.E. School Philadelphia

Household Income

Manayunk households earn higher incomes than households in Philadelphia overall. Manayunk has a predominantly affluent residential base with a mean household income of $124,439 (2023), compared to the Philadelphia average income of $86,504. This represents a significant increase in the mean household income in 2018, prior to COVID, in which the average household income in Manayunk was $105,558 (in 2023 inflation-adjusted dollars).[38,39] The largest share of Manayunk households fall in the $100,000 to $150,000 income range (17%), while in Philadelphia the largest share of households fall in the $50,000 to $74,999 range (15%).

Occupations

A substantial portion of Manayunk residents work in white-collar professions with 65% of residents working in management, business, and financial occupations.[40] Over 1,000 residents work in computer and mathematical occupations (1,435 workers and in healthcare practitioners and technical occupations (1,435 workers).[41] Office and administrative support, educational instruction, and sales-related occupations are other common employment sectors.

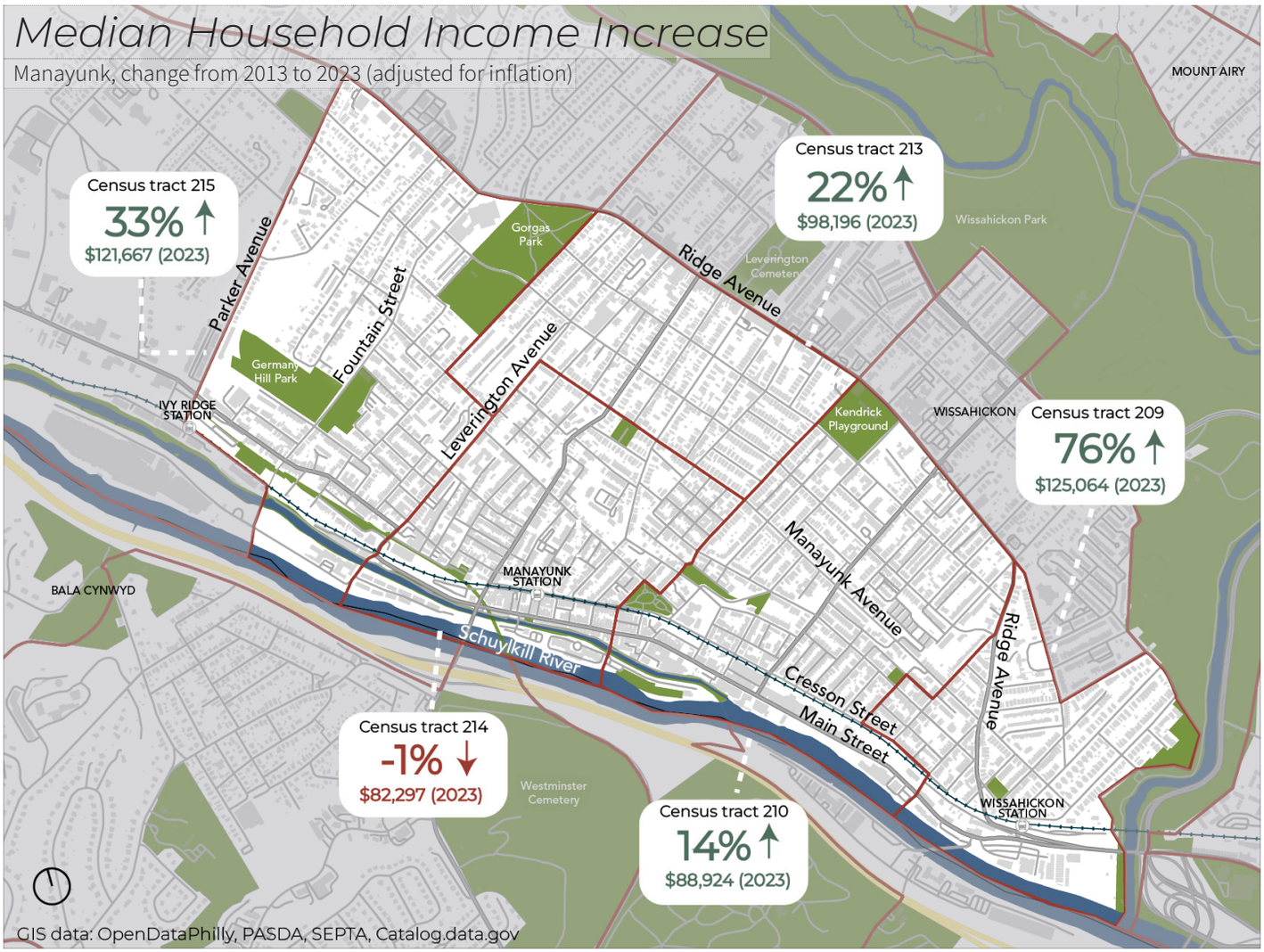
Despite food and accommodations serving as a prominent industry in Manayunk (see "Economic Conditions" on page 20), only approximately 1% of residents work in food preparation and serving occupations, suggesting that food service employees reside outside of Manayunk.

Commuting Flow

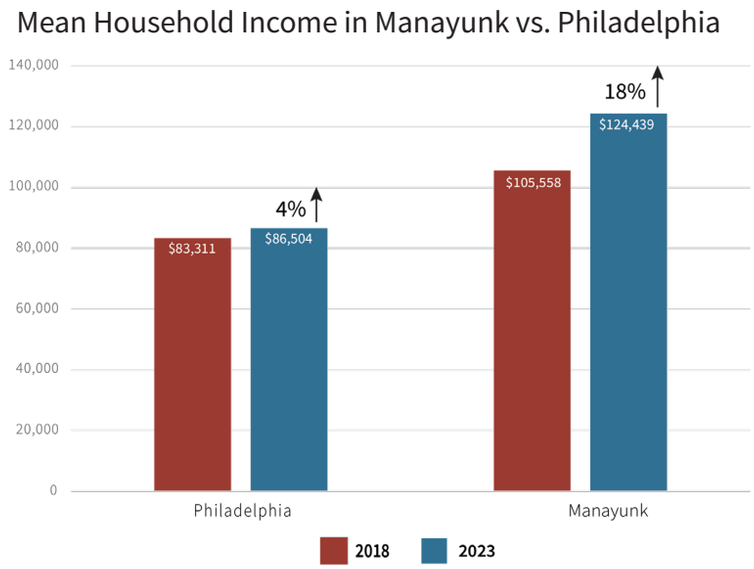
Most Manayunk residents commute outside of the neighborhood for work. In 2023, 96% of employed residents work outside of the Manayunk neighborhood, while only 4% work locally.[42] This positions Manayunk as a bedroom community with connections to employment centers elsewhere in Philadelphia. In 2023, 90% of Manayunk residents (8,901 workers) commute to work within the Philadelphia-Camden-Wilmington area.[43]

Of Manayunk residents that work within the Philadelphia-Camden-Wilmington metropolitan region, most residents work in the Center City and University City areas.[44] Outside of the Philadelphia metropolitan area, the second-most common metropolitan area for residents to work in is New York City. In 2023, 3% of Manayunk residents (275 workers) commute to the New York-Newark-Jersey City metropolitan area for work.[45]

Traffic congestion on Main Street



Data Source: 5-Year ACS (2018 & 2023) Table B19013: Median Household Income in the Past 12 Months

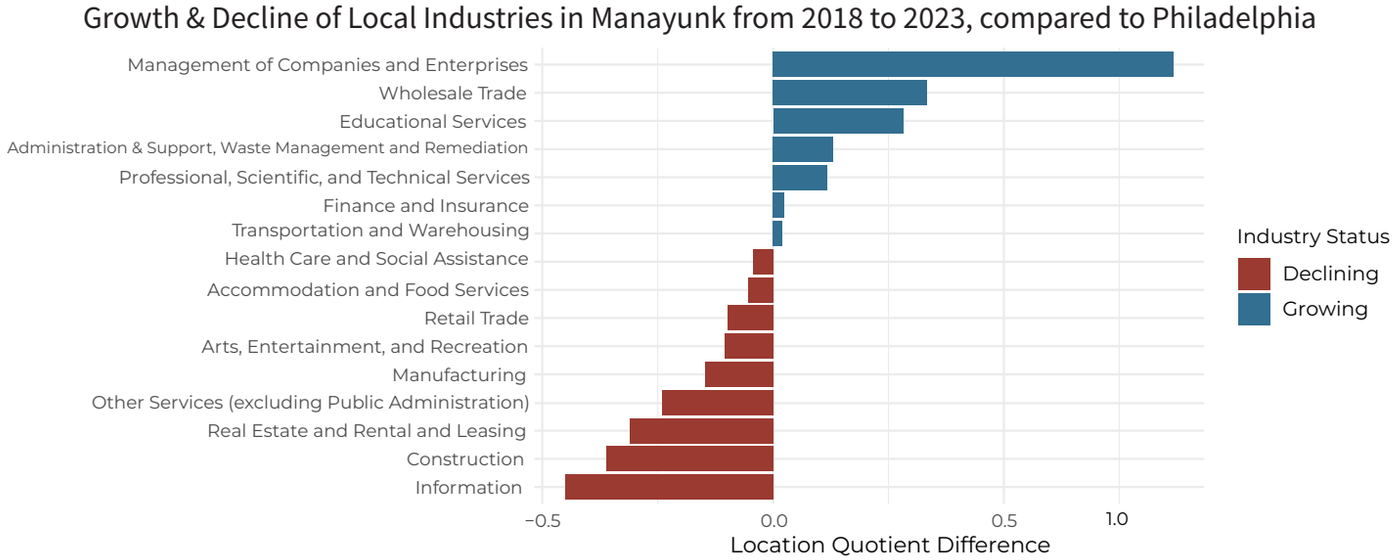


Data Sources: 5-Year American Community Survey (2018 & 2023), Table B19025: Mean Household Income in the Past 12 Months

Between 2013 and 2023, Manayunk has experienced an increase in its median household income. However, this increase is not evenly distributed across Manayunk.

For example, Census tract 209 experienced a 76% increase in median household income, whereas Census tract 214, along the Schuylkill River, experienced a minimal change in median income.

Economic Conditions



Data source: U.S. Census Bureau OnTheMap, Bureau of Labor Statistics Quarterly Census of Employment and Wages (QCEW)

Industry Presence

Manayunk is home to a mix of industries, with its main exports driven by its accommodation and food services and construction industries. In 2023, Manayunk's main basic industries, or industries that exceed the citywide average for industry providers, included accommodation and services, other services (excluding public administration), wholesale trade, and real estate. Manayunk is a popular commercial hub known for its dining scene, which is further supported by local economic development initiatives that attract visitors.

This mix of industries highlights Manayunk's predominantly food service-oriented commercial activity and its increasing presence of industries like healthcare, education, and retail that are prominent in other parts of Philadelphia.

Main Street Corridor

Manayunk has established community and economic development organizations to support the vitality of its commercial corridors. The Manayunk Development Corporation (MDC) has been integral to this vitality with one of their primary goals of business development and community engagement in the neighborhood.[46] The MDC is responsible for the management, promotion, and development of Manayunk's business district, while also collaborating with civic and community organizations to implement programming and physical improvement projects.

For example, the MDC has established an Incubator Space at 109 Grape Street, providing a low-risk, supportive environment for entrepreneurs developing early-stage business plans. The Incubator Space was created with the intention of helping businesses test ideas and build momentum to integrate into Manayunk's broader commercial landscape.

Main Street

In 2022, there were a total of 255 jobs created by businesses between 0 to 1-years old, demonstrating a strong presence of early stage businesses in industry growth. In 2018, there were a total of 277 jobs created by businesses between 0 to 1-years old, indicating Manayunk's strong recovery post-COVID. However, in 2022, job growth in new businesses was concentrated in northern Manayunk along Green Lane, whereas this growth was concentrated towards lower Manayunk along Main Street in 2018. This suggests trends of recent economic growth may be concentrated in the northern region.

Alongside the MDC, the Manayunk Special Services District (MSSD), created in 1996, focuses on capital improvements and district maintenance. The MSSD works in partnership with the MDC to sustain marketing and promotional outreach that enhances Manayunk's image. In 2012, the MSSD was renewed for an additional 10-year period, indicating continued long-term interest in economic development.

In tandem, the MDC and MSSD support many events, including Founders Philly Freeze-Out, the StrEAT Food Festival, and the Manayunk Arts Festival, which contributes to the overall local economy and citywide visibility.

Ridge Avenue Corridor

The Ridge Avenue corridor is a mixed-use commercial corridor that runs through Manayunk and into Roxborough. Compared to Manayunk Main Street, Ridge Avenue is less centered around dining and nightlife. Ridge Avenue is a more auto-oriented commercial area due to parking access and shopping center and grocery store presence.

Since 1992, the Roxborough Development Corporation (RDC) has taken the lead on revitalization efforts, using the Main Street Four Point Approach, a framework for commercial development focusing on organization, promotion, design, and economic vitality. Funding for this initiative was provided through the Ridge Avenue Business Improvement District and Community Development Corporation Tax Credit Program to promote events, beautification, business, recruitment, and marketing. The Ridge Avenue Neighborhoods Overlay zoning district, adopted in 2024, limits building height and bulk, extends parking requirements for residential uses, and offers density bonuses for mixed-income housing.[47]

Ridge Avenue

Future Plans

The Philadelphia 2035 Plan for Lower Northwest Philadelphia outlines strategies to strengthen Manayunk's commercial corridors.[48] The main initiatives for commercial development involve rezoning efforts, including:

- Along Ridge Avenue and into parts of Roxborough, rezoning efforts aim to encourage a more pedestrian-oriented environment to better promote walkable retail and mixed-use development.
- Zoning changes will permit commercial uses in former industrial buildings, enabling adaptive reuse.

Zoning

Manayunk's zoning is dominated by rowhouse residential districts, with commercial and mixed-use districts concentrated along two major street corridors, which has reinforced the concentration of residential zoning in the interior of the neighborhood.

Residential

Manayunk is dominated by areas zoned for Residential Single-Family Attached (RSA), which together account for 59% of the neighborhood. RSA-5 (44%) and RSA-3 (13%) account for the highest proportions, reflecting the rowhouse typology seen throughout the neighborhood.[49]

The proportion of land zoned for Residential Single-Family Detached (RSD) housing districts is small. There is a presence of some detached houses in low-density residential areas, which are usually located in peripheral areas or in areas with poor street connectivity. Although multi-family residential areas do exist, they are limited in number, indicating that high-density housing is not the main use of this community. In total, residential zoning accounts for 71% of all zoned land in Manayunk.[50]

71%

58% RSA
7% RSD
3% RM
1% RTA
1% RMX

Commercial

The commercial-zoned areas of Main Street and Ridge Avenue accommodate many types of commercial activities and mixed-use developments, with convenient transportation options. Mixed-use zoning districts in these two corridors typically have retail, dining, and service industries on the ground floor, while the upper floors are for residential use. Compared to residential zones, there are relatively less areas zoned for commercial use (7%).

7%

4% CMX-2
2% CMX-2.5
1% CMX-1
0.4% CA-1

Industrial

Industrial and mixed industrial zones account for approximately 11% of all zoned land, despite Manayunk appearing to be a mostly residential area when walking through the built environment. Of the industrial area, ICMX accounts for the most at 5%, followed by I-2 (4%), I-1 (2%), and IRMX (1%).[51]

Areas zoned for industrial use are concentrated along the Schuylkill River, reflecting historical patterns of industry. Many of the historically industrial zone districts have transitioned to mixed-use. This zoning supports various commercial-industrial mixed-use & commercial-residential mixed-use activities such as light industry, production, manufacturing, and warehousing.

11%

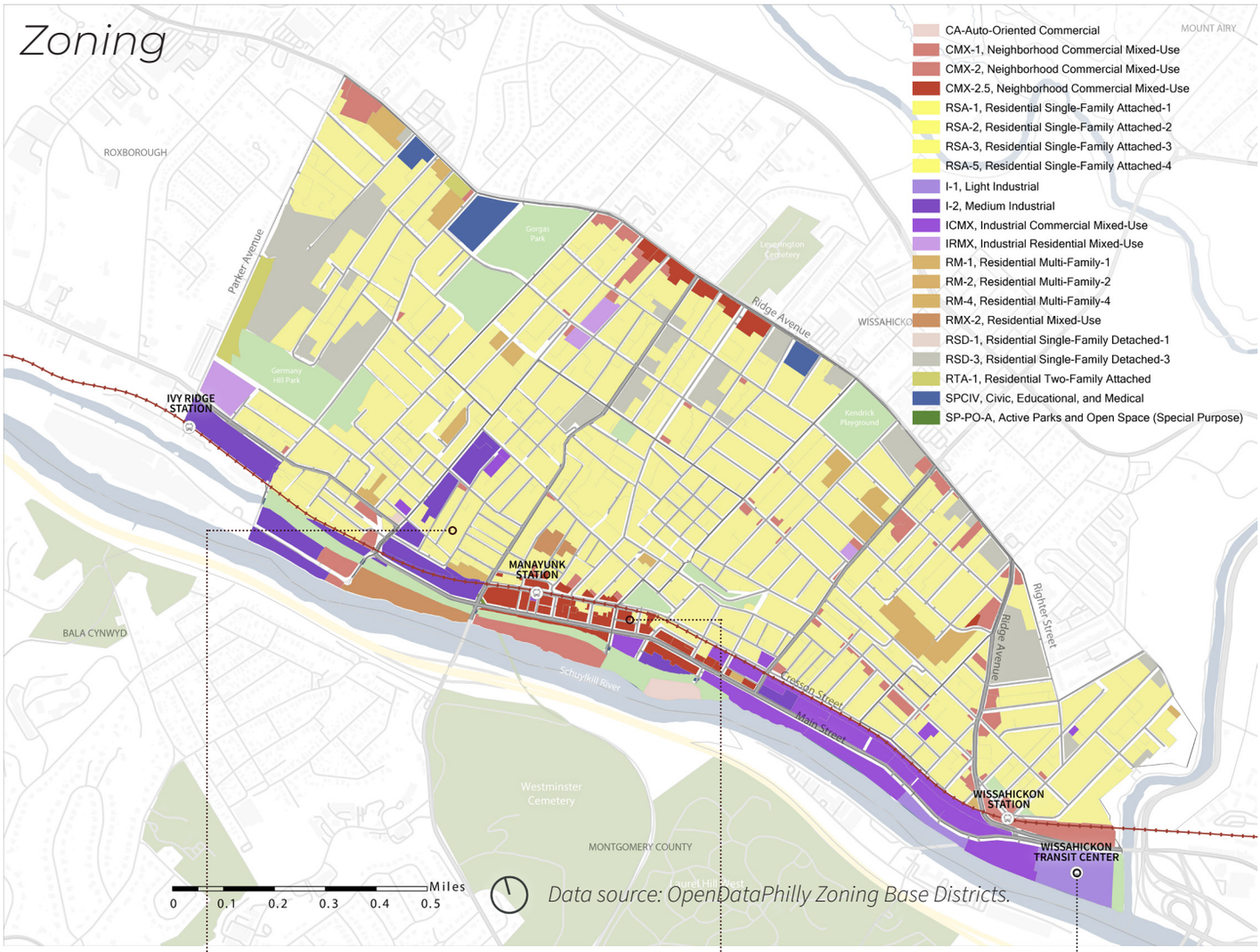
5% ICMX
4% I-2
2% I-1
1% IRMX

Parks and Open Space

Lastly, around a tenth of all land in Manayunk is zoned as special-purpose areas, particularly as SP-PO-A (9%) and SP-CIV (1%). This indicates that a considerable portion of the land is reserved for parks and open spaces, and municipal functions, thereby determining which areas can develop and which areas' land is restricted by public or protected uses.

10%

9% SP-PO-A
1% SP-CIV



Residential Single-Family Attached (RSA)

Commercial Mixed-Use (CMX)

Industrial (I-1&2)

Land Use

Residential

Manayunk is a primarily residential neighborhood, with 47% of total land area in residential use. Medium-density housing has the largest share (23%), while low-density residential (18%) high-density residential (5%) make up a higher share. This indicates that the community mainly consists of row houses and medium-density housing, while high-density residential buildings are less common.[52]

47%

23% Medium-density residential
18% Low-density residential
5% High-density residential

Transportation

About 26% of Manayunk is designated as transportation and roads, making it the second largest land use type. This large proportion reflects the significant influence of the main transportation arteries, bridges, and infrastructure along the Schuylkill River and throughout the community.

26%

Commercial

In contrast, the total area of commercial land use is limited, accounting for only about 5%, and it is concentrated in several smaller areas rather than dispersed throughout the community. These land uses are mainly for commercial consumption purposes (3%) and office and service purposes (0.8%), along with some smaller commercial subtypes. This may strengthen a few active transportation arteries as commercial uses generate daily destinations for shopping, services, and employment, while leaving most areas dominated by residential uses.[53]

5%

Vacant land

The vacant land proportion is 5%, indicating that although some lots may be suitable for infill development, most of Manayunk has already been built out. Future development in Manayunk is likely to occur through smaller infill projects due to the distribution of vacant land in the neighborhood.[54]

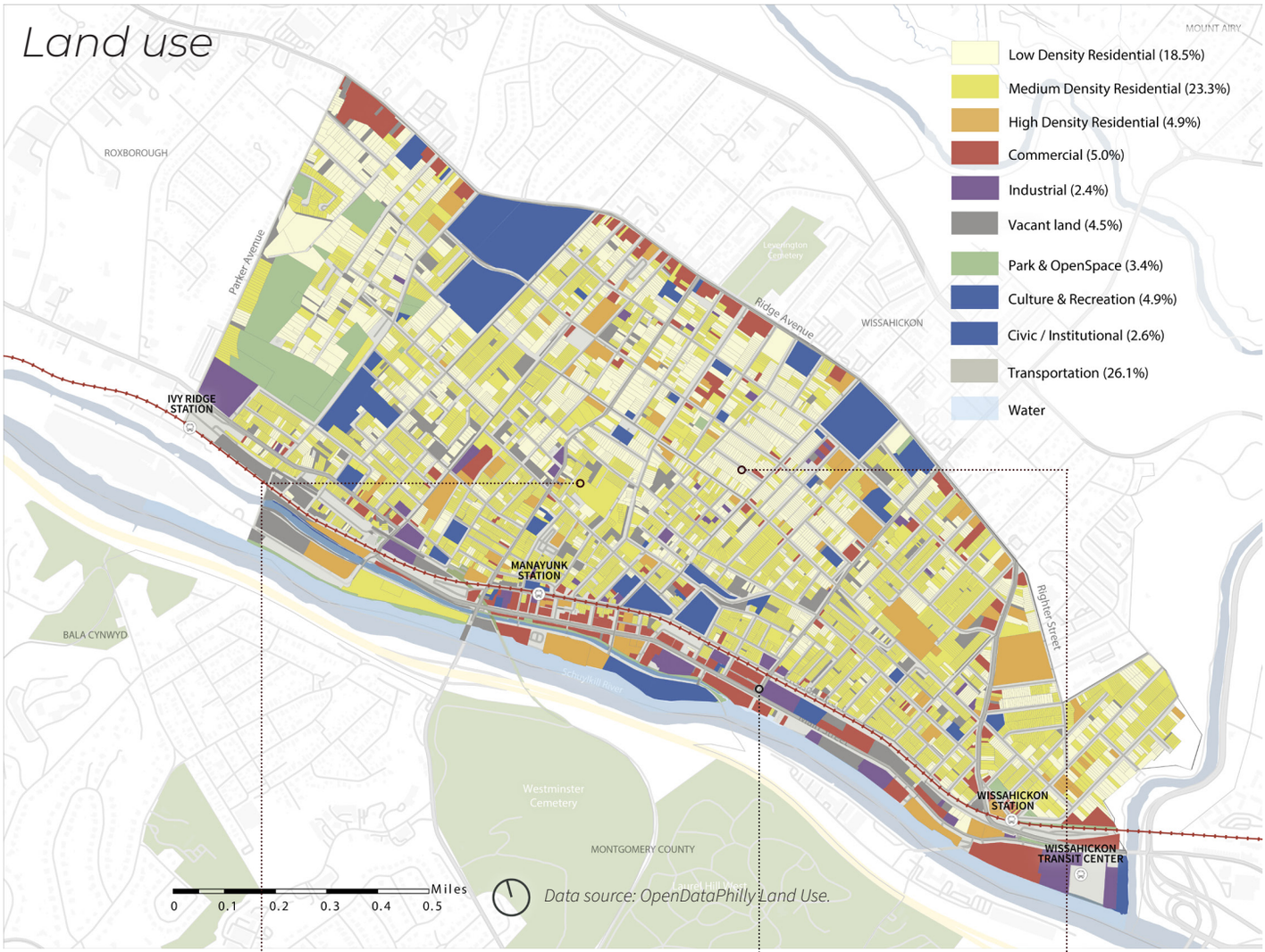
5%

Other uses

Cultural and recreational land (5%) and parks and open spaces (3%) provide amenities and community service, while water areas (5%) form the periphery of the Schuylkill River waterfront community. Industrial land (2%) and civic and institutional land (3%) remain limited and are only distributed in smaller local lots. This indicates that large campuses or heavy employment districts are not the dominant features of this region.[55]

3%

5%



Medium-Density Housing

The compact row house blocks and small multi-unit buildings constitute the majority of the residential areas in Manayunk

Commercial Mixed-Use

Ground floor is for retail, dining, and service industries, while the upper floors are for residential use

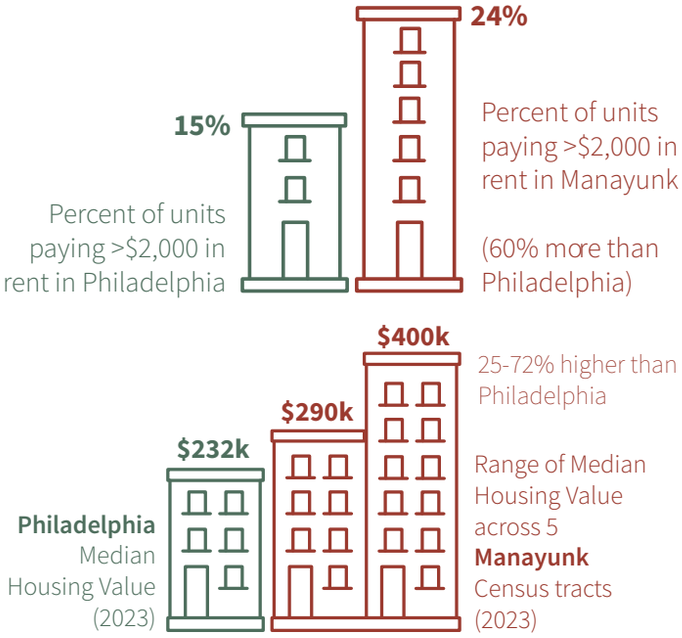
Low-Density Housing

The spacing between houses is greater, the lots are larger, more space for trees and backyard

Housing

Manayunk has a variety of housing types, with most housing units constructed before 1939; the average residential building age is 95 years.[56] In the past 10 years, Manayunk has seen increased housing development, which has been characterized by an influx of new residents and denser housing typologies. In 2013, there were 8,963 total housing units, which has since increased by 1,532 units (17%) to 10,495 in 2023.[57] Multifamily units have accounted for 78% of that growth (compared to 29% of housing growth before 2013).[58]

Philadelphia versus Manayunk's Housing Costs



Household Types & Costs

Manayunk is becoming an increasingly unaffordable neighborhood to live in. As of 2023, median housing value in Philadelphia is around $232,000. However, the median housing values across Manayunk's five census tracts are much higher, ranging from $290,000 to $400,000 (25-72% higher). Overall the homeownership rate has decreased slightly, from 57% in 2013 to 51% in 2023. Still, Manayunk remains a majority owner-occupant neighborhood.[59,60]

Furthermore, while only 15% of Philadelphia households pay over $2,000 in rent in 2023, 24% of Manayunk households pay over $2,000. The number of rent-burdened households in Manayunk has decreased over the last decade, from 42% to 30%; this is likely on account of mean household income in Manayunk increasing 18% during this time. Rents have also stayed roughly stable between 2013 to 2023 in Manayunk, adjusting for inflation.[61] Although the total percentage of rent-burdened households in Manayunk has decreased over the last decade , the percentage of rent-burdened senior householders rose from 23% in 2013 to 58% in 2023.[62]

Lastly, the percentage of long-term residents in Manayunk has fallen. In 2013, one-third of all Manayunk householders had lived in their unit for over 13 years. By 2023, that percentage decreased to less than one-quarter.[63]

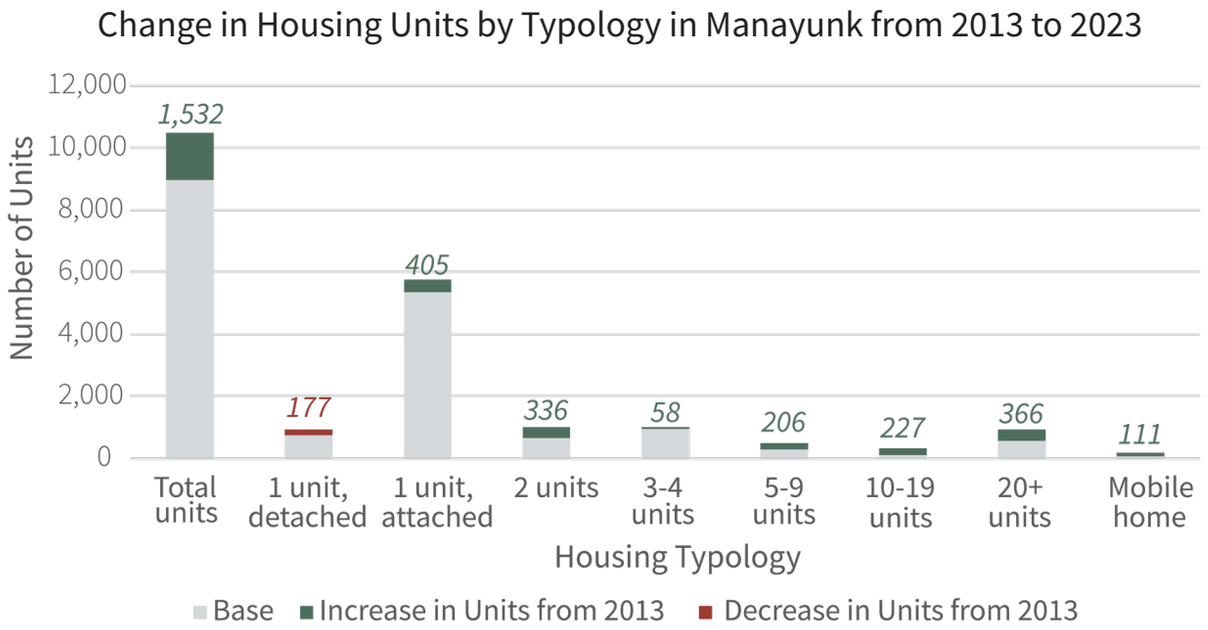
Together, these findings suggest that Manayunk is becoming a wealthier and younger neighborhood.

Typical Housing Forms

A typical single-family attached rowhome in Manayunk (190 Markle Street, built ~1925)

A typical single-family detached house in Manayunk (373 Green Lane, built ~1930)

New multifamily construction in Manayunk (Parkline, 6174 Ridge Avenue, built 2026)



Data Source: 5-Year ACS (2013 & 2023) DP04: Profile of General Population and Housing Characteristics

Physical Conditions

Over 50% of the housing in Manayunk was built prior to 1939. The average year of construction for a residential building in Manayunk is 1931, showing the age of the neighborhood.[64] This is in stark contrast to the influx of new, multifamily construction in Manayunk over the past decade.

Historic Buildings

As a result of its designation under the National Register of Historic Places, over 100 historic buildings in the Main Street Manayunk Historic District are eligible for historic tax credits, which cover approximately 15-18% of rehabilitation costs.[66,67] Secondly, Philadelphia zoning code allows for Accessory Dwelling Units to be constructed inside designated historic zones such as the Main Street Manayunk Historic District. However, ADUs are not permitted outside of the Historic District due to their restriction under the Fourth District Zoning Overlay.[68] Adaptive reuse of historic structures, use of historic tax credits, and expansion of the areas that permit ADUs are all potential strategies to increase the number of housing units in Manayunk.

Transportation

Manayunk, situated between the Schuylkill River and Wissahickon Valley Park, is physically separated from the rest of Philadelphia and relies on a handful of key connections to reach the rest of the city. With the neighborhood's steep terrain, narrow roads, and limited space, Manayunk faces physical limitations to its transportation infrastructure. The three Regional Rail stations and Wissahickon Transit Center make Manayunk an ideal neighborhood for transit commuters who live along the transit corridor near Main Street.

Local Roads and Highways

Manayunk's narrow streets create competition for space on the roads. Between street parking, traffic lanes, sidewalks, and bikers, many of Manayunk's roads are forced to be one-way. The narrow street layout and often steep inclines limit the volume and speed of vehicle traffic.

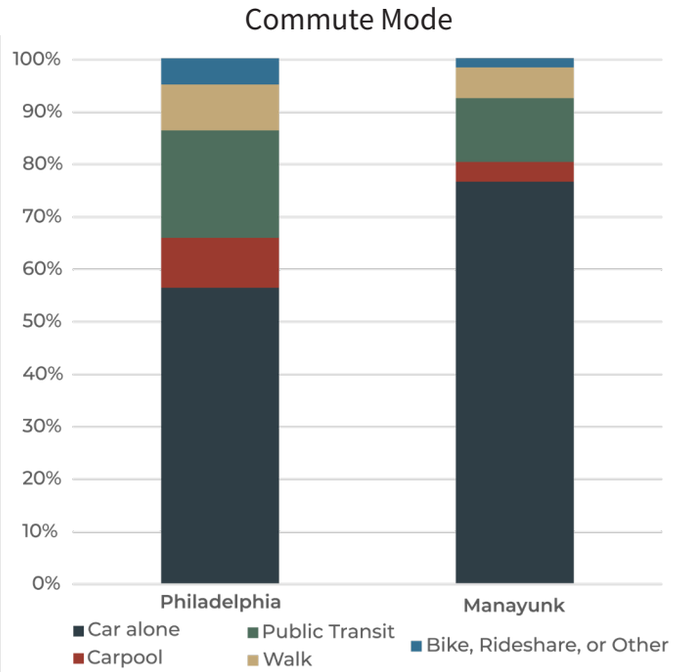
The limited capacity of Manayunk's local roads funnels most vehicle traffic to the neighborhood's two main arterials: Ridge Avenue and Main Street. Ridge Avenue, with its wide lanes and high volume and speed of vehicle traffic, is the primary arterial connecting

the neighborhood out to neighboring areas, the Wissahickon Transit Center, I-76, and the Roosevelt Expressway (which serves Northeast Philadelphia). Main Street is a major commercial corridor in Manayunk, carrying two lanes of traffic parallel to the Schuylkill River. In the downtown core, Main Street's travel speeds are slower than on Ridge Avenue and the narrow roadway design creates a pedestrian-friendly corridor.

Interstate 76 is the most integral roadway for accessing the neighborhood. As of 2024, the highway sees an average of nearly 70,000 daily trips, or 11.7 million annually.[65] It serves as the main route for travel between Center City and Manayunk for buses and private vehicles.

Congestion

About 80% of commuters in Manayunk travel by car, nearly 15 percentage points higher than commuters citywide. Due to the limited access points across the Schuylkill River and Wissahickon Creek, congestion builds up during peak travel hours. Delays build up around the southeast of the neighborhood where Ridge Avenue meets Main Street and turns off to meet the Wissahickon Transit Center, I-76, and Roosevelt Expressway. Main Street also sees steady congestion as a major commercial corridor in the neighborhood with only one lane of traffic in either direction—used by cars, buses, and trucks that often offload to businesses.



Data Source: 5-year American Community Survey (2023), S0802 Means of Transportation to Work by Selected Characteristics, B08006 Sex of Workers by Means of Transportation to Work

Rail and Bus Transit

Manayunk is served by SEPTA's Manayunk/Norristown Regional Rail Line, which begins at Penn Medicine and runs northwest to Norristown. In Manayunk, the Regional Rail line is constructed at grade until they become elevated at Shurs Lane. The tracks create a series of dead ends along Cresson Street starting at Ridge Avenue, creating barriers between residential areas and Main Street. Three stations provide convenient access: Wissahickon, Manayunk, and Ivy Ridge. A typical commute takes 27 minutes to get from the Manayunk Station to Suburban Station in Center City, making it a competitive mode of transportation for city-center commuters. The Manayunk Regional Rail Station is located below the steep ridge running through the neighborhood, making this commute challenging for those that have to walk along the steep sidewalks, and inaccessible for those with mobility limitations.

Manayunk and the Wissahickon Transit Center are served by 10 SEPTA bus lines. The Wissahickon Transit Center serves as a key bus hub for travel in and out of Northwest Philadelphia, facilitating an estimated 4,600 passengers daily. The newly renovated transit hub offers ADA-compliant boarding areas for each bus route, as well as shelter, seating, and dedicated turn-ins for buses. However, the station may be hard to reach for physically disabled transit users due to its location at the bottom of the neighborhood's steep hill and across two high-traffic roadways that feed I-76. Bus route 35 currently provides travel within the Manayunk and Roxborough area, however SEPTA announced that this line would be discontinued in fall 2026, with service allocated to extend bus route 61.[69]

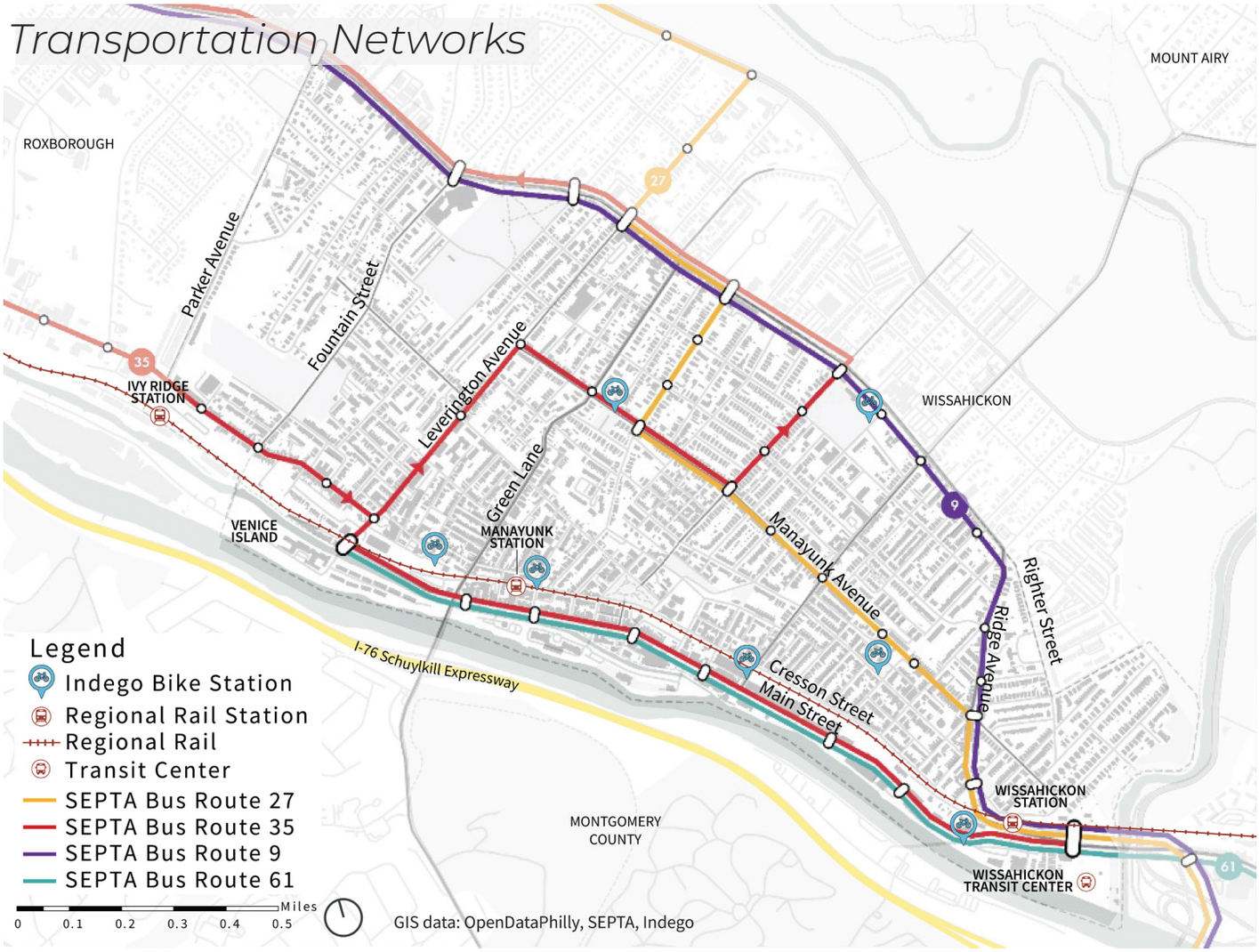
Active Transportation

Despite the steep terrain in Manayunk, the neighborhood is well served by nearby protected walking and bike trails. One could bike seven miles from Manayunk to Center City nearly entirely on

A typical street in Manayunk with one-way traffic and street parking

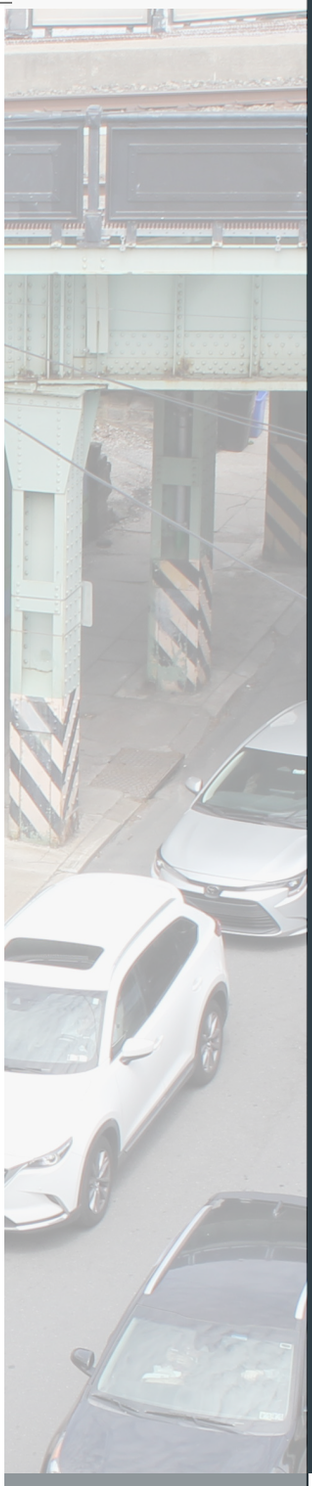
Indego bike station on Cresson Street

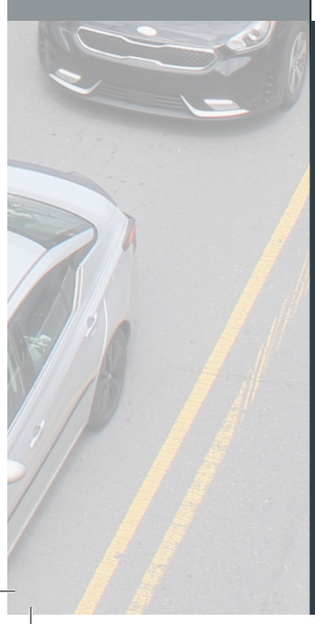
protected paths via the Schuylkill River Trail, but it is likely unfeasible for most commuters. Manayunk has seven Indego bikeshare stations, but it is the furthest northwest location served by the bikeshare system. Electric Indego bikes make the hills more manageable, but the lack of non east-west dedicated bike routes pose hazards due to the difficulty to control speeds on declines, and the narrow roads with poor visibility and frequent cars. The neighborhood's naturally narrow streets and slow vehicle speeds make it a relatively safe place for pedestrians despite a general lack of major pedestrian infrastructure beyond sidewalks.



03
OPPORTUNITIES & ISSUES

A mural "Welcome to Manayunk" on the approach from Green Lane entering the neighborhood.





Opportunities *32*
Issues *34*

Opportunities

Diverse Transit Connections

One of the many attractive features of Manayunk is the neighborhood's connection to Center City Philadelphia and the broader region through SEPTA Regional Rail and bus routes.

There is convenient SEPTA access in the neighborhood via the Manayunk, Wissahickon, and Ivy Ridge stations on the Manayunk/Norristown Regional Rail Line, and the Wissahickon Transit Center, which provides service on 10 bus routes.[70] This extensive public transit connectivity gives the neighborhood strong external access and creates the condition for workers and visitors to reach and experience the community.

Wissahickon Transit Center

Vitality of Two Commercial Corridors

There are two main commercial corridors in Manayunk, Main Street and Ridge Avenue. Main Street, located in the southwestern part of Manayunk, is a pedestrian-friendly commercial corridor in the neighborhood with indoor and outdoor dining and nightlife options. The Wissahickon Transit Center, Manayunk Station, and Wissahickon Station are all

Main Street

transportation hubs placed strategically along Main Street, facilitating easy access between Main Street and Center City. The Main Street corridor has a strong arts atmosphere and vibrant shops and restaurants, attracting both residents and visitors.

Ridge Avenue runs through Manayunk and into Roxborough. It is a more auto-centric commercial corridor. Ridge Avenue is less visitor-focused but rather neighborhood-serving, with a more auto-oriented commercial environment that is more closely tied to surrounding community life and everyday needs. Because Main Street and Ridge Avenue serve distinct community interests, Manayunk has a valuable opportunity to support both tourism and everyday local life across both corridors.

Historic Preservation and Adaptive Reuse

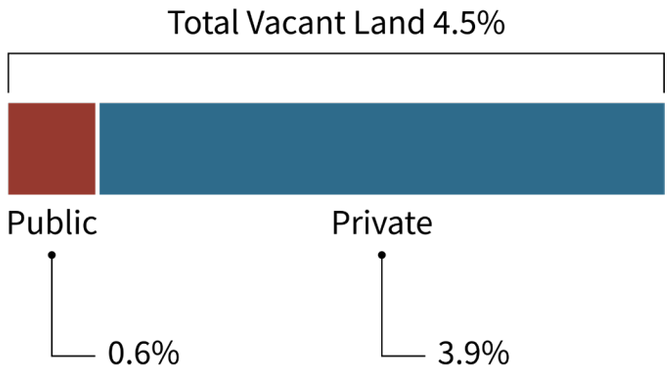
Manayunk has many historic resources, including registered historic places, churches, and historic street paving.

Developments along Main Street are incorporated into the Main Street Historic District, with approximately 100 buildings being eligible for historic tax credits. This presents the opportunity to lower future renovation costs by around 15-18%, presenting an opportunity for preservation, reinvestment, and adaptive reuse of these historic buildings.[71]

Street dancing at the Manayunk StrEAT Food Festival

Vibrant Organizations, Culture & Activities

Manayunk is home to many community organizations. The largest organization, the Manayunk Development Corporation (MDC), supports the Main Street business district and helps organize major public events such as the Arts Festival, Manayunk StrEAT Food Festival, and Restaurant Week.[72] The MDC is also responsible for supporting and promoting businesses along Main Street through social media engagement and economic development initiatives. Additionally, the Manayunk Neighborhood Council (MNC) is a registered community organization that supports neighborhood advocacy and responsible development Manayunk.[73] The MNC has a strong cultural legacy in Manayunk, hosting events like the annual Philadelphia Cycling Classic. Other organizations like the Ridge Park Civic Association and the North Light Community Center also support volunteer initiatives and local youth, contributing to the tight-knit nature of the Manayunk community.



Access to Open Space and Trails

Access to the numerous parks, trails, and the Schuylkill River makes for an attractive resident experience with access to open space.

The Manayunk Canal Towpath runs directly behind Main Street as a two-mile trail for walking, jogging, and biking, while the Wissahickon Valley Park provides a much larger landscape of woods, creeks, and trail systems. Manayunk's natural resources are closely integrated into everyday community life creating the opportunity for residents to support the parks through local cleanup and service days.

Manayunk Towpath[76]

Development Potential

Manayunk has potential for further development.

Manayunk consists of 4.5% vacant land.[74] Of the vacant land available, 0.6% sits in public ownership and 3.9% in private ownership.[75] Venice Island is the largest portion of undeveloped land, largely attributed to its formerly industrial use and its location in the 100-year FEMA floodplain. This vacant land presents an opportunity for community-centered development where it is deemed environmentally suitable.

Issues

Flood Risk

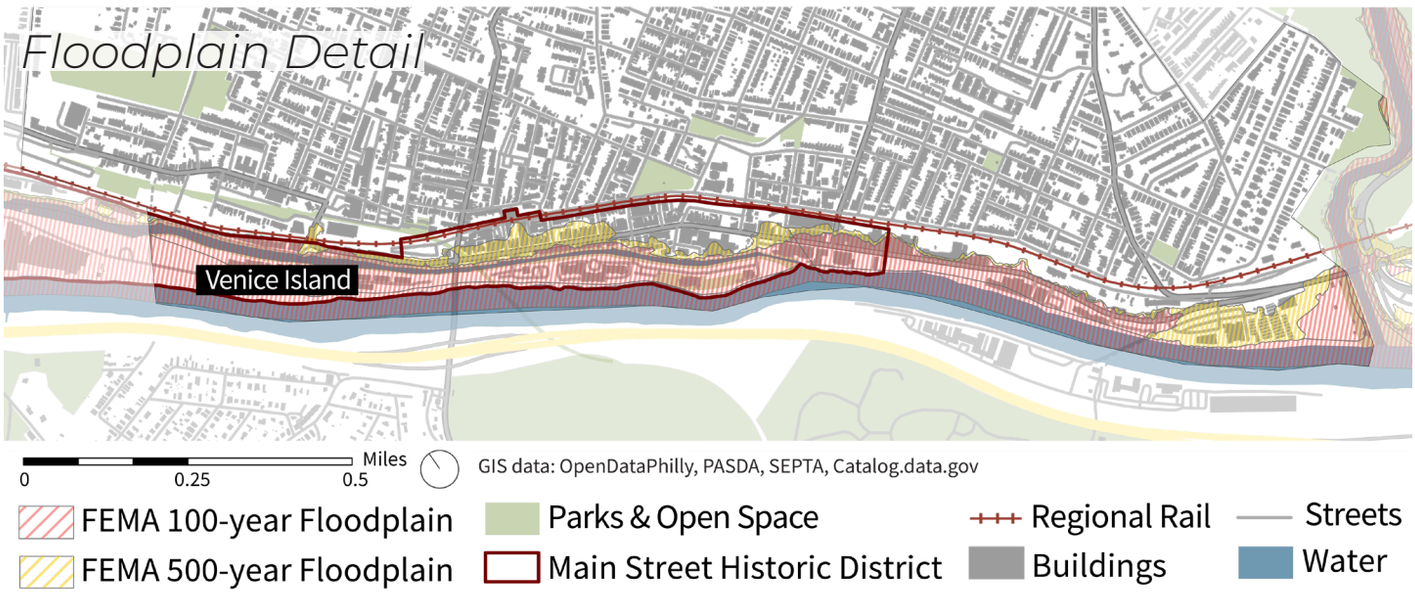
While there is opportunity for development on vacant land, risk of flooding is one of the largest obstacles pertaining to development in the neighborhood.

More than 200 structures in Manayunk rest within the 100-year floodplain, primarily along Main Street and near public transit sites.[77] There is a history of flooding on the Main Street corridor; in 2021, Hurricane Ida caused lasting damage to infrastructure and resulted in commercial vacancies. Despite Manayunk's flood history, in recent years, there has been a surge in residential developments along Venice Island, making flood risks even more consequential for residents.

High Rents

Manayunk has much higher rents compared to the rest of Philadelphia.

In 2023, 24% of rental units in Manayunk cost $2,000 or more a month, compared to 15% of rental units in Philadelphia costing $2,000 or more a month.[80] Although Manayunk rental prices have remained stable between 2013 and 2023 when adjusted for inflation, rents remain high compared to the rest of Philadelphia.[81]



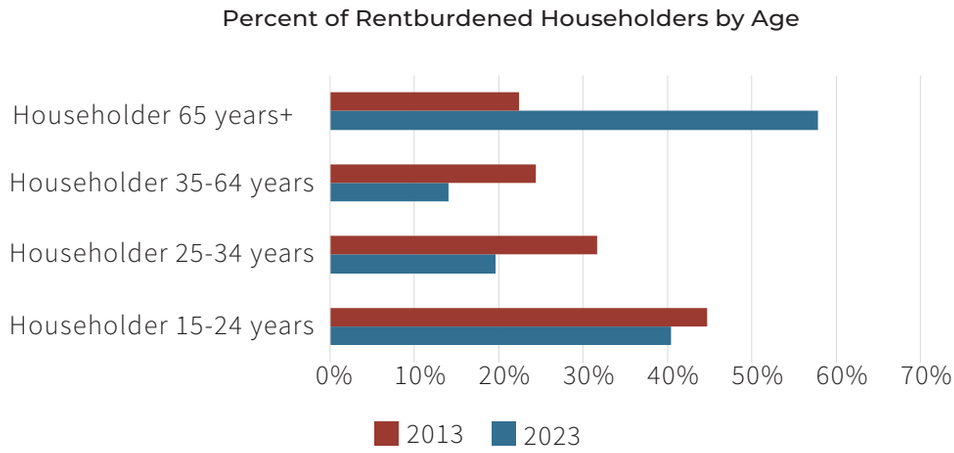
Aging Housing Stock

Despite its charming historic character, Manayunk has an old housing stock, posing infrastructural challenges. The average age of residential buildings in Manayunk is 95 years old, with over 50% of housing being built prior to 1939.[78] Around 75% of all residential buildings in Manayunk have been assessed to have a building grade of C+ or worse, indicating subpar residential infrastructure, especially for longer-term homeowners.[79]

Rent-Burdened Seniors

Seniors in Manayunk are bearing the brunt of high rents, representing the most vulnerable age demographic among the renting population.

Manayunk's median age is 28 years old, which is younger than Philadelphia at 35 years old.[82] Senior residents make up 10% of the population. Almost half of Manayunk residents rent. Despite their smaller makeup of the total population, householders 65 and above make up 7% of renters.[83,84] As of 2023, 31% of



Data Source: 5-Year ACS (2013 & 2023) B25072: Age of Householder by Gross Rent as a Percentage of Household Income in the Past 12 Months

Manayunk residents are rent-burdened, decreasing from 42% in 2013.[85] This suggests that rates of rent burden overall have decreased.

However, a growing number of seniors are rent burdened. About 58% of householders above 65-years-old are rent burdened, a sharp increase from 23% in 2013.[86] In comparison, rates of rent burden have actually decreased since 2013 for all other age groups in Manayunk, indicating that renting seniors in Manayunk are particularly vulnerable to rent shocks.

Car Dependency

Manayunk demonstrates a higher rate of car dependency for commuting to work compared to the rest of Philadelphia.

Despite the fact that Manayunk is well connected by public transit through Regional Rail stations and the Wissahickon Transit Center, approximately 77% of Manayunk relies on cars to commute to work.[87] In comparison to the rest of Philadelphia, Manayunk exceeds the citywide rate of car usage by more than 20 percentage points.

Steep Terrain

Manayunk's steep topography also poses a significant challenge for mobility, inhibiting inter-neighborhood mobility, thus limiting access to wider transit networks and making the neighborhood less walkable as a whole. There is about a 300-foot elevation gain from Main Street to the northern area of Manayunk, requiring stairs to connect areas from below and above the ridge.[88] This steep terrain can make mobility within the Manayunk neighborhood difficult for older and disabled residents without car access.

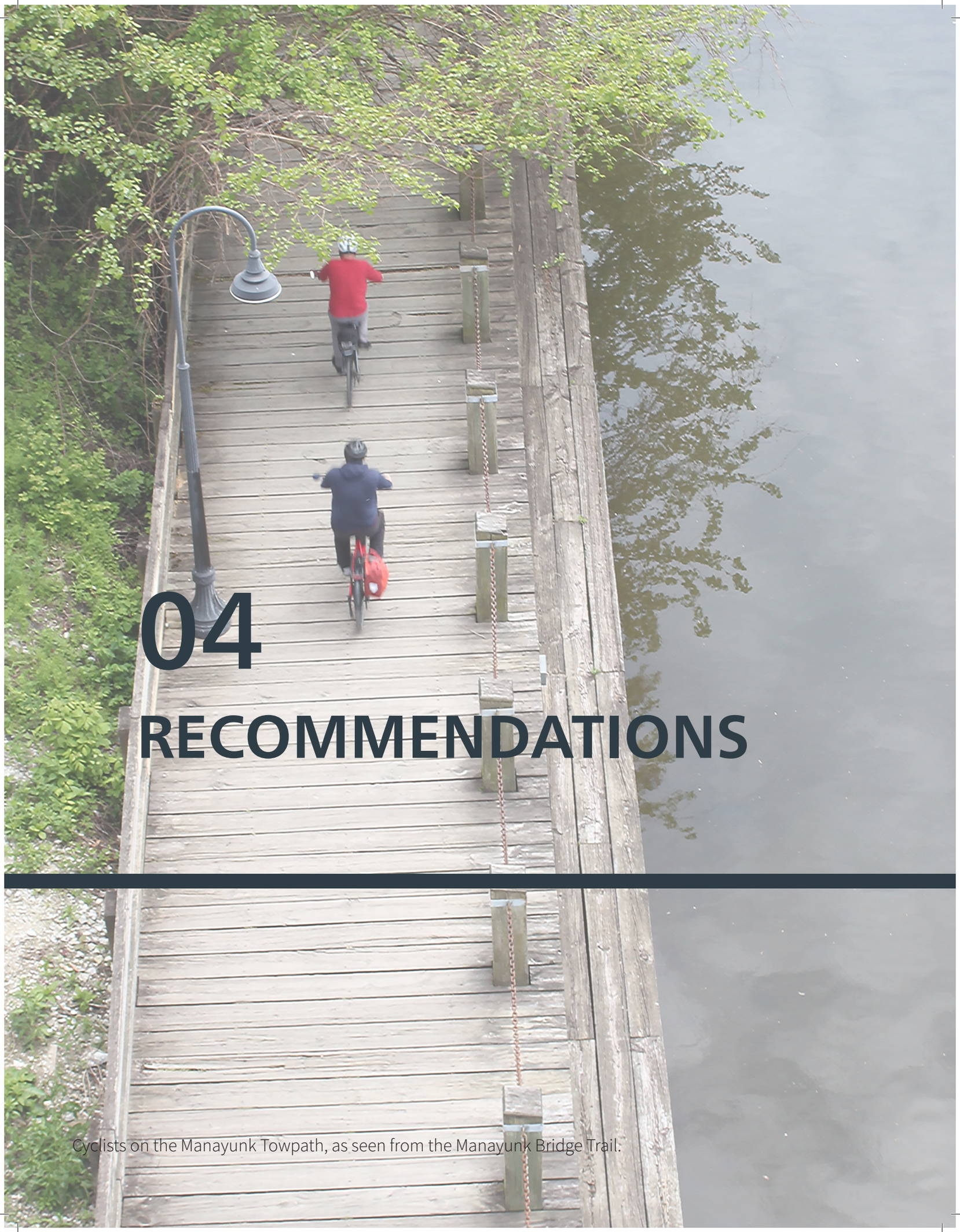
Road Safety

The steep terrain of the neighborhood also creates challenges for road safety, specifically for bikers.

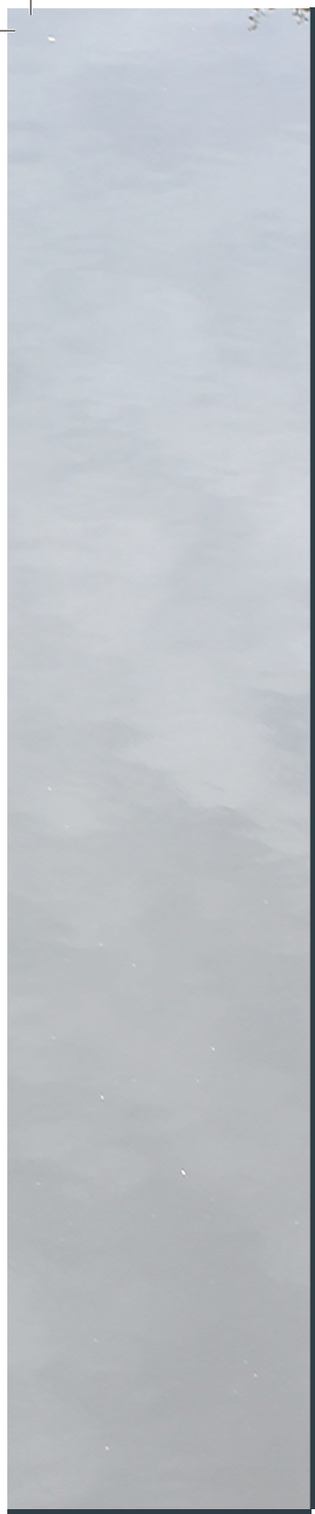
Manayunk overall has a very low rate of road fatalities. Since 2019, the two fatalities in the neighborhood have both involved biking.[89] The steep roads and narrow shared space make for dangerous biking experiences in Manayunk. While biking along Main Street is a cultural strong suit of Manayunk, safe biking infrastructure throughout the neighborhood is inconsistent.

Levering Street[90]

04
RECOMMENDATIONS



Cyclists on the Manayunk Towpath, as seen from the Manayunk Bridge Trail.



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Environment 60
Infrastructure 70

Vision & Goals

In the future, Manayunk is a connected, resilient, and inclusive neighborhood with strong commercial corridors, climate-conscious development, well-supported community networks, and increased access and opportunity for current and future residents, businesses, and visitors.

COMMUNITY

Develop housing strategies that promote a range of housing types and affordability, supporting the needs of Manayunk's current and future residents.

Create financial programs that support local businesses and property owners in repairing and improving the built environment.

ECONOMIC

Support and invest in the local economy and Manayunk's major commercial corridors.

Promote climate-conscious development in the floodplain area.

ENVIRONMENT

Improve flood-resilience using ecological planning and green infrastructure solutions.

Enhance trail conditions and local connectivity.

INFRASTRUCTURE

Increase access to multimodal transit for Manayunk residents and visitors.

Activate vacant land and underutilized lots to become community assets.

Recommendations

How to read this plan

In total, this plan proposes 20 recommendations for creating a more resilient Manayunk, which are presented in order of the four themes: community, economic, environment, and infrastructure resilience. These recommendations take shape as either programs, projects, or policies. Programs are centered around extended activities or events, projects focus on physical improvements, and policies typically feature legislative changes.

Each recommendation also includes a box with five elements: Goals Met, Partners, Funding, Cost, and Time. Each recommendation supports one or more of the plan's goals, represented by the icons under "Goals met." "Partners" are groups or organizations who are key to implementing the recommendation, while "Funding" identifies potential sources of financial support for each recommendation. The "Cost" section features dollar signs which represent the cost of the recommendation on a logarithmic scale from $5,000 to $50 million. Finally, the "Time" section describes how long the recommendation would take for implementation, represented by how many dots are shaded in and a range of years.

PROGRAM PROJECT POLICY

Cost

$ = $5,000

$$ = $50,000

$$$ = $500,000

$$$$ = $5 million

$$$$$ = $50 million

Time

7 *Increase Visibility of Small Businesses and Commercial Activity outside of Main Street*

PROGRAM

Main Street acts as a key center for tourism in Manayunk. This recommendation builds upon existing marketing efforts and events on Main Street to drive commercial activity and economic vitality on Ridge Avenue and throughout the neighborhood.

Additionally, car dependency has been identified as a condition of the difficult terrain of the neighborhood. Providing incentives for public transit use encourages transit use for visitors as well as gives residents alternatives to using their cars. Through the existence of strong infrastructure currently, this recommendation can likely be completed within a year.

Manayunk StrEAT Food Festival 2025[91]

Objectives:

- Increase diversity of businesses represented at Main Street events.
- Utilize the existing Manayunk Main Street image to increase local spending at businesses along Ridge Avenue.
- Encourage visitors to venture beyond Main Street and distribute commercial activity around the neighborhood.
- Incentivize public transit use to improve the walkability of Main Street during high-attendance events.

Actions:

- Implement a “Manayunk Go” transit partnership between SEPTA and local businesses, incentivizing visitors to commute to the neighborhood via transit instead of car through coupons or deals to local businesses during Manayunk Development Corporation festivals and events.
- Develop and implement a pilot program: During Manayunk Restaurant Week 2027, the first 100 visitors to show proof of SEPTA ridership into the neighborhood receive a free first drink from participating restaurants. Participating restaurants will be coordinated through MDC. Restaurants are incentivized to participate through increased foot traffic and the expectation of patrons continuing to purchase drinks and beverages.
- Develop and implement a second pilot program: During Manayunk Street Food Festival 2027, MDC will provide a “Small Business Grocery Store” table with samples from participating stores free for customers and 10% off coupons. This will aid in the visibility of small businesses who are unable to afford a full station at the food festival.

CASE STUDY: Visit Philly "Grocery Store" Pop-Up

Source: Kyle Stein, Visit Philly

Visit Philly provides a great model for replicable marketing as their sole purpose is to boost tourism, shopping, and experience in the Philadelphia area. The activation shown here, a "Gourmet Market" pop-up featured businesses that are a part of the Sisterly Love Collective, a non-profit highlighting women in the food and hospitality space. The pop-up was a one-day event at the 2025 Chef Conference, utilizing existing foot traffic to highlight small businesses that would not have had capacity otherwise.[92,93]

Goals Met

Cost $

Partners
- Manayunk Development Corporation
- SEPTA
- Visit Philly
- Ridge Park Civic Association

Time | Short Term

● ○ ○ ○ 1 - 2 Years

Funding
- MDC Seed Donation (if needed)
- Philadelphia Reinvestment Fund

2 Start a Block Build Program for Home Repairs

PROGRAM

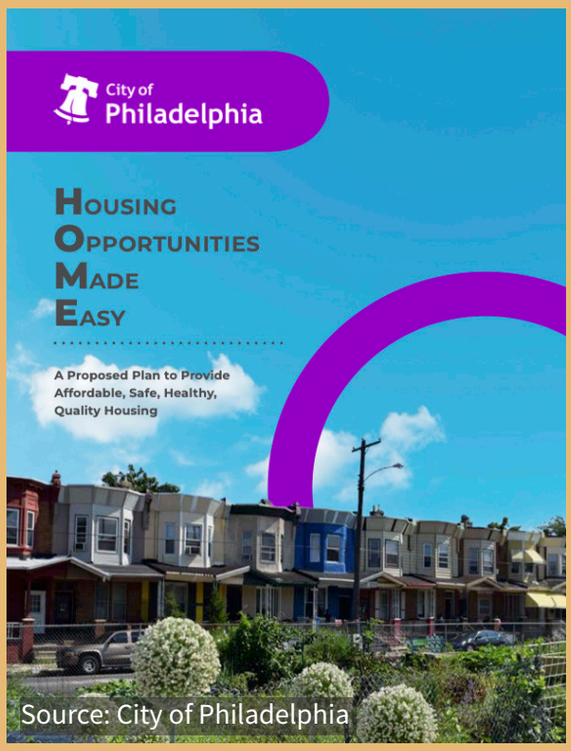
Manayunk has a distinct demographic divide with the neighborhood mostly consisting of young college students and professionals with a small proportion of older, long-term residents. Manayunk is also a historic neighborhood, with an aging housing stock. For the older and often lower-income residents of Manayunk, maintaining these homes can be both a physical and financial challenge. The creation of a block build program will set up community events where volunteers from the local community conduct repairs for homeowners unable to repair their own homes.

The program will provide an opportunity for the young, new residents of Manayunk to contribute to the community around them. Through regular community block builds, homeowners will have the chance to see their living conditions improved and home values increased. At the same time, younger residents of Manayunk will be able to give back to the neighborhood and strengthen their bonds to the local community.

Objectives:

- Allow older residents to age in place in good quality homes.
- Increase home values for long-term owners who have experienced stagnant home value appreciation relative to neighborhood trends.
- Provide opportunity for different demographic groups within the neighborhood to interact.
- Improve aesthetic appeal of Manayunk.

EXISTING PLANS



Source: City of Philadelphia

Under the Housing Opportunities Made Easy (H.O.M.E.) plan of Mayor Cherelle Parker, home repairs are a key aspect to preserving housing stock in Philadelphia. A block build program builds upon initiatives such as the Restore, Repair, Renew home repair loan program and the Basic Systems Repair Program to ensure that Philadelphians have high quality and safe places to live.[94]

Actions:

- Market block build program through RCO networks to compile a database for suitable properties.
- Survey properties to build a ranked list of properties to target based on housing conditions.
- Partner with local universities and Registered Community Organizations (RCOs) to recruit volunteers and raise funds.
- Organize orientation for volunteers to familiarize power tool usage and block build day roles.
- Create a schedule for block builds on a regular basis, partnering with Rebuilding Together Philadelphia for expertise in organizing events.
- Survey participation satisfaction and continue to advertise the program throughout the neighborhood.

Partner Bio: Rebuilding Together Philadelphia

Rebuilding Together Philadelphia is a nonprofit organization that provides free home repairs for distressed homeowners in Philadelphia. In 2025, Rebuilding Together Philadelphia mobilized over 500 volunteers to repair 150 homes across the city, investing around $20,000 into each home.[95] The Block Build organization identifies around 5-10 neighboring units that qualify for this program, and work with the homeowners in the weeks leading up to the block build, administering critical repairs and improvements by skilled volunteers. On the day of the block build, unskilled volunteers from the neighborhood are trained and given non-essential tasks to finish the home repairs started by the skilled volunteers.

Source: Rebuilding Together Philadelphia 2025 Annual Report

As an implementation partner, Rebuilding Together Philadelphia would serve as the liaison between homeowners and volunteer groups, organize block build logistics, and provide training and leadership to volunteers.

Goals Met

Cost

$ $

Partners

- RCOs
- Rebuilding Together Philadelphia
- Saint Joseph's University
- Thomas Jefferson University

Time | Short Term

● ○ ○ ○ 1-2 Years

Funding

- City of Philadelphia
- Saint Joseph's University
- Thomas Jefferson University
- Small donations

3 Update Zoning Ordinances to Reflect Current Housing Needs and Development Patterns

POLICY

Manayunk is optimally located with strong character allowing the neighborhood to become an increasingly attractive place to live. This policy change would further ensure that housing units within the neighborhood remain affordable for current residents and as well as maintain its historical social fabric.

Objectives:

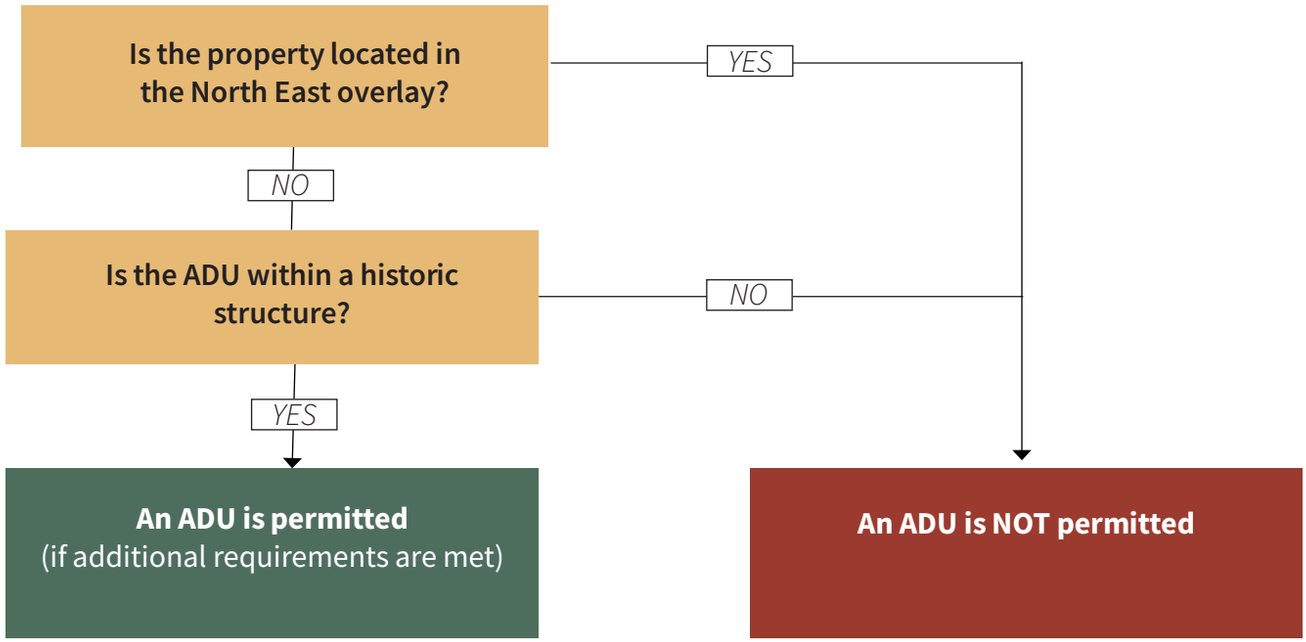
- Increase affordable housing supply reflective of existing development patterns.
- Maintain neighborhood affordability for current residents.
- Expand affordable development construction and accessory dwelling units (ADUs) over a 10-year timeline.

Actions:

- Identify a registered community organization or alliance to spearhead the recommendation.
- Secure funding to hire an outside consultant agency to draft a plan, detailing what the new zoning ordinance will consist of and how the revision will lead to specific outcomes, such as increased unit construction and affordability based on cost, location, and potential impact.
- Draft an updated zoning ordinance to allow ADUs outside of historic properties.
- Submit a zoning ordinance application to the Philadelphia Department of Planning and Development and review the draft ordinance.
- Conduct community outreach, including an accessible survey posted on Main Street and at the transit centers throughout the neighborhood to better understand community preferences and recommendations.
- Strategically lobby for support from the Philadelphia City Council Member for District 4. Engage this Council Member to promote their support of the measure through the zoning application and ordinance adoption process.
- Gain City support for implementation of plan proposal through Council Member approval and community engagement efforts.

Typical housing typology within northern Manayunk

Typical housing typology in lower Manayunk



City of Philadelphia Accessory Dwelling Unit Flow Chart[96]

Typical housing typology near Main Street

An ADU constructed behind a home near Green Lane

Goals Met

Partners

- Philadelphia Department of Planning and Development
- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Other RCOs
- District 4 Council Office

Funding

- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Other RCOs

Cost $ $

Time | Short Term ● ● ● ○ 5-10 Years

4 Implement and Expand Historic Preservation Programs

PROGRAM

Manayunk has a rich history which is reflected in its built environment. Expanding historic preservation programs in Manayunk will help to repair, preserve, and maintain historic properties and preserve neighborhood culture. The creation of a thematic historic district is one way to promote historic preservation as a community value and can help connect homeowners to resources for repairing and preserving homes.

Objectives:

- Repair, preserve, and maintain historic properties.
- Improve building quality for residents and historic neighborhood culture.
- Increase the number of historic designations.
- Increase the number of buildings repaired and renovated over a 10-year period.

Actions:

- Perform a study to identify potential properties to be included in thematic district and regulations regarding development and maintenance for the creation of a thematic district.
- Conduct community outreach to determine whether the Ridge Avenue Roxborough Thematic District and Main Street Thematic District should be expanded or if a new thematic district should be made.
- Implement identified historic properties into a thematic district using the Ridge Avenue Roxborough Thematic Historic District as an example.
- Hold public meetings in partnership with the Philadelphia Historical Commission to identify buildings and weigh in on the design process.

St. John the Baptist Church

Wissahickon Church

CASE STUDY: Ridge Avenue Roxborough Thematic Historic District

6832 Ridge Ave.

Ridge Avenue Thematic District parcel protected from demolition

Source: Cheryl Feldman, Ridge Park Civic Association

Through the Office of Councilman Jones, Jr., the Philadelphia Historical Commission has adopted a Thematic Historic District along Ridge Avenue in Roxborough with the purpose of ensuring the preservation of historically significant buildings and structures. The Philadelphia Historical Commission (PHC) hosted a public meetings to display information on the nomination of a Ridge Avenue Thematic District, as well as an overview of the design review process for exterior renovations to designated buildings. A key incentive for historic preservation includes the Storefront Improvement Program. All Ridge Avenue commercial storefronts are eligible for the program, which provides reimbursement of up to 50% of the cost for improvements (up to a maximum of $10,000 for a single commercial property). The Thematic District has not earned federal designation, indicating a long timeline to complete improvement projects.[97]

Goals Met

Cost $ $ $

Partners

- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Ridge Park Civic Association
- Philadelphia Historical Commission

Time | Long Term

15-20 Years

Funding

- Philadelphia Historical Commission
- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Keystone Historic Preservation Planning Grants[98]

5 Create a Neighborhood Trust

PROJECT

Manayunk is becoming an increasingly unaffordable neighborhood, meaning that lower-income residents and small businesses are increasingly at risk of being priced out of the neighborhood.

A newly created neighborhood trust in Manayunk could acquire residential and retail properties, to then be leased out to low-income residents and local businesses to ensure their continued livelihood in Manayunk. The neighborhood trust may also acquire and develop vacant properties according to needs within the neighborhood, as opposed to speculative investment from for-profit developers. Properties placed in the trust will be held affordable and community-serving in perpetuity, ensuring that low-income residents and small, local businesses will remain in the neighborhood regardless of future neighborhood appreciation.

Objectives:

- Generate new permanently affordable housing units and retail space.
- Provide spaces for small businesses to operate without threat of rising rents.
- Develop and manage real estate according to neighborhood desires as opposed to for-profit interest groups.
- Reduce speculation via buying and activating vacant and underutilized properties in the neighborhood.
- Create a circular economy within the neighborhood, where rents paid by tenants in trust properties go back to improving the neighborhood.

EXAMPLE ACQUISITION AND DEVELOPMENT SITE

This site, located a 2-minute walk from the Main Street commercial corridor and a 12-minute walk to the Manayunk Regional Rail station is an example of a transit-orientated development optimal for the neighborhood land trust. Zoned as a CMX-2, the parcel has potential for construction of affordable residential units on top of the existing building through utilizing existing zoning bonuses. If acquired and developed by the trust, the site could generate new affordable retail and residential space and introduce density slowly to the neighborhood.[100]

Source: Google Street View

Location: 4047-4049 Cresson Street

Acquisition cost: $795,000[99]

Retail space: 6,240 sq ft

Possible affordable residential space to be built: 5,800 sq ft (Six two-bedroom units)

Actions

- Register the land trust as a legal entity under the desired organizational framework (such as an LLC, 501(c)(3), or another entity).
- Create an executive board composed of local residents, business owners, and community groups who accurately reflect neighborhood opinions.
- Draw upon rich network of community land trusts and neighborhood trusts in Philadelphia for best practices on operating a successful neighborhood trust.
- Apply for initial seed funding from a philanthropic group or foundation.
- Use initial funding to hire first staff, obtain funding for acquiring and managing properties.
- Evaluate success of program after 10 years.

CASE STUDY: Kensington Corridor Trust

Source: Kensington Corridor Trust

Founded in 2019, the Kensington Corridor Trust (KCT) is a leading example of how a community organization can mitigate negative socioeconomic trends in favor of investing in long-term neighborhood needs.

Located on the disinvested Kensington Avenue commercial corridor in Philadelphia, the neighborhood trust combines community ownership and decision making with innovative financial and real estate development strategies to revitalize vacant properties for permanent affordability and neighborhood control. In the first four years of its operation, it had acquired 20 properties along the corridor and continues to expand its impact today. Keeping in mind the socioeconomic and difference in needs of community members in the two neighborhoods, KCT could serve as a partner in advising best practices for the Manayunk Trust.[101]

Goals Met

Cost

$ $ $

Partners

- Local RCOs
- Local land trusts

Time | Long Term

10+ Years

Funding

- Philadelphia Reinvestment Fund
- The Enterprise Center - Plenary Fund
- William Penn Foundation

6 Provide Partial Transit Subsidy for Service Workers

PROGRAM

Providing a partial transportation subsidy for service workers along the Main Street corridor, administered by the Manayunk Development Corporation (MDC), will aid in supporting and investing in the local economy while also increasing multimodal transit use.

A partial transit subsidy is essential for food service workers. As of 2023, the annual average weekly wage for those in the accommodations and food services sector is approximately $627, with an average annual pay of $32,627.[102] This is significantly lower than the average annual income for Philadelphia residents at $86,504 and Manayunk residents at $124,439.[103]

Food and accommodations are a prominent industry in Manayunk. However, only approximately 1% of Manayunk residents are employed in food preparation and serving occupations. This indicates that Manayunk relies on service workers from outside of the neighborhood rather than sustaining a local workforce.[104] Specifically, on the Main Street corridor,[105] there are approximately 835 workers employed in the accommodations and food services sector, making up 37% of the total share of employees along Main Street—the largest share of any industry in the area.[106]

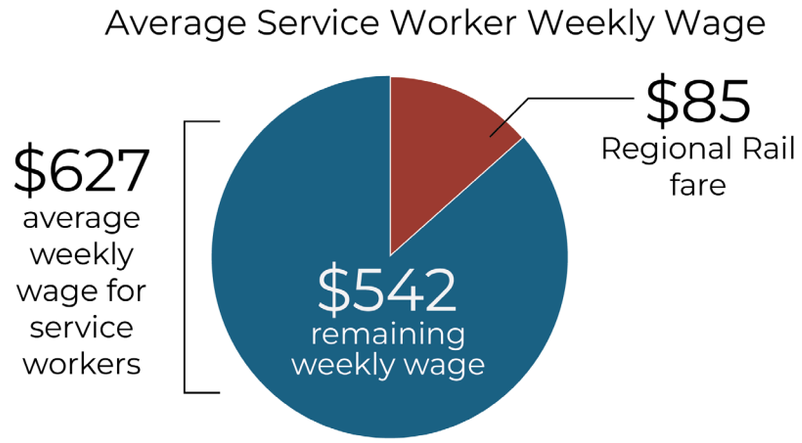
Furthermore, public transportation costs to and from Manayunk are substantial. For example, traveling from CC (Center City) to Zone 2 (Manayunk) on Regional Rail costs between $6.50-$8.50 per one-way trip, amassing to a total of $65-$85 per week for a standard five-day work week. As a result, transportation expenses alone can consume an estimated 10-13% of service workers' take-home earnings.

CASE STUDY: ORCA LIFT

In 2015, ORCA LIFT, a public transit fare reduction for qualifying low-income residents aged 19-64, was implemented in Washington's Puget Sound region.

The program offered $1.50 rides for residents below 200% of the federal poverty level. In October 2020, King County expanded the program to provide a fully subsidized annual pass for those at or below 80% of the federal poverty level.[107] As of 2022, ORCA LIFT had 42,000 active cardholders and has facilitated 3 million annual rides. Research showed that riders receiving fully subsidized fares:
1.) used public transit more than those with a partial subsidy,
2.) did not overcrowd the transit system at peak times, and
3.) used the transit system more often than they had prior to receiving the subsidy.[108]

Source: Sound Transit[109]



Data source: U.S. Census Bureau Longitudinal Employer-Household Dynamics (LEHD) Origin-Destination Employment Statistics (LODES): Workplace Area Characteristics[110]

Though Philadelphia's Zero Fare pilot program provides free transit to those earning below 150% of the federal poverty level, many service workers in Manayunk fall just above this cut-off and remain burdened by transportation costs.

Objectives:

- Increase service worker satisfaction to higher than pre-subsidy threshold.
- Increase service worker retention rate.
- Decrease service worker car ridership to work.
- Increase public transit ridership to work.

Actions:

- Launch pilot program. The program will allow eligible service workers to receive a pre-loaded SEPTA Key card with $75/month. One hundred Main Street food service workers who spend more than 20% of their income on public transit or parking are invited to participate.
- Implement the pilot for three months and administer pre- and post-pilot survey evaluating worker satisfaction, commuting behavior, and employee retention.
- Expand and/or alter pilot program based on achieved metrics.
- Partner with SEPTA to provide partial subsidies for service workers along Manayunk in conjunction with the Zero Fare program over the coming years.

$22,500
SEPTA key card costs for 3-month pilot

$1,500
Outreach, recruitment, and engagement exercises

$5,000
Administrative costs for pilot oversight

Goals Met

Cost
$ $

Partners
- SEPTA
- Manayunk Development Corporation

Funding
- SEPTA
- Manayunk Development Corporation

Time | Medium Term
2-5 Years

7 Create a Bilateral Committee of RDC and MDC Members

PROGRAM

While the Manayunk Development Corporation supports the thriving Main Street corridor, the Roxborough Development Corporation (RDC) could greatly benefit from the resources and network provided by the MDC to further strengthen Ridge Avenue. Additionally, promoting MDC initiatives to businesses along Ridge Avenue would bolster additional revenue to the MDC and aid in overall connectivity across Manayunk businesses.

The MDC currently has an Associate Membership program designed for local businesses and property owners located outside of their boundaries who want to participate in the their event programming and marketing opportunities.[111] Membership costs $360 per year for businesses and provides opportunities for owners to promote their business in marketing and communications, participate in district events, receive updates on relevant citywide policies and grant funding opportunities, and make connections with local partners.

In addition, the MDC provides an Incubator Space for prospective business-owners looking for a commercial space to build momentum for longer-term business ventures. Located on 106 Grape Street, the Incubator Space is ideal for prospective business-owners, providing short-term leases and mentorship opportunities.[112]

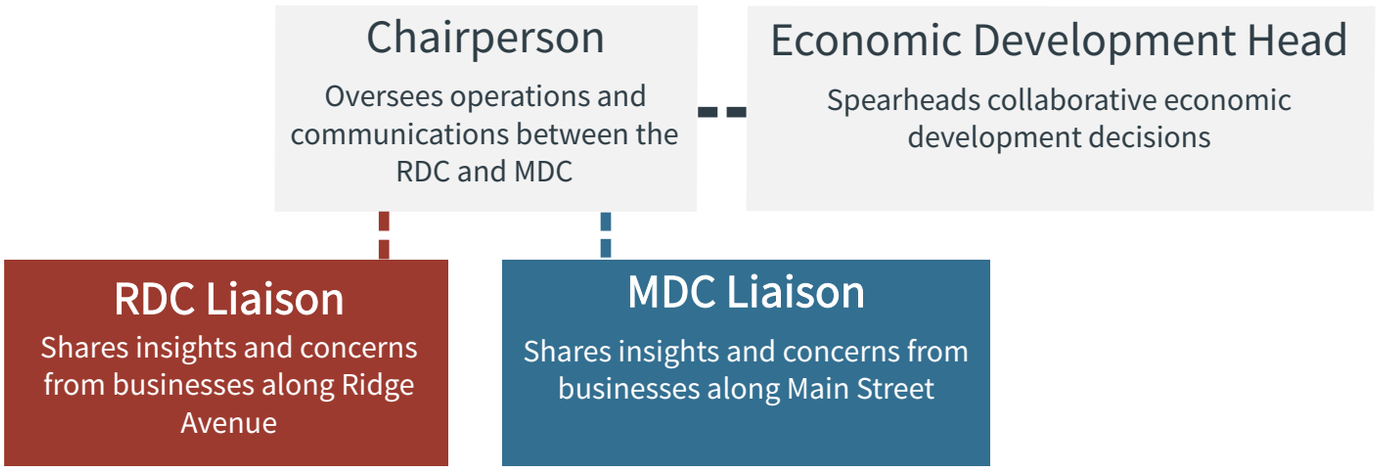
Thus, the proposed bilateral committee would exist to mutually benefit both the RDC and MDC by:

1.) Expanding current MDC initiatives to include businesses along Ridge Avenue.

2.) Promoting communication of opportunities to business-owners on both Main Street and Ridge Avenue.

3.) Providing guidance for the RDC to adopt successful practices along Main Street.

Proposed Organizational Structure



Objectives:

- Increase MDC Associate Membership by the end of the first year of implementation.
- Decrease the vacancy rate for the MDC Incubator Space.
- Increase RDC- and MDC-affiliated businesses' satisfaction with economic development efforts in their respective corridors.

Actions:

The bilateral committee will consist of four members (Chairperson, MDC Liaison, RDC Liaison, Economic Development Head). The members will split these responsibilities:

- The MDC will conduct a formal retail demand and gap analysis for the Main Street corridor, expanding on the RDC's initial analysis.
- The findings are compiled into a shared, publicly accessible resource to better inform prospective business owners of where demand for their goods and services are the highest.
- Coordinate marketing efforts to ensure business owners in both corridors are aware of available resources, including event programming, promotional platforms, and funding opportunities.
- Enhance the Associate Membership Program through inclusion of Incubator Access.
- Host regular monthly meetings between MDC and RDC leadership to share relevant programming updates and strategies, open to both MDC- and RDC-affiliated businesses.

$1,500
Regular meetings and staff coordination

$15,000
Consultant-led demand analysis

$5,000
Additional staff time

Goals Met

Time | Short Term

● ○ ○ ○ 0-2 Years

Cost

$ $

Partners

- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Roxborough Development Corporation

Funding

- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Roxborough Development Corporation

8 Update Zoning to Protect Residents and Business Owners from Flood Risk

POLICY

In Manayunk, flooding is not only an environmental issue, but a problem that affects the economic stability of the Main Street, Venice Island, and the transportation corridor, as these are all within the floodplain.

The scale of Hurricane Ida in 2021 caused long-lasting impact in Manayunk. Under the existing City of Philadelphia zoning standards, several developments in the flood zone have still received approval through the zoning variance process.[113] The continuing risk to these projects in the floodplain point to the need for clearer, resilience-oriented standards for buildings in these areas.

Objectives:

- Require specific standards for development in the floodplain to protect businesses along Main Street.
- Reduce future flood damages to properties within the floodplain.

Goals Met

Partners

- Department of Planning and Development
- Philadelphia City Planning Commission
- City Council
- Manayunk Neighborhood Council
- Manayunk Development Corporation

Funding

- Department of Planning and Development
- Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities (BRIC) Program
- PA Emergency Management Agency

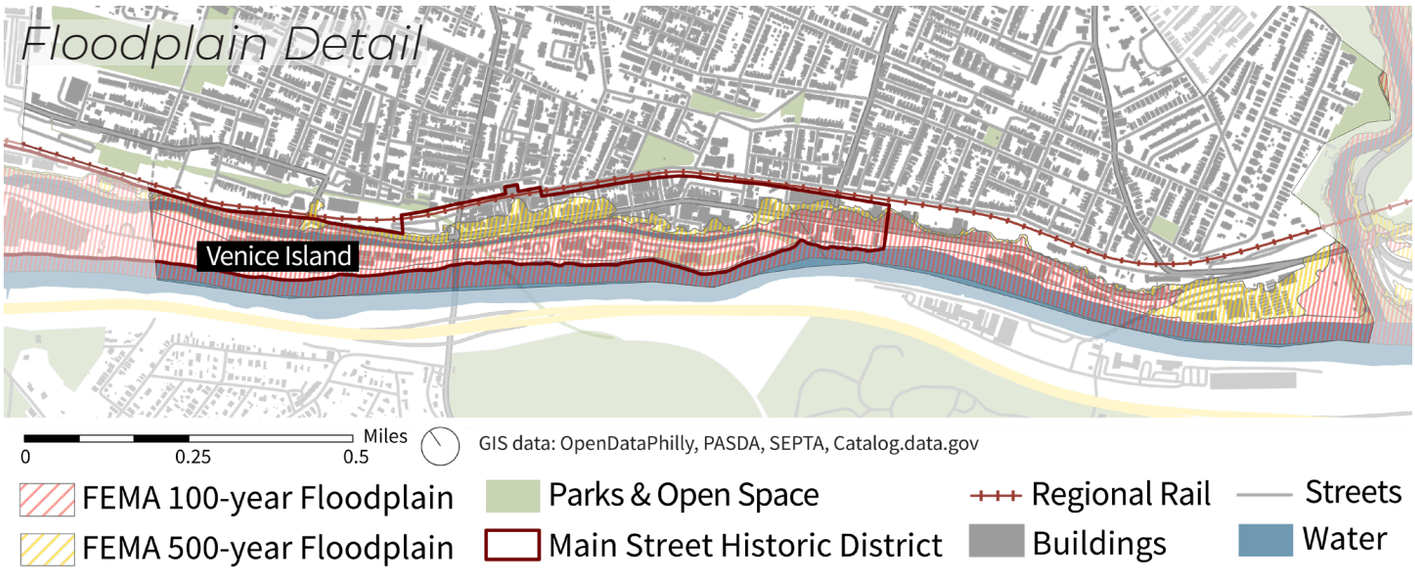
Cost

$ $

Time | Short Term

●● ○○ 2-5 Years

Floodplain Detail



Actions:

- Work with Philadelphia Department of Planning and Development staff to draft a Main Street and Venice Island Flood Resilience Overlay zoning ordinance and map.
- Work with Philadelphia Licensing & Inspections to review feasibility and impacts of the ordinance to the current permitting process.
- Hold required community meetings and public hearings to present the draft map and ordinance and receive community input.
- Hold a business community meeting hosted by MDC, so owners and tenants are notified of the changes.
- Update the map and ordinance text based on comments.
- Prepare FAQ and a summary memo about the proposal.
- Work with the District 4 Council Member to introduce the ordinance and follow the Planning Commission review and public hearings process.
- If approved by the Planning Commission, take the proposal to the City Council for full adoption.

CASE STUDY: New York City's Zoning for Coastal Flood Resiliency

Source: FEMA[115]

In 2012, following Hurricane Sandy, many buildings in NYC could not practically meet flood-resistant construction requirements due to zoning rules preventing flood-resilient design. For example, elevating the first floor to mitigate flooding effects is in opposition with height restrictions and building envelope regulations.

By 2013, New York City adopted the Flood Resilience Zoning Text Amendment (2013) which used the updated FEMA flood level to measure building height. This allowed height to be measured from the design flood elevation (DFE) rather than from the ground or grade and placed mechanical systems above flood level.

For example:

Max zoning height = 45 ft (measured from grade).

DFE = 6 ft above grade (Base Flood Elevation + 1 ft freeboard).

Max zoning height under Flood Resilience Zoning: 6 ft + 45 ft

In 2021, NYC passed the Zoning for Coastal Flood Resiliency (ZCFR) ordinance, which jointly includes the 1% annual-chance (100-year) and 0.2% annual-chance (500-year) in the flood zones. Hurricane Sandy inundated areas beyond the 1% annual-chance flood zone and flooded approximately half of the plots in the 0.2% annual-chance flood zone, indicating that the 0.2% annual-chance flood zone is also currently in danger and will remain in danger in the future.[114]

9 Update Building Standards for Flood Prevention

POLICY

Following the flooding from Hurricane Ida in 2021, many businesses experienced extensive damages. In addition to the high costs for rehabilitating damage, many businesses had to close for an extended period of time to perform repairs.[116] In addition to the cost to make repairs, this resulted in lost revenue. Businesses were thus doubly impacted, from the financial costs for repairs and the financial losses of termporary closure. Adjustments to current building standards can help business owners to reopen more quickly after a major disaster. Gradually upgrading the existing buildings in the flood resilience overlay zone will pace updates which would be unaffordable if completed all-at-once, while reducing future flood damage.

Objectives:

- Reduce financial damages to local businesses from floods.
- Reduce the duration of business closures (to make repairs) following major floods.
- Promote flood-resilient building upgrades during major renovations, extensive maintenance after floods, changes in use, or major building system replacements.

Actions:

- Survey businesses and property owners about damages sustained during major floods, such as Hurricane Ida in 2021. The survey results can help inform the development of the building standards to address areas of concern.
- Work with Philadelphia Department of Planning and Development staff to draft a flood-resilient building standards ordinance. As part of this process, research comparable ordinances in other

Goals Met

Partners

- Department of Planning and Development
- Philadelphia City Planning Commission
- Philadelphia Department of Licenses & Inspections (L&I)
- Philadelphia City Council
- Property & Business Owners

Funding

- FEMA: Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities (BRIC) program
- City operating budgets
- Flood Mitigation Assistance
- U.S. Small Business Administration Disaster Loans and mitigation add-ons
- Philadelphia Commerce programs
- PHDC repair programs
- Storefront Improvement Program

Cost

$ $

Time | Short Term

● ● ○ ○ 2-5 Years

locations and speak with other municipal staff to better understand the impacts of the ordinance and best practices.

- Work with Philadelphia Licensing & Inspections to review feasibility and impacts of the ordinance to the current permitting process.
- Hold required community meetings and public hearings to obtain community input, particularly from business owners on Main Street and Venice Island.
- Update the ordinance text based on comments and feedback received during the community engagement phase.
- Prepare FAQ and a summary memo about the proposal.
- Work with the District 4 Council Member to introduce the ordinance and follow the Planning Commission review and public hearings process.
- If approved by the Planning Commission, take the proposal to the City Council for full adoption.
- Connect local business owners and property owners with financial resources to make upgrades to existing structures to protect against future flood damage.

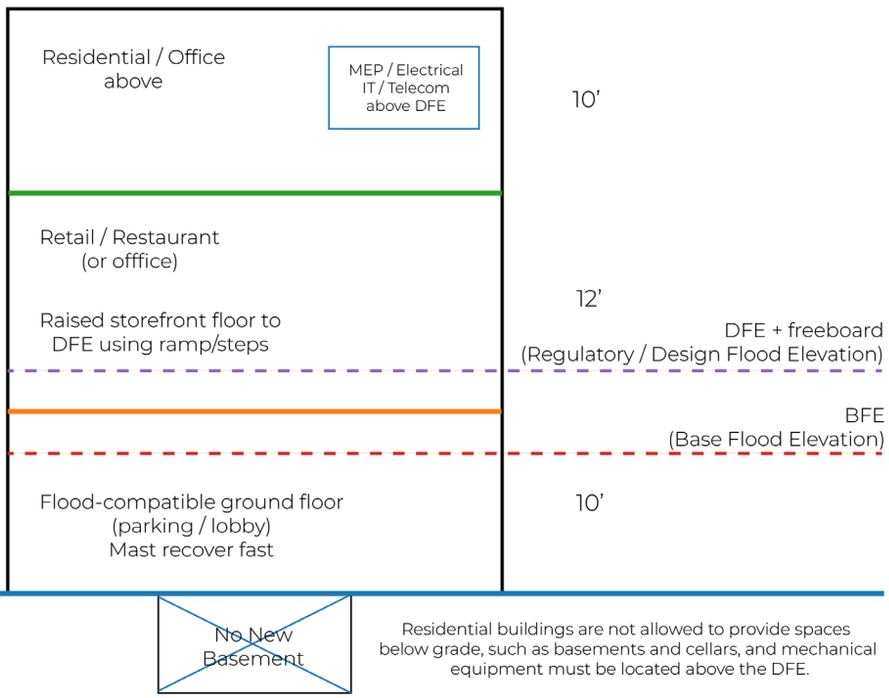
Source: FEMA[117]

EXAMPLE STANDARDS

- *Elevate critical systems (electrical, HVAC, IT, etc.) above the flood level*
- *Install backflow prevention devices.*
- *Use water-resistant materials on the ground floor, such as concrete floors and removable fixtures.*
- *Construct occupiable space at higher levels*

Example of Current Mixed-Use Building:

Example of Mixed-Use Buildings with New Building Standards:



10 Pedestrian-Friendly Street Design Along Ridge Avenue

PROGRAM

Ridge Avenue functions as a high-volume, high-speed barrier that separates areas of the neighborhood. This auto-oriented feel discourages casual spending; this barrier street condition has a significant impact on the economy as people pass quickly along Ridge Avenue, spending less time on the street. This causes businesses to rely more on visibility and parking availability rather than foot traffic.[118]

Creating an environment for pedestrian foot traffic promotes through-traffic into local consumption, making Ridge Avenue a place where people are willing to stop, rest, and stay, thereby enhancing the stability of the street outside of the peak weekend hours.

The City of Philadelphia has an existing permitting and licensing process for sidewalk cafés and streeteries (from "street eatery"). A sidewalk café is contained entirely within the sidewalk public realm, whereas a streetery extends into the street, typically into a parking lane. The application process is similar for both types, although there are additional steps to obtain permission to utilize the street for a streetery.[119,120]

$500-1k
Direct business costs (furniture, planters, etc.)

$227
Sidewalk Café License fee

$1,750
Streetery License fee

EXAMPLE SITE: A sidewalk café at 6155 Ridge Avenue

EXAMPLE SITE: A streetery at 6156 Ridge Avenue

Actions:

- Collaborate with Roxborough Development Corporation to conduct community outreach to businesses on Ridge Avenue and to identify businesses to participate in the program.
- Conduct a survey of sidewalk widths, existing street furniture, and other space constraints to keep 5 feet clear for accessible pedestrian use.
- Document proposed sidewalk installation with photos, renderings, and plan drawings. Ensure that the proposal complies with public space requirements, applicable zoning codes, and permitting requirements.
- Complete the pre-requisite approval application for the Streets Department. If the proposal includes a structure, the Art Commission must also review the Streets Department application.
- Submit plan and photos as required by the sidewalk café or streetery licensing process using the City's eCLIPSE licensing portal.
- Install movable tables, chairs, and planters, and mark the clear path.
- Run the program for a season, tracking the seats filled by hour, sales, and foot traffic, and take note of any sidewalk conflicts.
- Evaluate program success and impact, including shifts in customer base or sales by local businesses and continue implementing the program.

Goals Met

Partners

- Property owners (vacant storefront)
- Restaurant operator (new tenant) or existing restaurant owner
- Philadelphia Streets Department
- Philadelphia L&I
- Roxborough Development Corporation

Funding

- City of Philadelphia Neighborhood Economic Development Grant
- Philadelphia Department of Commerce
- Private Capital and small business loans

Cost

$

Time | Short Term

● ○ ○ ○ 0-2 Years

11 Expand Green Stormwater Infrastructure

PROJECT

Green stormwater infrastructure (GSI) is an adaptive solution to stormwater management in cities, using vegetation and planted areas, along with engineered components, to proactively manage stormwater on-site and reduce runoff on impervious surfaces. Philadelphia's GSI program primarily focuses on areas in the Combined Sewer Overflow catchment, which excludes Manayunk as it is on a separated system (or MS4). Expanding GSI in Manayunk would improve local drainage and water flow, reducing the cumulative effect of flooding in the area.

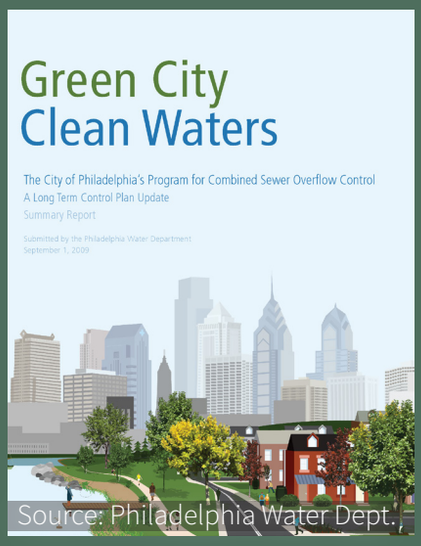
Objectives:

- Introduce more vegetation to Main Street such as street trees and planters.
- Increase use of green stormwater infrastructure as other infrastructure updates are made in Manayunk.
- Reduce impervious surfaces in Manayunk.
- Promote additional green stormwater infrastructure in higher elevation areas of the neighborhood to reduce stormwater runoff flowing to Main Street and lower-elevation areas.

Actions:

- Identify community partners or community members willing to collaborate on green infrastructure, including the Philadelphia Water Department, Manayunk Development Corporation, Philadelphia Parks and Recreation, community organizations, or business partners.
- Advertise the existing Rain Check rebate program to Manayunk homeowners via demonstration installations, at community events, and through local civic associations.[122]
- Create and distribute a survey to residents and businesses to identify any areas of concern during rainstorms that could benefit from better drainage design or conditions.
- Conduct a site survey of Main Street, Green Avenue, Manayunk Avenue, and Ridge Avenue to identify areas for green infrastructure improvements. Begin with these major streets and continue to identify future corridors for improvements.
- For GSI solutions on public property, coordinate with the Streets department on areas where

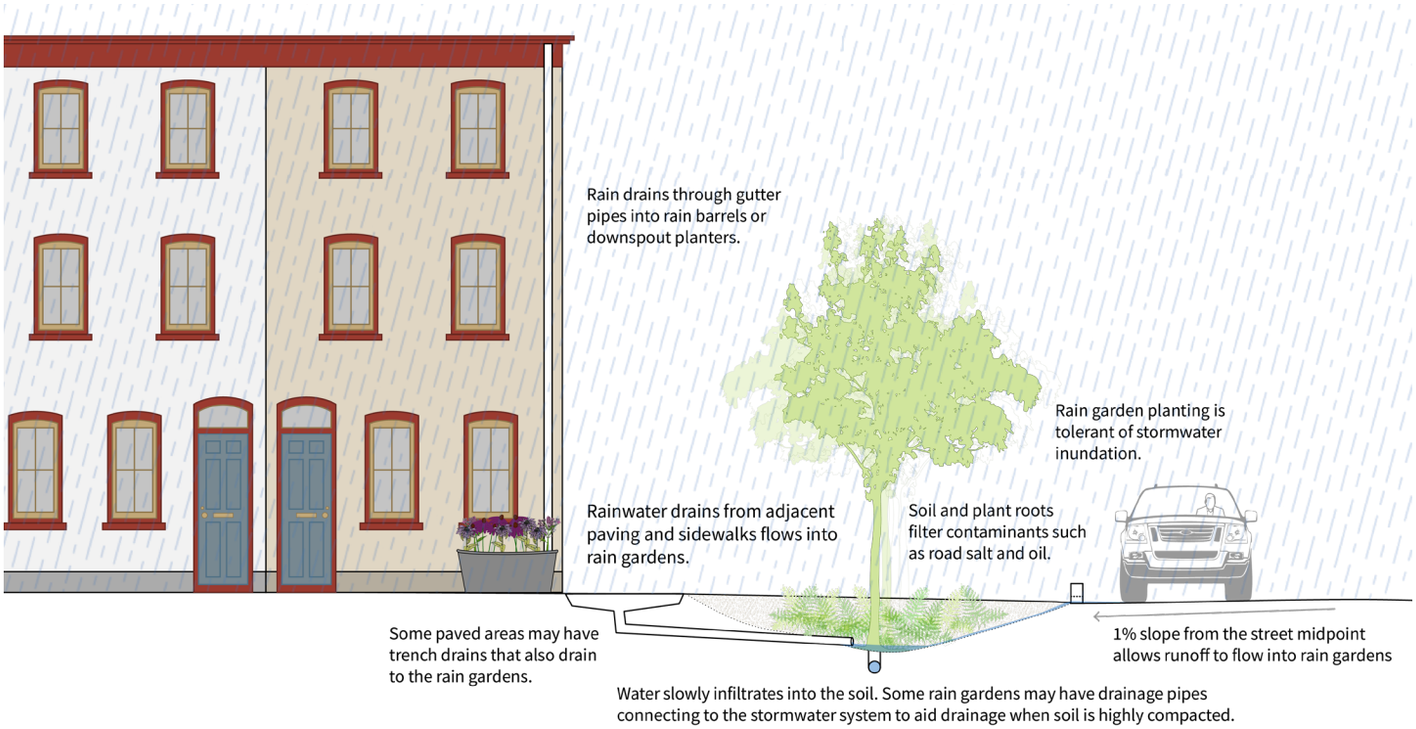
EXISTING PLANS



Source: Philadelphia Water Dept.

Green City Clean Waters

Citywide plan and strategies for implementing green stormwater infrastructure[121]



upgrades could accomplish multiple goals. For example, areas identified for rain gardens could be designed within curb extensions that will also create better pedestrian conditions.

- Create a ranking system to prioritize projects based on cost, location, and potential impact.
- Begin implementing new green stormwater infrastructure projects based on this prioritization list.
- Advocate for the Philadelphia Water Department's Greened Acre Retrofit Program to be expanded to include areas of the city with high pluvial and fluvial flood risk.[123]

$0
Rain Check participant's cost for a rain barrel

$100
Rain Check participant's cost for downspout planter & plants

$22
cost per sq. ft. that Rain Check will reimburse (up to $2500) for a rain garden

Goals Met

Cost

$ $

Partners

- Philadelphia Water Department
- Manayunk Development Corporation

Time | Short Term

● ○ ○ ○ 0-2 Years

Funding

- Rain Check grants
- Community Resilience and Environmental Justice Fund
- Schuylkill River Restoration Fund
- Greened Acre Retrofit Program

12 Improve Trail Amenities and Connections from Main Street to the Manayunk Towpath

PROJECT

The Manayunk Towpath is well-utilized and provides great recreation opportunities for walkers, cyclists, and joggers. Some existing access points are not ADA accessible, while other entrances have low visibility of the trail, creating safety hazards. Investment in improving trail conditions and amenities along the Towpath, such as paving materials, seating, more public art, bicycle repair stations, and planting design will improve the trail experience.

Objectives

- Ensure trail design has a standardized character throughout the trail corridor.
- Complete updates and maintenance of the trail to protect against damage from future flooding.
- Improve safety conditions of the trail for pedestrians, cyclists, runners, and other modes .
- Obtain funding from state programs to support trail development and improvements.
- Increase visibility and access points to the Towpath from Main Street.
- Improve visibility of pedestrians and cyclists at trail crossings across roadways.

Actions:

- Survey existing trail conditions and access points, including seating, public art, visibility, paving material, state of repair, ADA accessibility (or lack of), and other conditions.
- Conduct community engagement efforts in Manayunk and of trail users to identify the most heavily utilized segments, areas needing attention, desired amenities, and mode share among trail users.
- Identify areas of public ownership or with existing public access easements to identify potential sites to create new access points.
- Advocate for future expansion of the Schuylkill Banks project area to include Manayunk and areas of Philadelphia north of Fairmount Dam, to expand institutional partners, funding sources, and grant opportunities in the future.
- Prioritize amenities that can be easily purchased and installed to improve trail conditions immediately.
- Work with local artists to implement more public

Towpath access as seen from Cotton Street (left) and Rector Street (right). The access points could benefit from better marking or signage, both along Main Street, as well as on these streets leading to the Towpath.

Current access points to the Manayunk Towpath from Main Street. Many access points have stairs, which creates barriers for cyclists, people with strollers, or disabled trail users.

art projects along the Towpath.
- Work with the Manayunk Development Corporation, Philadelphia Parks & Recreation, and other agencies to obtain necessary permits for making additional access points.
- Provide support of the RFP process to receive design alternatives for major access upgrades.
- Design trail connections, signage, and updated trail flow, ensuring compliance with Circuit Trail standards and Schuylkill River Trail standards.

Goals Met

Cost

$$~$$$

Partners

- Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy
- Schuylkill River Greenway National Heritage Area
- Philadelphia Parks & Recreation

Time | Medium term

3-5 years

Funding

- Heritage Partnership Program Funding
- Department of Conservation and Natural Resources Trail Grants
- Circuit Trails Community Grant
- DVRPC Regional Trails Program
- Regional Trail Workshop Grants
- PA Water Trails Mini-Grant

13 Utilize Existing Parks System to Improve Resilience

PROJECT

Manayunk has many parks and open space areas, ranging from small pocket parks to large natural, undeveloped areas. The connectivity of the parks in Manayunk could be improved to create a sense of cohesion in the park system and to improve the local tree canopy, reduce urban heat, contribute to onsite management of stormwater, connect the existing trail system, improve walkability, and improve the neighborhood atmosphere.

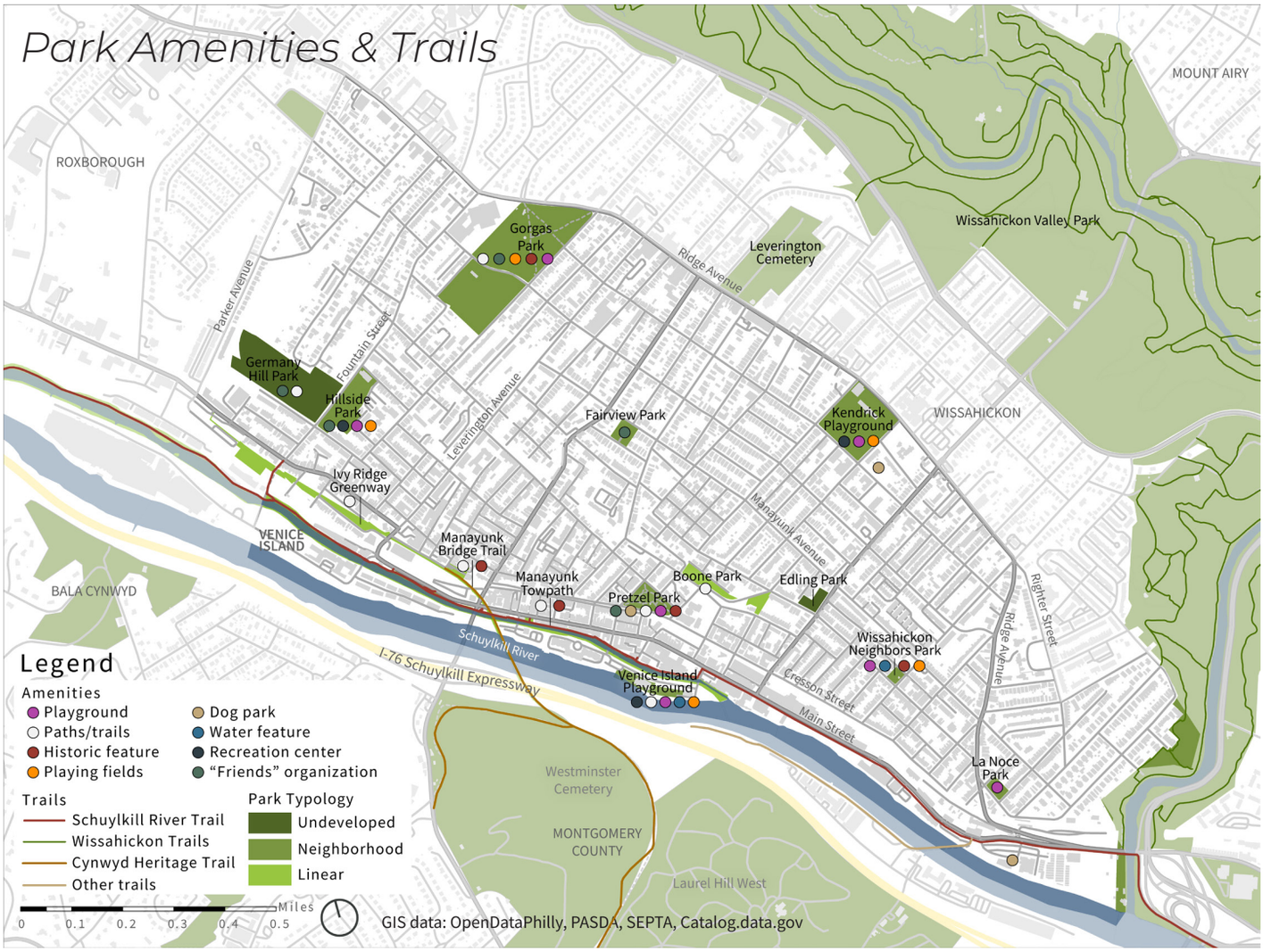
Objectives:

- Create stronger connections between existing park sites, trails, and other recreation amenities in Manayunk.
- Coordinate investment of time, funds, and volunteer work into parks that will best support recreation opportunities in the neighborhood.
- Use existing parks and recreation assets to improve outcomes of urban flooding and urban heat.

Actions:

- Evaluate existing parks and recreation assets for flood resilience of current parks and facilities within the floodplain (qualities such as planting species, impervious surface, paving materials, etc.). Identify existing tree canopy, lawn areas, naturalized vegetation, and park amenities.
- Conduct community engagement efforts in Manayunk to identify the most heavily utilized park sites, areas of deficient park access, and other community feedback regarding the local parks and trails.
- Collaborate with the Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy to identify priorities regarding local parks, maintenance and improvement needs, and community partners.
- Evaluate feedback received from community members, Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy, and other organizations to identify priority parks or areas.
- Conduct site surveys of parks to evaluate opportunities for tree planting, revegetation, improvement of drainage issues, better pedestrian infrastructure, and suitability for green stormwater infrastructure improvements.
- Identify major gaps in trail system and connections between parks. This could include signage for cyclists and pedestrians, preferred bicycle routes between major parks and trails, and ADA accessibility.
- Facilitate collaboration between Philadelphia Parks and Recreation, Philadelphia Water Department, Philadelphia Streets Department, Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy, Fairmount

Tree planting on a hillside slope at Gorgas Park.



Park Conservancy, and other local parks organizations.

- Apply for grant funds to augment funds directed by the Fairmount Park Conservancy and Philadelphia Parks and Recreation.
- Organize park service project days in collaboration with the Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy and "Friends of" parks organizations to clean up and beautify park amenities on an annual basis after installation.

Goals Met

Cost

$$~$$$

Partners

- Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy
- Philadelphia Parks & Recreation
- Local "Friends of" Park groups

Time | Short Term

3-5 Years

Funding

- Department of Conservation and Natural Resources Community Conservation Partnerships Program Park Rehabilitation and Development
- Recreation and Conservation Planning Grants

14 Create New Water Access to the Schuylkill River & Manayunk Canal

PROJECT

The Schuylkill River Greenways National Heritage Area is part of the National Park Service and recognizes the historic heritage of the Schuylkill River along its entire length. Schuylkill River Greenways has promoted the development of a Water Trail, with information for kayaking and canoeing along the Schuylkill River. Venice Island is included in the existing plans for river access and designing a kayak launch or similar water access point would allow Manayunk residents and visitors to experience the river and canal up close.

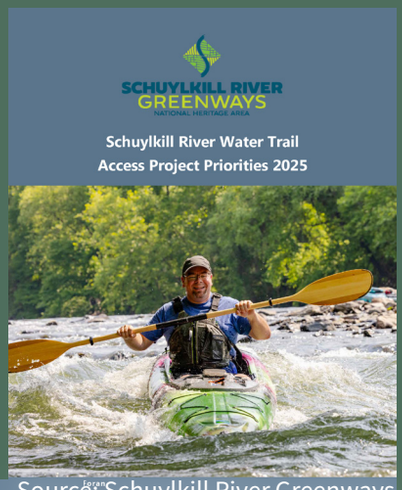
Objectives:

- Create water access points to allow for non-motorized boat use.
- Increase water trail users in Philadelphia by creating Manayunk Canal boating access points.
- Increase funding being spent locally from the Schuylkill River National Heritage Area funding programs.
- Improve portage experience for boaters navigating around Flat Rock Dam.

Actions:

- Conduct community engagement to determine level of community interest in a permanent boat launch, seasonal boat launch, kayak/canoe education programs, or other water-related amenities.
- Connect with local businesses and organizations such as Hidden River Outfitters, Schuylkill River Greenways, and the Philadelphia Canoe Club to explore the potential for expanding kayak or canoe rentals, lessons, education programs, and activities at a new location in Manayunk.
- Establish rating criteria such as amount of space needed, location on trail, population of Manayunk within a certain distance, etc.
- Identify potential sites for water access points and score according to rating criteria. Some sites may be suitable for developing water access in the short-term, while others may require substantially more investment to create this access.
- Develop required and optional safety measures to promote safe water access/use (such as buoys noting where the Canal connects into the river,

EXISTING PLANS



Source: Schuylkill River Greenways

Schuylkill River Water Trail Access Project Priorities 2025

This plan identifies gaps for desired investment in waterfront access.[124]

CASE STUDY: Brooklyn Bridge Park

The design of Brooklyn Bridge Park includes a variety of programming, including new sites for park visitors to engage with the waterfront and the East River. The redesigned kayak launch includes a sheltered area where kayakers can paddle. In the summer, NYC Parks operates free kayaking days, which remains a popular attraction among the park's many offerings.[125]

signage or requiring use of personal flotation devices, etc.).
- Establish rules or regulations needed to promote safe water use, such as certain times of year or water speeds when Canal access points may be closed.
- Obtain easements, land purchases, or other necessary permissions for creating water access point.
- Identify the community partner or City agency that will manage the access point(s).

Goals Met

Cost

$$$~$$$$

Partners

- Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy
- Schuylkill River Greenway National Heritage Area
- Philadelphia Parks & Recreation

Time | Long Term

● ● ● ○ 8-10 Years

Funding

- Heritage Partnership Program Funding
- Department of Conservation and Natural Resources Trail Grants
- Circuit Trails Community Grant
- DVRPC Regional Trails Program
- Regional Trail Workshop Grants
- PA Water Trails Mini-Grant

15 Build a Resilience Park

PROJECT

Much of the Manayunk Main Street area is in the floodplain, as well as nearly all of Venice Island. This presents serious hazards during flooding, such as in 2021 when Hurricane Ida inundated the area. Undeveloped land in the floodplain and near the floodway presents an opportunity to construct a resilience park, which would prevent housing construction in an area of high risk. This would also create a community amenity that contributes to stormwater management.

Objectives:

- Utilize vacant waterfront property to create a community amenity.
- Build responsibly on the waterfront to reduce flood hazards to community members.
- Design a floodable park that can accommodate high water levels during major storms and riverine flooding.
- Discourage further development of new housing in the floodplain and floodway, especially on Venice Island.

Actions:

- Conduct a survey of vacant properties on or adjacent to the waterfront area.
- Establish criteria for a scoring/rating system to evaluate potential park sites and site feasibility for this project. Criteria may include items such as proximity to high-traffic areas, parcel size, location within the floodplain or floodway, and suitability for park development.
- Begin community engagement to assess community support for the project and receive feedback about this concept, potential sites, and the types of amenities desired by the community.
- Engage organizations such as Manayunk Development Corporation, Philadelphia Parks & Recreation, National Park Service, Schuylkill River National Heritage Area, and more, in discussions about a new resilience park to identify collaborators, funding sources, and partners for site acquisition.
- Identify potential funding sources, including Philadelphia Parks and Recreation budget, state parks and recreation grants, federal recreation grants (for example through the National Park

Potential site #1: 4000 Main Street

Potential site #2: North Venice Island

CASE STUDY: Hoboken's ResilienCity Park

Source: Reena Rose Sibayan for The Jersey Journal

The ResilienCity Park opened in Hoboken, New Jersey in 2023, designed by OLIN. The $78 million park was built on a former industrial site and can accommodate 2 million gallons of stormwater in underground tanks. The park received some of its funding through FEMA's BRIC (Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities) program.[128]

Service National Heritage Area Program Funds), corporate donors, and private donors.
- Identify the agency or entity that will lead the project and provide support of RFP process to begin the design process.
- Conduct environmental assessments.
- Advocate with Philadelphia's federal elected officials for FEMA's Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities (BRIC) program[127] to be funded again, which could be an important funding source for this type of project.
- Complete project design and construction.

Goals Met

Cost

$ $ $ $ $

Partners

- Philadelphia Parks & Recreation
- Manayunk Development Corporation
- Roxborough Manayunk Conservancy

Time | Long Term

15-20 Years

Funding

- William Penn Foundation
- Heritage Partnership Program Funding
- Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities

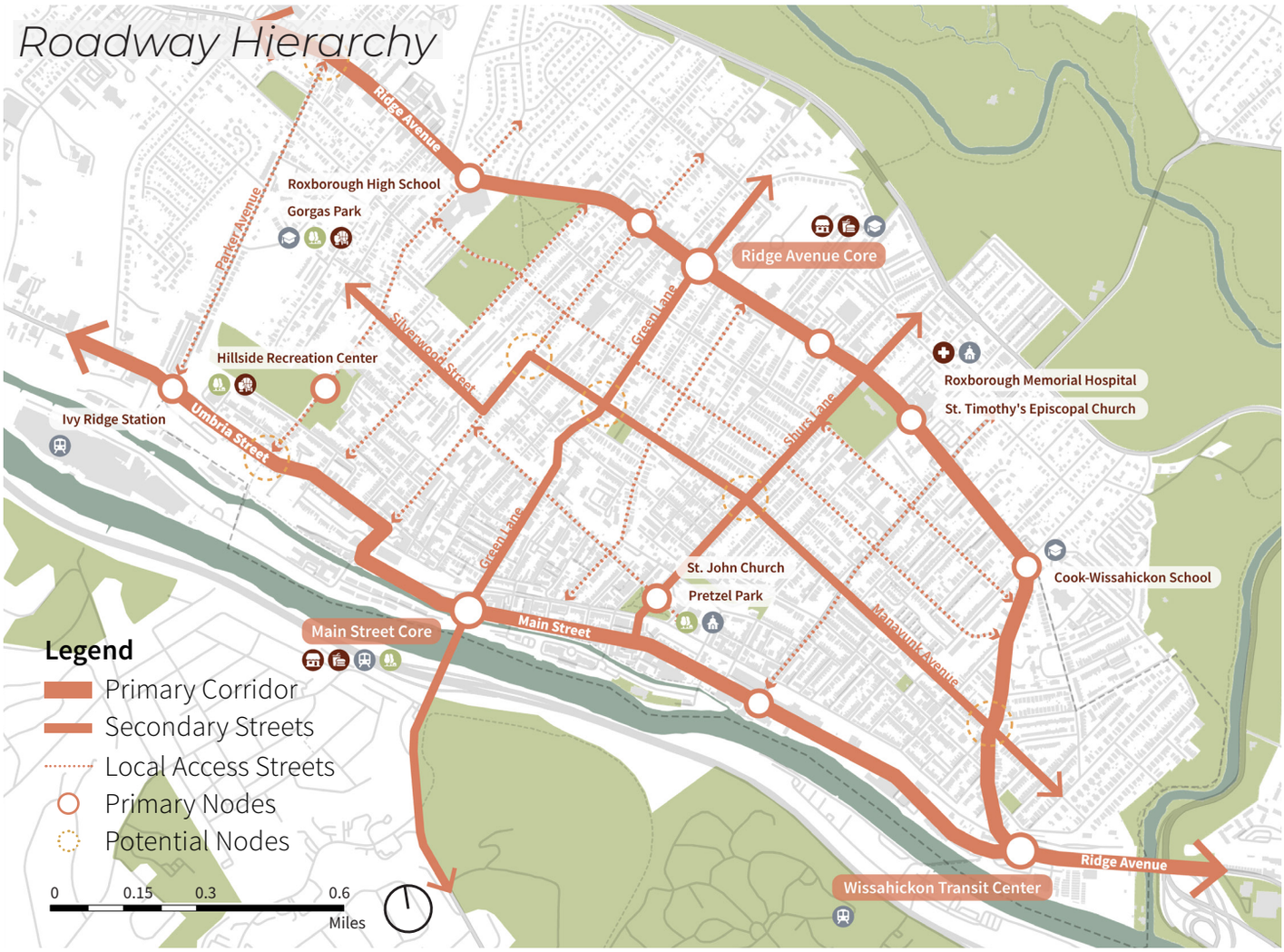
16 Reorganize Street Space

PROJECT

Much of the traffic congestion in Manayunk occurs because a limited number of routes also have limited travel lanes. Key road segments can be reorganized to better utilize the space and prioritize multiple modes of travel, while preserving street parking in key areas. Clarifying the street type hierarchy in Manayunk will strengthen links between residential areas and daily destinations and create a clearer and more connected circulation system across the neighborhood.

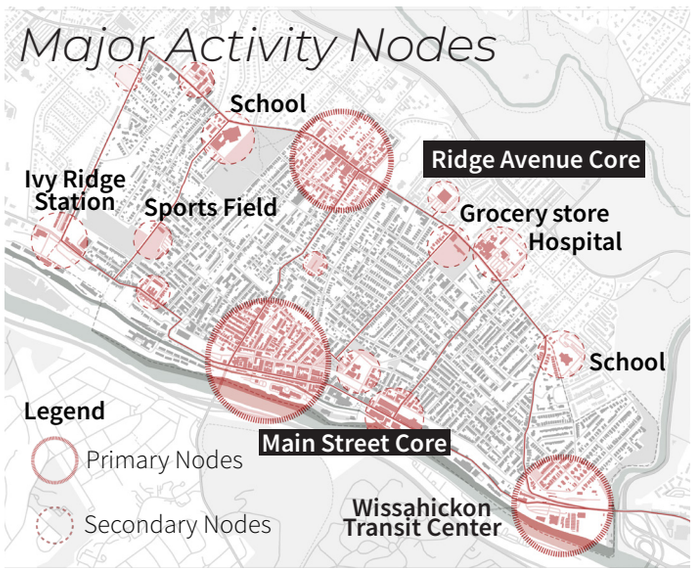
Objectives:

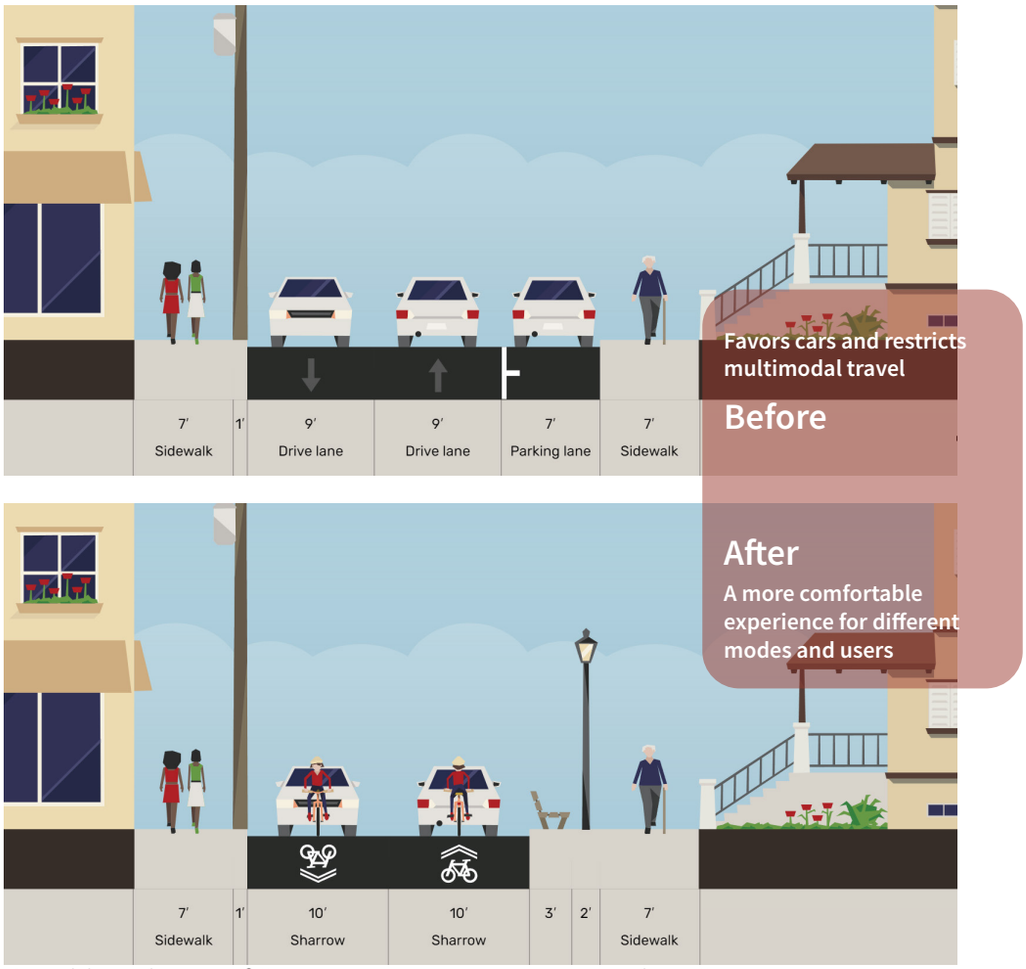
- Rebalance street space to better serve pedestrians, transit users, cyclists, and drivers.
- Reduce conflicts between vehicles and pedestrians in high-activity commercial areas.
- Improve safety, comfort, and visibility at crossings, intersections, and curbside areas.
- Identify priority corridors for future street improvements.



Actions:

- Map Manayunk's major activity nodes, including Main Street Core, Ridge Avenue Core, Wissahickon Transit Center, schools, parks, churches, recreation centers, and neighborhood destinations.
- Analyze existing transit routes to identify where bus service is strongest, especially along Main Street, Ridge Avenue, and Manayunk Avenue.
- Compare activity nodes and transit routes to show that Manayunk's current movement pattern is mainly organized in the east-west direction.
- Identify where direct north-south connections between Main Street and Ridge Avenue are limited, especially for hillside residential areas.
- Evaluate which streets have the greatest potential to connect residential blocks, daily destinations, transit stops, and community facilities.
- Use these corridors as the planning foundation for later improvements, including street hierarchy designation, signage, shared-road markings, pedestrian safety upgrades, and traffic calming.





Possible redesign of Green Lane; street sections made in Streetmix

Goals Met

Partners

- OTIS
- PCPC
- Streets Department

Funding

- DVRPC TCDI program
- City Capital program
- PA DCED Multimodal Transportation Fund

Cost

$ $

Time | Medium Term

2-5 Years

17 Improve High-Risk Intersections and Steep Street Segments

PROJECT

Many Manayunk streets prioritize car travel at the cost of pedestrian experience. Simple adjustments to the geometry of dangerous intersections, pedestrian crossings, and traffic flow can improve safety, as well as the experience for all types of street users. Deploying low-cost and quick-build safety measures is an effective way to test improvements before investing in permanent changes. These easily implementable wins for improving high risk intersections and steep street segments.

Objectives:

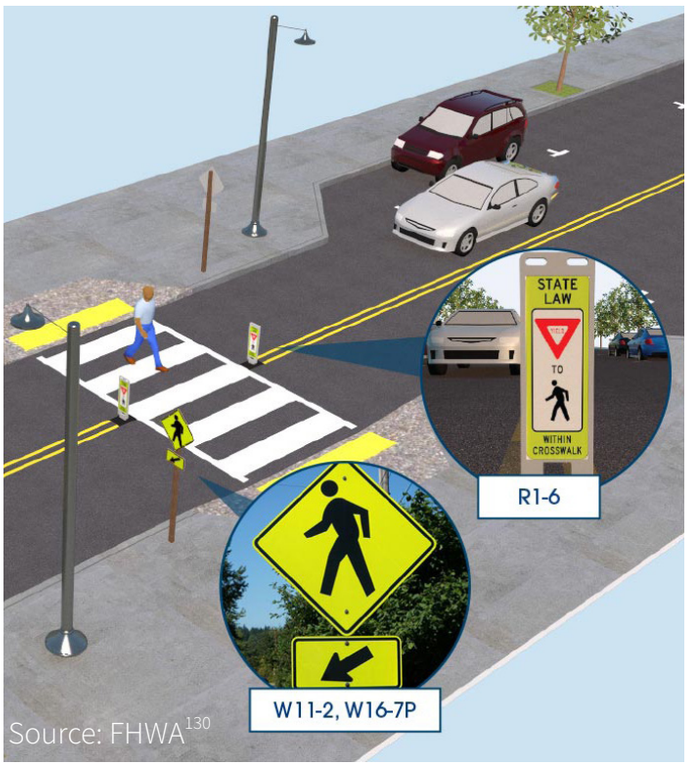
- Implement safety measures efficiently.
- Prioritize low-cost interventions to build momentum and test solutions before long-term investment.
- Introduce crosswalk visibility enhancements to make crossings easier for drivers to see and easier for pedestrians to use.
- Create easier to navigate, safer to cross, and more comfortable street design for everyday use.

Actions:

- Begin with low-cost changes, such as repainting lane lines and no-parking zones to clarify vehicle paths.
- Add flex posts, bollards, planters, and or temporary curbs to create bump-outs.
- Tighten turns and remove corner parking at select intersections to improve sightlines.
- Upgrade crosswalk markings to significantly improve the pedestrian and vehicle experience.
- Continue street improvements by implementing higher-cost changes, such as clearer lane markings and high-visibility crosswalks so movement through the intersection is easier to read.
- Add curb extensions to shorten crossing distances, slow turning vehicles, improve visibility, and keep parking farther from the corners.
- Reorganize bus stops to the far side of the intersection to allow waiting areas to no longer block the crosswalk and pedestrians can reach transit more safely and directly.

Manayunk–Ridge–Dawson Intersection Example

Tire tracks at the intersection of Ridge Avenue and Osborn Street reveal the road space cars actually use. The untouched snow shows exactly where protective infrastructure like flex posts, planters, or painted markings could be installed without impeding traffic, while reclaiming space for safer, more comfortable pedestrian crossings.



Crosswalk Visibility Enhancements

CASE STUDY: NYC 6 1/2 Avenue

New York City 6 1/2 Avenue Pinchpoint

The 6 1/2 Avenue project in Midtown Manhattan, New York City shows how quick-build design can improve pedestrian safety at midblock crossings. The project made pedestrians more visible, clarified where people should cross, and strengthened the route as a continuous walking corridor. NYC DOT also found that pedestrian volumes along the route increased after implementation.[129]

Goals Met

Cost **$$ ~ $$$$**

Partners

- OTIS
- Department of Streets
- SEPTA
- PennDOT
- PCPC

Funding

- City Capital Program
- PennDOT
- USDOT SS4A

Time | Short to Long Term

1 - 15 Years

18 Revitalize Vacant Land and Underutilized Community Assets

PROJECT

Manayunk has both vacant land that is not being fully used and existing community assets that are in poor condition. Rather than treating these as isolated problems, this recommendation sees them as opportunities for reinvestment. By improving aging facilities and reusing underutilized sites, the neighborhood can create more useful and community-serving spaces.

Objectives:

- Reuse vacant and underutilized land to provide new spaces and services for the community.
- Upgrade aging or poorly maintained community assets to better meet current neighborhood needs.
- Strengthen the social and functional value of public spaces through targeted reinvestment.

Actions:

- Coordinate with Manayunk “Friends of” parks organizations to create a team of community stakeholders. This group will spearhead implementation of upgrades and organize construction events.
- Work with community stakeholders to identify underutilized community assets within Manayunk through on-foot surveying.
- Synthesize data collection to create a ranking of which assets should be upgraded first based on cost and current conditions. From this list, create a timeline for improvement to delineate next steps for the initial projects.
- Partner with Philadelphia Parks and Recreations and Council Office District 4 for construction funding and permitting.
- Coordinate “build days” with Rebuilding Together Philadelphia for construction upgrades to provide lower labor cost through partnership with local universities, such as Saint Joseph's University and Thomas Jefferson University.
- Continue phasing of upgrades to community assets over time and as funding allows.

EXAMPLE SITE: Hillside/ Cohen Recreation Center

Before **After**

Existing Pool and Playground, Source: Phillypublicpools

The pool and park at Hillside Recreation Center are examples of existing assets that are in disrepair or dated. Strategic investment and upgrades would improve these facilities to meet community needs.

EXAMPLE SITE: Roxborough Dog Park

Existing Roxborough Dog Park, Source: Google Earth

At present, the Roxborough Dog Park is little more than a fenced vacant lot with no real facilities. This proposal would transform the site into a real dog park and provide a more enjoyable space for dog walking and recreation.

Goals Met

Cost $ $ $

Partners

- Philadelphia Parks & Recreation
- Capital Program Office
- Councilmember Curtis Jones, Jr. / District 4 Office
- Local universities
- "Friends of" Parks groups

Funding

- City Capital Budget
- Pennsylvania DCED Grants

Time | Medium Term

● ● ○ ○ 3 - 5 Years

19 Establish a Neighborhood Shuttle Connection for Regional Rail

PROGRAM

Manayunk's steep topography and limited pedestrian access to its Regional Rail Stations present a significant barrier to transit use for many residents. A scheduled neighborhood shuttle connecting the upper neighborhood to the Manayunk, Ivy Ridge, and Wissahickon Stations (timed to Regional Rail departures and arrivals) would provide a reliable, low-barrier alternative to driving for daily commuters. By the end of 2026, SEPTA's bus route 35 which serves as the interior Manayunk neighborhood loop route that takes residents to the Wissahickon Transit Center will be discontinued. A shuttle bus would serve riders who relied on that route in the past.

Objectives:

- Attract riders to commuter rail by providing first/last-mile transit.
- Make Manayunk more accessible for those with mobility restrictions.
- Mitigate negative transit ridership effects of SPETA funding cuts.
- De-incentivize unnecessary car trips in Manayunk.

Actions:

- Explore partnerships with local and regional institutions who may have interest and demands in a Manayunk shuttle service.
- Determine most effective routes to serve the neighborhood and its Regional Rail stations.
- Convene a working group with the Manayunk Neighborhood Council and members from SEPTA, DVRPC, and/or OTIS to assess route designation prioritizing key interior neighborhood locations that are less accessible to stations by foot.
- Study the ridership of the discontinued SEPTA 35 bus route to understand what gaps may need to be filled.
- Launch a limited 6-month pilot operating during weekday morning and afternoon peak periods, synced with the train schedule for onboardings and offboardings.
- Evaluate ridership, on-time performance, and user satisfaction rates to refine route design and make the case for permanent funding.
- Explore options for expanded shuttle service to grocery stores such as ACME, which is inaccessable by foot for most Manayunk residents. Explore future partnerships with ACME to promote easier access to grocery stores.

Goals Met

Cost

$ $

Partners

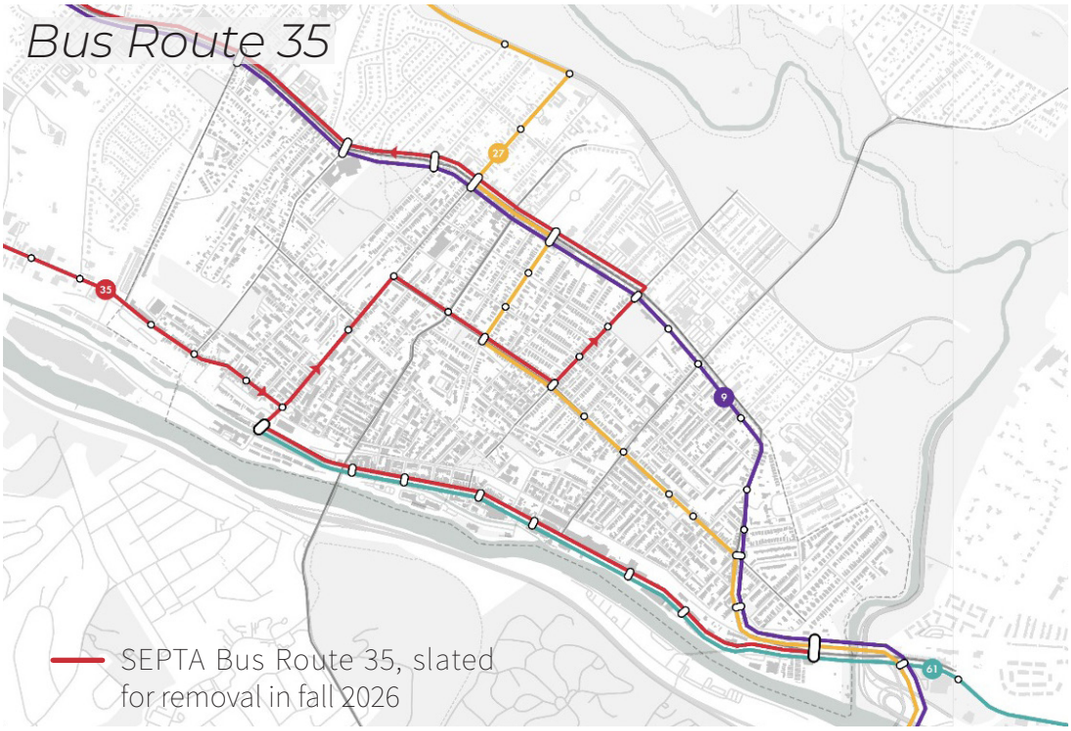
- OTIS
- SEPTA, Manayunk Neighborhood Council, DVRPC
- Potential to partner with local employers, institutions, organizations
- ACME

Funding

- Local Institution, employers, and organizations
- SEPTA
- Pennsylvania's Multimodal Transportation Fund

Time | Medium Term

● ● ○ ○ 1-4 Years



CASE STUDY: Feeder Shuttle Service and the BART System, San Francisco Bay Area

BART Commute Shuttle bus, Castro Valley, CA

BART's feeder shuttle system offers a useful precedent. By the 1990s, parking shortages at rail stations were pushing commuters back to driving. A market survey in Castro Valley found 60% of residents would return to BART if a train-synced shuttle served their neighborhood.[131,132] Today, 24 shuttle lines connect suburban commuters to stations across the Bay Area.[133]

SEPTA's fixed Regional Rail timetable makes synchronized scheduling just as feasible in Manayunk. Though here, the barrier is topography, not parking. The hill remains the primary obstacle to station access for many residents.

20 Expand Shared Mobility and First/Last-Mile Access

PROJECT

With its Regional Rail stations and the Wissahickon Transit Center, Manayunk has great transit points of connection to the rest of the city, but riders are often discouraged from using these connections due to poor or inconvenient first/last mile connections (transportation to/from transit stations). By providing transit users with easier access to stations, and peace of mind to promote biking, transit trips may become more competitive for those who would otherwise drive.

Objectives:

- Expand first/last mile options for commuters
- Protect against bike theft
- Improve neighborhood bike network

Goals Met

Partners

- OTIS
- Indego (Bicycle Transit Systems)
- SEPTA
- Department of Planning and Development
- BikeLink

Funding

- Bicycle Transit Systems (BTS)
- Other state and federal Grants

Cost $$

Time ●● ○○ 1-4 Years

Current Indego Bikeshare Stations Map

The current Indego bike station locations favor access to the towpath and other bike trails, but lacks stations further uphill.

The nearest station to the Wissahickon Transit Center and Regional Rail station is disconnected by the busy Main Street and Ridge Avenue intersection and steep flight of stairs. The Ivy Ridge Station has no Indego bike share station.

Indego Station Map of Manayunk[134]

Actions:

- Pursue partnership with Indego to expand bikeshare presence near Regional Rail stations, the Wissahickon Transit Center, and in the interior parts of Manayunk.
- Coordinate with SEPTA and OTIS to identify underserved parts of the neighborhood for more stations.
- Prioritize e-bike stock at Indego stations to help cyclists climb Manayunk's steep hills.
- In conjunction with Indego expansion, partner with BikeLink to find ideal locations for new electronic bike lockers for commuters to leave their bikes at when they take transit, or for visitors to lock up as they explore Manayunk.
- Add secure, convenient bike storage at Regional Rail stations and the Wissahickon Transit Center.
- Prioritize new bike storage in well-lit, high-activity, locations near transit locations.
- If bike locker usage becomes great enough, coordinate with SEPTA to see if a joint payment system would be possible to make the bike and ride experience smoother.

Current Bicycle Parking at the Manayunk Station

Example BikeLink Facility in San Jose

$4.50
Single ride for regular & E-bikes
E-bike +30c/min

$20
Month pass for regular & E-bikes
E-bike + 20c/min

$156
Annual pass for regular & E-bikes
E-bike + 20c/min

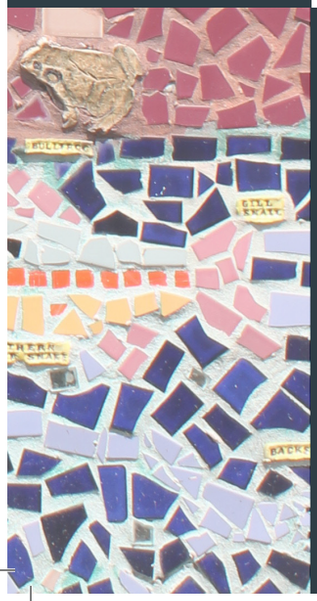
$0.05
hourly cost for BikeLink locker storage

Indego Bikeshare station near Main Street

05

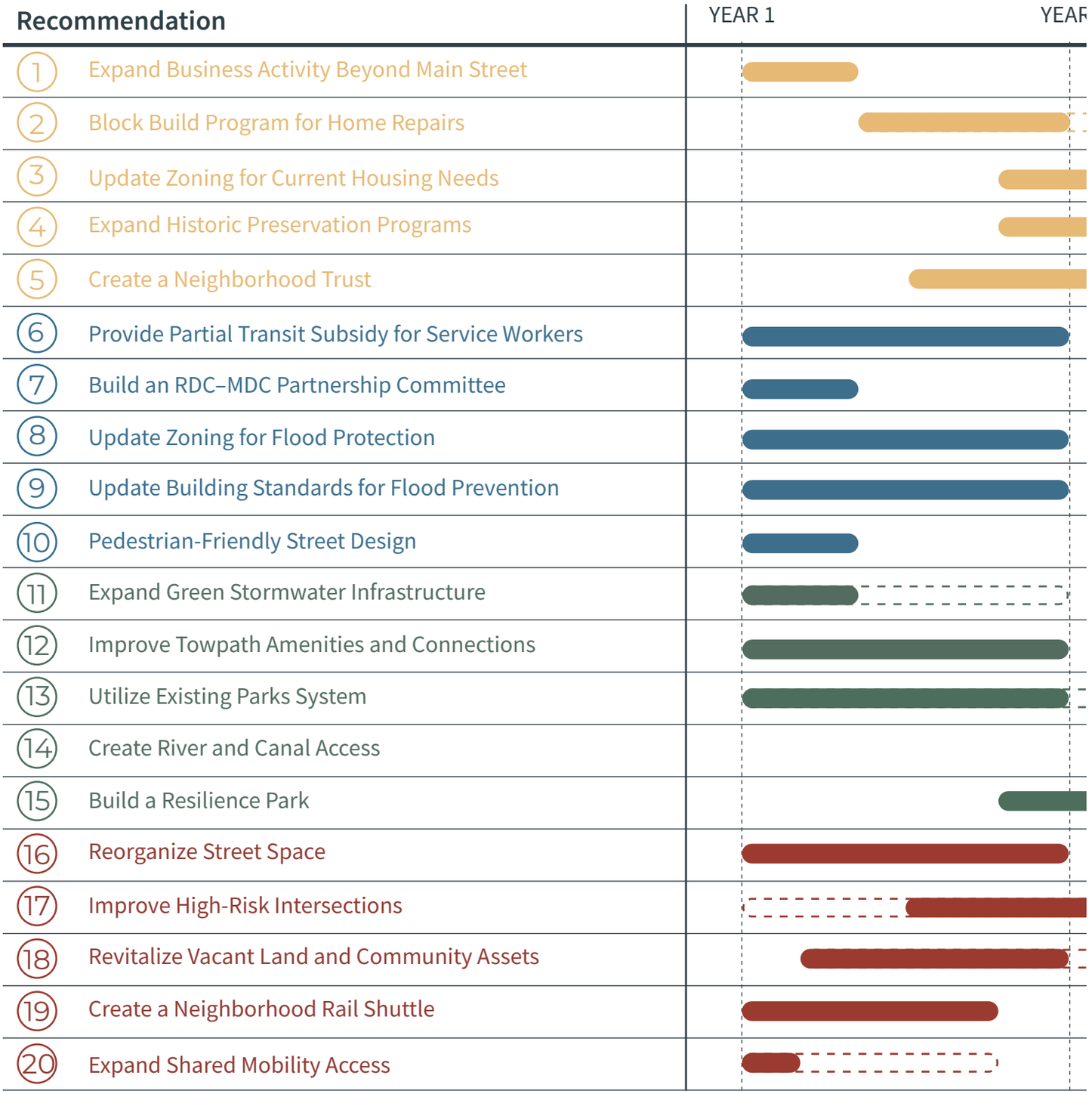
IMPLEMENTATION

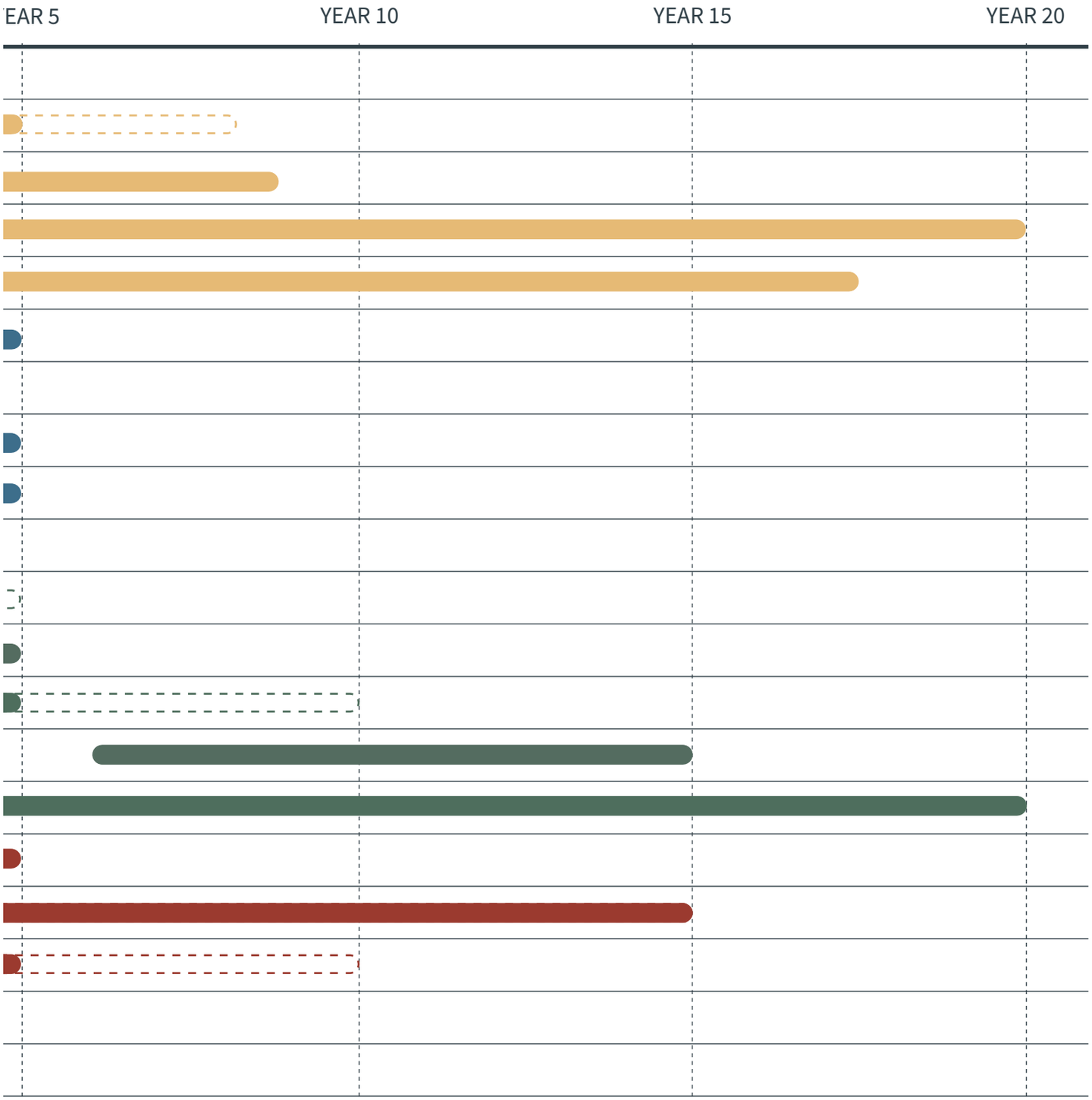
Public art on the Manayunk Towpath.



Timeline *82*
Funding & Partners *84*
Phasing *86*

IMPLEMENTATION: TIMELINE




EAR 5
YEAR 10
YEAR 15
YEAR 20

IMPLEMENTATION: PARTNERS & FUNDING

Recommendation	Cost*	Goals
1 Expand Business Activity Beyond Main Street	$	●
2 Block Build Program for Home Repairs	$ $	●
3 Update Zoning for Current Housing Needs	$ $	●
4 Expand Historic Preservation Programs	$ $ $	● ●
5 Create a Neighborhood Trust	$ $ $	● ●
6 Provide Partial Transit Subsidy for Service Workers	$ $	● ●
7 Build an RDC–MDC Partnership Committee	$ $	●
8 Update Zoning for Flood Protection	$ $	● ●
9 Update Building Standards for Flood Prevention	$ $	● ●
10 Pedestrian-Friendly Street Design	$	● ● ●
11 Expand Green Stormwater Infrastructure	$ $	● ●
12 Improve Towpath Amenities and Connections	$ $ $	●
13 Utilize Existing Parks System	$ $	● ●
14 Create River and Canal Access	$ $ $	●
15 Build a Resilience Park	$ $ $ $ $	● ●
16 Reorganize Street Space	$ $ $	● ●
17 Improve High-Risk Intersections	$$ ~ $$$$	● ●
18 Revitalize Vacant Land and Community Assets	$ $ $ $	● ● ●
19 Create a Neighborhood Rail Shuttle	$ $	● ●
20 Expand Shared Mobility Access	$	● ●

Goals: *Community* *Economic* *Environment* *Infrastructure*

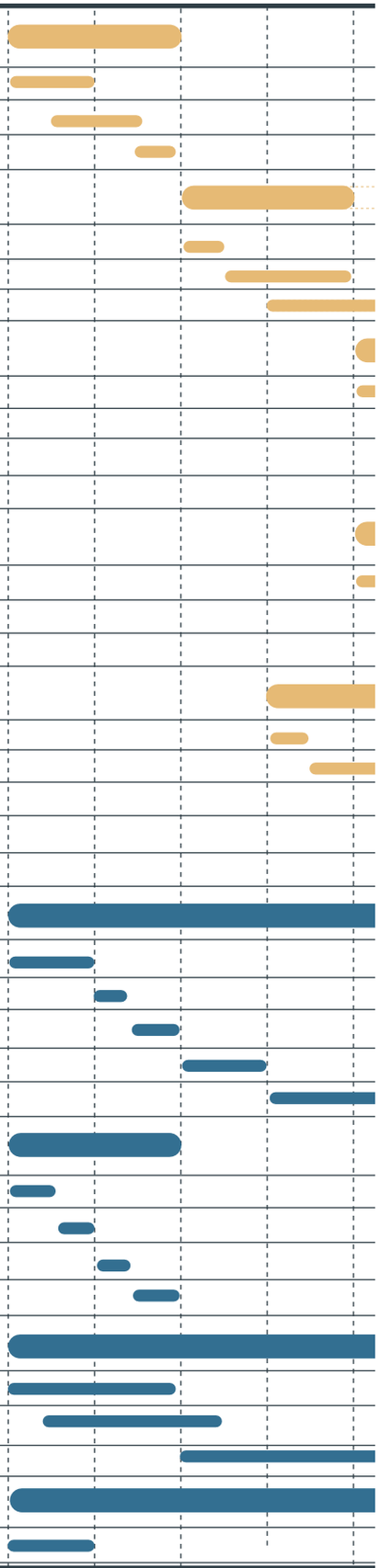
**Cost Range: $ = $5000; $$ = $50,000; $$$ = $500,000; $$$$ = $5,000,000; $$$$$ = $50,000,000*

***See additional partners and funding on individual recommendation pages.*

Partners**	Funding**
RMC; Philadelphia Parks & Recreation	MDC Seed Donation
Rebuilding Together Philadelphia; Saint Joseph's University	City of Philadelphia; Saint Joseph's University
Philadelphia Water Department; MDC	Manayunk Development Corporation
Manayunk Development Corporation; Ridge Park Civic Association	Philadelphia Historical Commission; MDC
Local RCOs; Kensington Corridor Trust	Philadelphia Reinvestment Fund
SEPTA	Manayunk Development Corporation
Manayunk Development Corporation; RDC	Manayunk Development Corporation
PCPC; City Council; Manayunk Neighborhood; MDC; RPCA	PCPC; L&I; FEMA
PCPC; L&I; City Council; Manayunk Neighborhood; MDC; PWD	FEMA; City operating budgets; Flood Mitigation Assistance
Property owner; Philadelphia Streets Department; L&I; RDC	Neighborhood Economic Development Grant
Philadelphia Water Department; MDC	Rain Check grants; Schuylkill River Restoration Fund
RMC; Schuylkill River Greenway National Heritage Area	HPPF; Circuit Trails Community Grant
RMC; Philadelphia Parks & Recreation; Park "Friends" organizations	Recreation and Conservation Planning Grants
RMC; Schuylkill River Greenway National Heritage Area	HPPF; Circuit Trails Community Grant
Philadelphia Parks & Recreation; MDC; RMC	William Penn Foundation; HPPF
OTIS; Philadelphia City Planning Commission; Department of Streets	DVRPC TCDI; PA DCED Multimodal Transportation Fund
OTIS; Department of Streets; SEPTA; PennDOT; PCPC	City Capital Program; PennDOT; USDOT SS4A
Philadelphia Rebuild Program; City Capital Budget	Philadelphia Parks & Recreation; Capital Program Office
PCPC; SEPTA; Manayunk Neighborhood Council; DVRPC	Local Institution, employers, and organizations; SEPTA
Indego; SEPTA; PCPC; BikeLink	Bicycle Transit Systems (BTS)

IMPLEMENTATION: ACTIONS

Recommendation YEAR 1



1 **Expand Business Activity Beyond Main Street**

Action 1: Establish pilot programming

2: "Manayunk Go" and “Small Business Grocery Store” pilot program

3: Survey participation satisfaction

2 **Block Build Program for Home Repairs**

Action 1: Identify suitable properties and homeowners for home repairs

2: Recruit volunteers and raise funds

3: Partner with Rebuilding Together to repair homes and organize block builds

3 **Update Zoning for Current Housing Needs**

Action 1: Find an entity to draft zoning update

2: Conduct community outreach through town halls and listening sessions

3: Lobby for Council Member support from District 4 Council member

4: Implementation at the City level

4 **Expand Historic Preservation Programs**

Action 1: Identify properties and conduct community outreach on district boundaries

2: Implement identified historic properties into a thematic district

3: Apply for federal historic designation to access renovation tax credits

5 **Create a Neighborhood Trust**

Action 1: File to set up trust and executive board composed of local stakeholders

2: Consult successful land and neighborhood trusts for best practices

3: Hire first staff, acquire and manage first properties

4: Apply for philanthropic low-interest loans, expand operations

5: Evaluate success of program, continue expansion of trust

6 **Provide Partial Transit Subsidy for Service Workers**

Action 1: Recruit eligible participants

2: Pilot implementation

3: Post-pilot evaluation

4: Expand/alter pilot based on metrics

5: Scale partnership with SEPTA

7 **Build an RDC–MDC Partnership Committee**

Action 1: Conduct retail demand analysis

2: Coordinate marketing resources

3: Expand Incubator access

4: Monthly MDC-RDC Leadership meetings

8 **Update Zoning for Flood Protection**

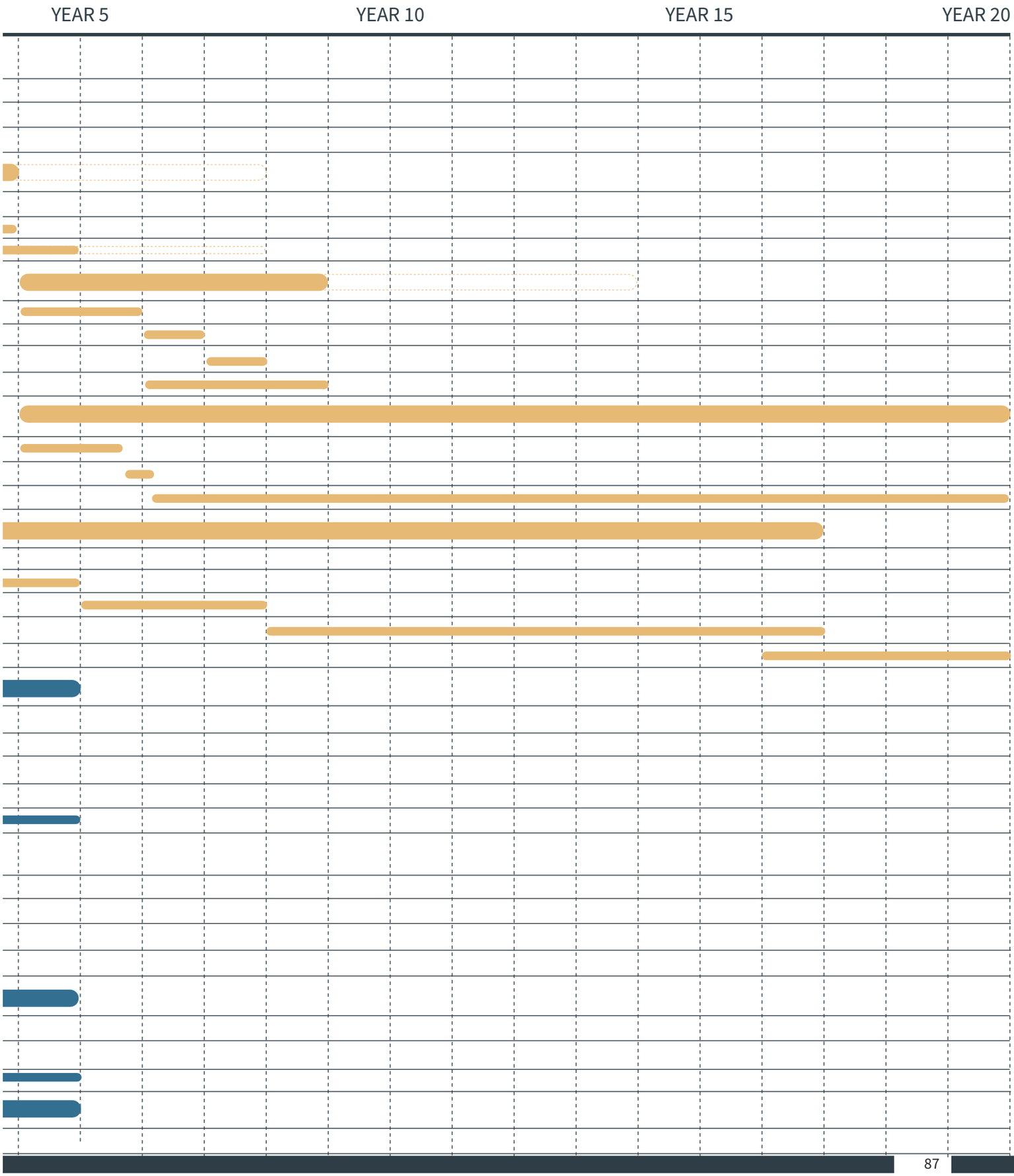
Action 1: Map flood-risk overlay boundaries, draft the ordinance, and review feasibility

2: Conduct community engagement and public meetings and implement feedback

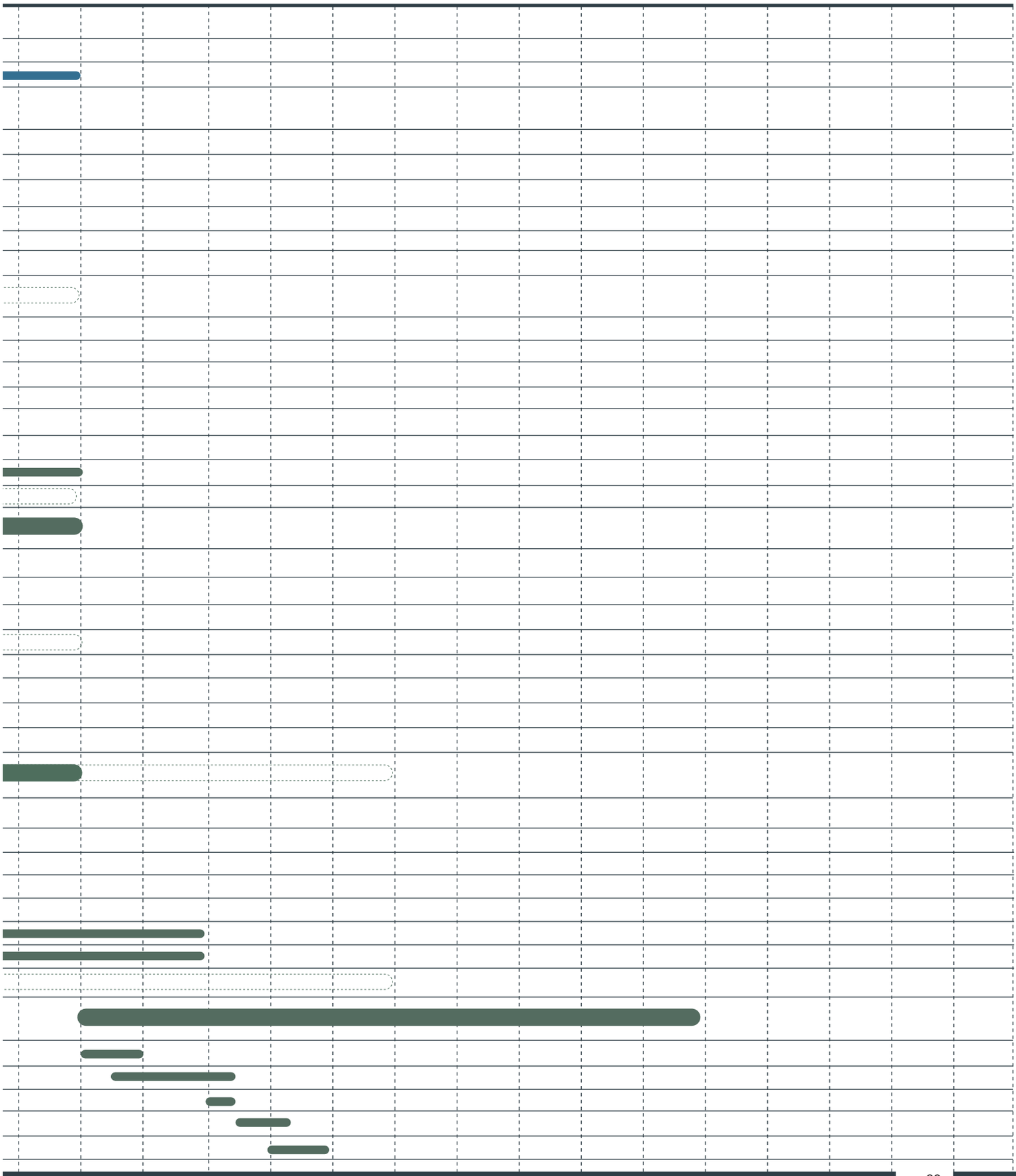
3: Adopt and implement the overlay ordinance

9 **Update Building Standards for Flood Prevention**

Action 1: Survey businesses and property owners about past flood damage


YEAR 5
YEAR 10
YEAR 15
YEAR 20

Recommendation	YEAR 1
2: Develop draft ordinance and review feasibility with City departments	
3: Conduct community engagement and implement feedback	
4: Advance ordinance through City legislative process and connect owners with resources	
10 Pedestrian-Friendly Street Design	
Action 1: Conduct community outreach	
2: Survey existing street furniture, sidewalk widths, and space	
3: Prepare installation drawings and plans	
4: Submit license application and any other necessary approvals	
5: Install movable tables, chairs, and planters, and mark a clear path	
6: Track program data and evaluate success	
11 Expand Green Stormwater Infrastructure	
Action 1: Identify community partners or collaborators	
2: Advertise existing Rain Check program to residents at community events	
3: Distribute a survey to identify areas of concern and benefits	
4: Conduct site survey to identify locations to improve	
5: Coordinate with Streets Department on incorporating GSI with other projects	
6: Rank projects based on cost, location, and impact	
7: Begin implementing projects based on priority list	
8: Advocate for Greened Acre Retrofit Program to include areas of high flood risk	
12 Improve trail amenities and connections (Main Street & Manayunk Towpath)	
Action 1: Survey existing trail conditions and amenities	
2: Conduct community engagement about desired amenities	
3: Identify existing public easement access	
4: Advocate for expansion of Schuylkill Banks project to include Manayunk	
5: Identify low-effort, high-impact amenities to install first	
6: Work with local artists to create new public art on the trail	
7: Determine what agency or entity will coordinate projects and RFP process	
8: Design trail connections, wayfinding signage, and trail flow	
13 Utilize Existing Parks System	
Action 1: Evaluate existing parks assets	
2: Engage community and local organizations to identify priorities and needs	
3: Review feedback and determine priorities for parks or areas to focus on	
4: Complete site surveys to prepare for specific projects	
5: Identify major gaps in trail system and connections between parks	
6: Facilitate collaboration between civic and non-profit partners	
7: Apply for grant funds	
8: Organize park service days	
14 Create New Water Access to the Schuylkill River & Manayunk Canal	
Action 1: Conduct community engagement to determine interest in boating amenities	
2: Connect with local partners and organizations	
3: Establish rating criteria such as space needed, population served, etc.	
4: Identify sites for potential boat launch and score according to criteria	
5: Develop safety measures to promote safe water use/access	


YEAR 5
YEAR 10
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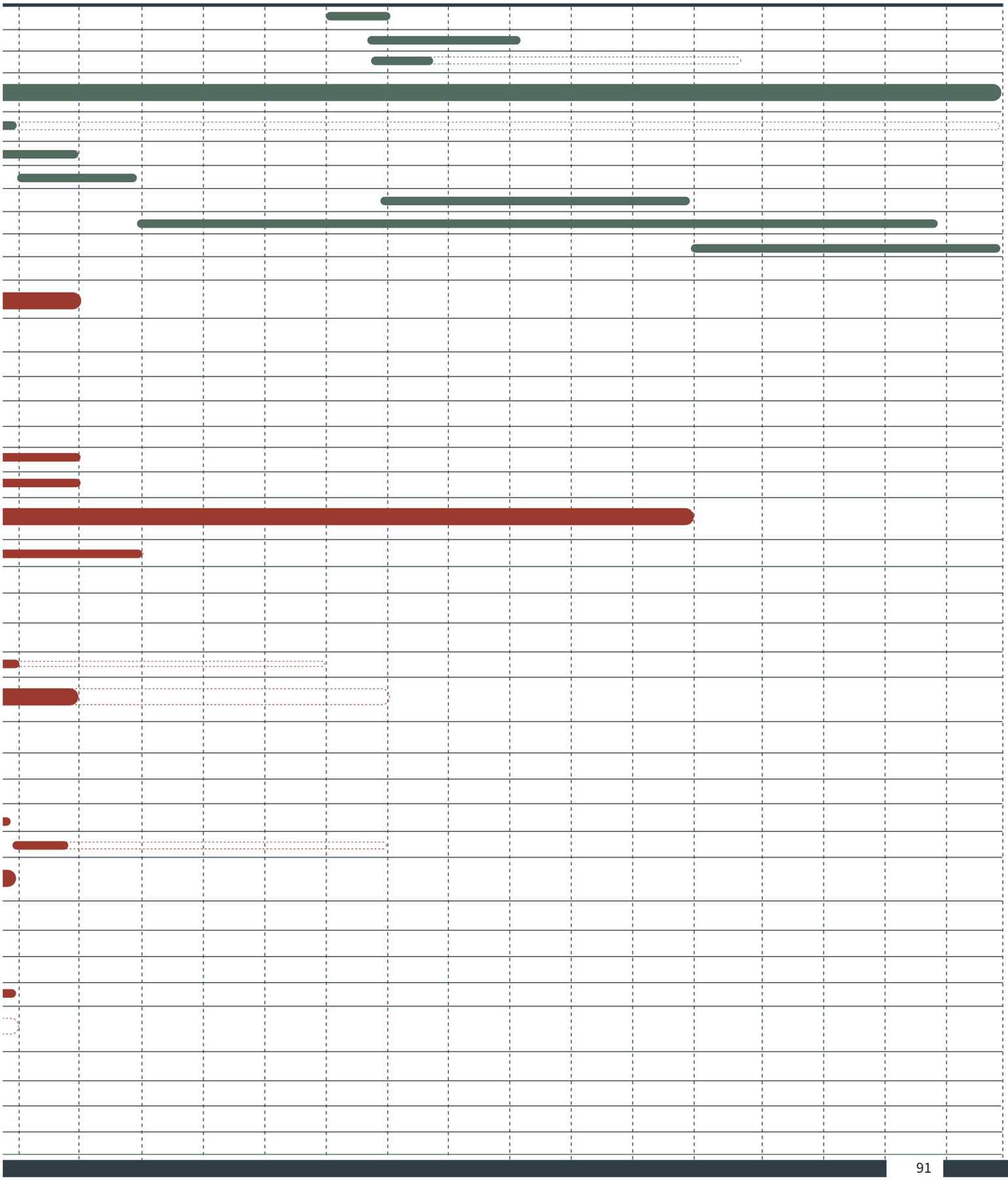
YEAR 20

Recommendation	YEAR 1
6: Establish rules or regulations for operation of facility	
7: Obtain easements, land purchase, or other permissions/permits	
8: Identify community partner or agency to manage access point(s)	
15 Build a Resilience Park	
Action 1: Identify vacant properties in waterfront area and score criteria to rank sites	
2: Begin community engagement process	
3: Engage partner organizations in discussions on funding, site acquisition, etc.	
4: Identify funding sources and entity to lead project and RFP process	
5: Conduct environmental assessments	
6: Advocate with FEMA for BRIC program to be funded	
7: Complete project design and construction	
16 Reorganize Street Space	
Action 1: Map major activity nodes and neighborhood destinations	
2: Identify a street hierarchy	
3: Low-speed connector routes: remove parking, widen lanes for multimodal travel	
4: Install wayfinding signs and markings along connector routes and key corridors	
5: Install benches where space allows	
6: Convert parking near crosswalks to pedestrian protection and visibility areas	
7: Where possible, shift curbs to make more space for non-motorized travel	
17 Improve High-Risk Intersections and Steep Streets	
Action 1: Begin with low-cost implementations	
2: Repaint lanes and no parking zones	
3: Add flex posts, bollards, planters to create bump-outs	
4: Tighten turns and remove corner parking at key intersections	
5: Complete high-cost implementations	
18 Revitalize Vacant Land and Community Assets	
Action 1: Coordinate with Manayunk parks groups on implementation of upgrades	
2: Identify underutilized assets through on-foot surveying	
3: Process construction allowance	
4: Coordinate with Rebuilding Together Philadelphia for construction upgrades	
5: Continue phasing of upgrades to community assets	
19 Create a Neighborhood Rail Shuttle	
Action 1: Explore partnerships with local and regional institutions and employers	
2: Determine most effective routes to serve the neighborhood	
3: Launch a limited pilot operating during weekday mornings and afternoons	
4: Evaluate ridership, on-time performance, and user satisfaction to refine program	
20 Expand Shared Mobility Access	
Action 1: Identify potential new bikeshare station locations	
2: Prioritize e-bike docks at stations	
3: Negotiate lockers near Regional Rail and the Wissahickon Transit Center	
4: Install lighting as needed	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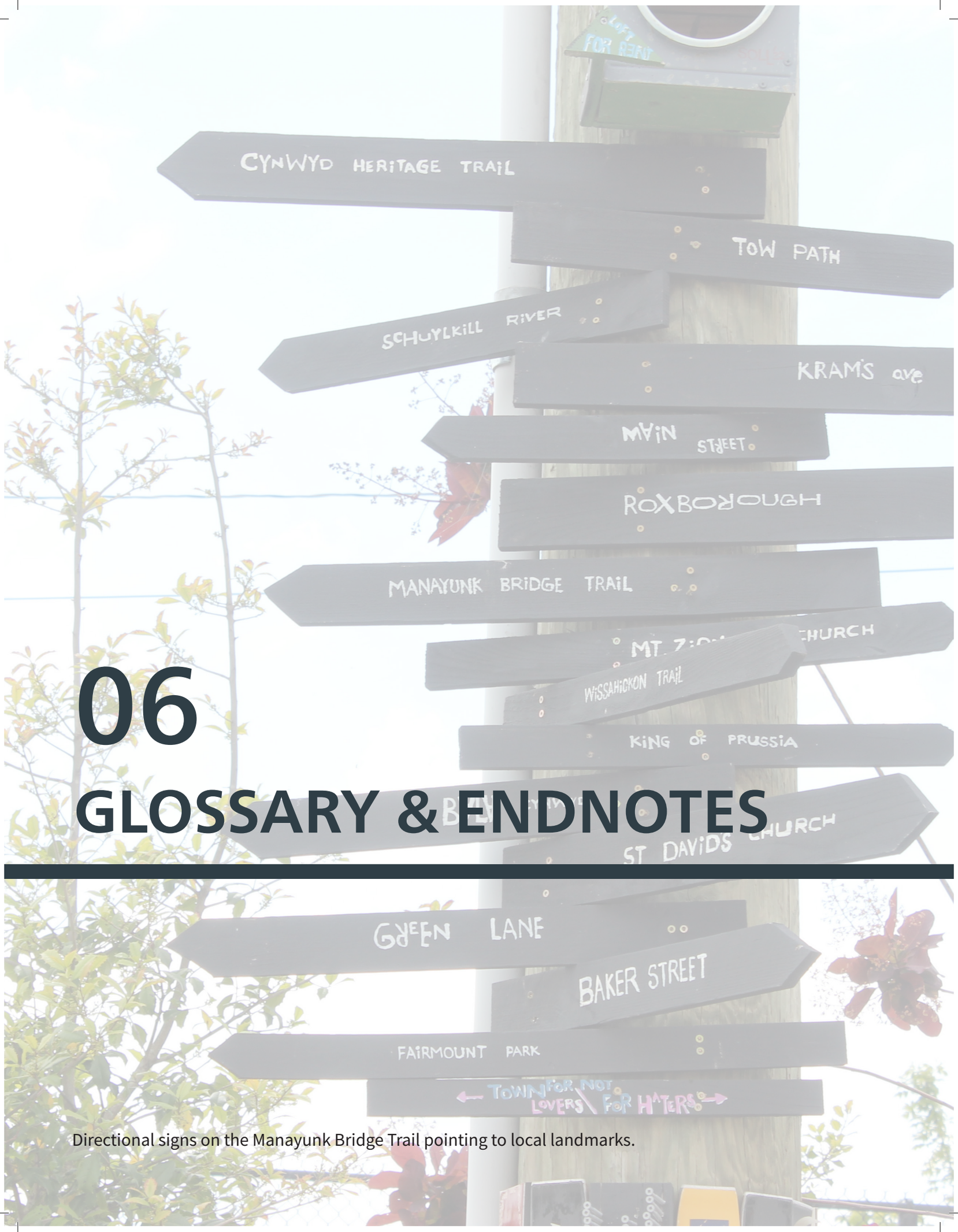
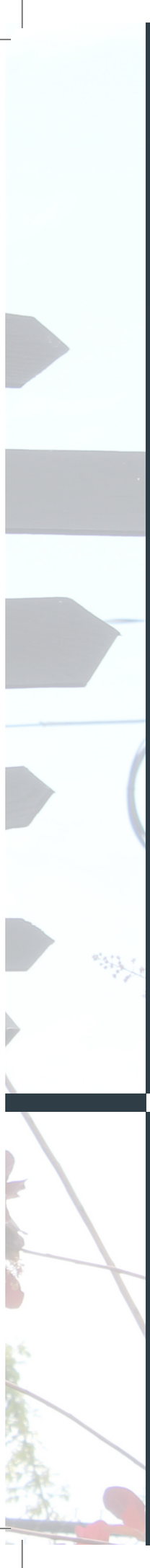


06
GLOSSARY & ENDNOTES

Directional signs on the Manayunk Bridge Trail pointing to local landmarks.



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Endnotes *96*

Glossary

This glossary includes definitions of technical terms that are used in this report, along with commonly used acronyms.

100-year floodplain: The 100-year floodplain refers to an area that has a 1-percent annual chance of flood, which is also described as the Special Flood Hazard Area (SFHA). See "*FEMA floodplain*" for related terms.

500-year floodplain: The 500-year floodplain refers to an area that has a .02-percent annual chance of flood. See "*FEMA floodplain*" for related terms.

ACS: American Community Survey. The ACS is conducted by the U.S. Census Bureau, providing annual updates on social, economic, housing, and demographic information in the United States.`

ADA: Americans with Disabilities Act

ADU: An Accessory Dwelling Unit is a smaller residential unit located on the same lot as a single-family detached housing unit. Many typologies of ADUs exist, such as detached ADUs, garage conversion ADUs, internal ADUs, and more.

Affordable Housing: There are two kinds of affordable housing. The first is "Capital-A" Affordable Housing, which refers to housing made affordable through subsidy. The second kind is "lowercase -a" affordable housing, which refers to housing which is naturally affordable without subsidy. Housing is considered affordable when housing costs are below 30% of a household's gross income.

Attached Housing: Housing that shares one or more walls with adjacent housing units. One example of attached housing would be a typical Philadelphia rowhome. Compare to "*Detached Housing.*"

Basic industry: an industry of fundamental economic importance, within a certain geographic context.

Bedroom Community: Also known as a commuter town or bedroom suburb, these are primarily residential neighborhoods where residents commute out of the neighborhood for work.

BFE: Base flood elevation. This elevation of flood levels in a one-in-a-hundred-year flood, also known as a "base flood."

BID: Business Improvement District

Bilateral committee: a formal group established between two organizations to manage, negotiate, and oversee shared interests.

Block Build: Events where volunteers and organizations provide free repairs to multiple homes located in proximity to each other.

BRIC: Building Resilient Infrastructure and Communities. BRIC is a program that was operated by FEMA to support states, tribal government, and local government in upgrading or constructing infrastructure or capital projects that would contribute to greater climate resilience.

Building envelope: The maximum physical extent buildings can take, based upon zoning regulations such as height limitations and setbacks.

Circuit: The Circuit trails is a name for Philadelphia's network of different trail systems.

Circular economy: In the context of neighborhood planning, a circular economy is an economic system where money and resources are used and stay within the neighborhood.

CSO: A Combined Sewer Overflow is related to a Combined Sewer Systme (CSS), which is a water system that combines stormwater with sanitary sewer, rather than managing stormwater as a separate system. When it is not raining, the pipes direct this waste stream to the wastewater treatment plant and clean, treated water is released into the river. During rainstorms, stormwater drains into the sewer system and may cause the pipes to overflow through CSOs, meaning that untreated sewage can flow into the rivers or other waterways.

Community Land Trust (CLT): An organization that acquires land to be held in perpetuity for benefits to the community instead of speculation. Property owners can still own buildings that are on CLT land and enjoy full ownership rights but must sell such buildings at a reduced rate to maintain affordability. For a related model, see "*neighborhood trust.*"

DCED: Pennsylvania Department of Community and Economic Development

Detached Housing: Housing that does not share any walls or structural elements with nearby homes. One example of detached housing would be a typical suburban single-family home. Compare to "*Attached Housing*."

DFE: Design flood elevation. The minimum elevation at which buildings located in a floodplain must be constructed at, calculating by taking the sum of the base flood elevation and the freeboard. See "*base flood elevation*" and "*freeboard*" for more information.

DVRPC: Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission

eCLIPSE: Electronic Commercial Licensing, Inspection, and Permitting Services Enterprise, an online portal for applying for licenses, inspections, and permits from the Philadelphia Department of Licensing & Inspections

FEMA: Federal Emergency Management Agency

FEMA floodplain: A floodplain is an area of land that is subject to flooding, often found in low-lying areas or lower elevations adjacent to a large body of water. The FEMA floodplain is the area of the floodplain designated by the Federal Emergency Management Agency as being part of a Special Flood Hazard Area (SFHA). FEMA has a series of precise classifications and definitions for the technical terms used in their flood map designations (this glossary also defines 100-year floodplain and 500-year floodplain). For more information, visit https://www.fema.gov/about/glossary/flood-zones.

FIRM: Flood Insurance Rate Map

First/Last Mile Solutions: First/last mile solutions aim to solve the first/last mile problem, which involves bridging the gap between a major transit station and a commuter's home. Solutions include improved pedestrian infrastructure, bike lanes, and shuttle services.

Floodplain: See "*FEMA floodplain.*"

Flood mitigation: Flood mitigation refers to various strategies that may be used to reduce the severity or impacts of flooding.

Fluvial flooding: Also called riverine flooding, this refers to flooding that occurs from a river waterway that overflows its normal water levels.

Four Point Approach: framework for commercial development focusing on organization, promotion, design, and economic vitality

Fourth District Zoning Overlay: A zoning provision which applies different zoning allowances to the Fourth City Council District in Philadelphia which Manayunk is located within.

Freeboard: The height above the base flood elevation which a building must be constructed at to be protected from flood events. See "*base flood elevation*."

"Friends of" parks organizations: These non-profit, typically volunteer-run organizations, partner with Philadelphia Parks and Recreation and the Fairmount Park Conservancy to improve and beautify local parks.

GSI/Green stormwater infrastructure: Green stormwater infrastructure incorporates ideas from natural systems to manage rainfall or other precipitation where it falls by using vegetation, permeable materials, rain gardens, green roofs, or other tools to absorb, collect, and retain water. Some green stormwater infrastructure allows water to more slowly drain into the stormwater system, while other GSI solutions may facilitate drainage and infiltration into the ground.

Historic District: A significant concentration, linkage, or continuity of sites, buildings, structures, or objects united historically or aesthetically. Some historic districts, such as the Manayunk Main Street Historic District, are listed on the National Historic Register.

Historic Tax Credits: A federal program allowing buildings certified as a historic structure by the National Park Service to receive a 20% income tax credit for rehabilitation. To use this tax credit, rehabilitation projects must follow guidelines set by the National Park Service. Due to the fluctuating demand for tax credits by institutional investors, historic tax credits cover effectively 15-18% of rehabilitation costs instead of 20%.

Householder: In the United States Census, the person whose name is associated with the ownership or rental of the household. There is only one householder per home under the United States Census.

I-76: Interstate 76, also commonly known as the Schuylkill Expressway, as much of this highway follows the banks of the Schuylkill River

KCT: Kensington Corridor Trust

LEHD: Longitudinal Employer-Household Dynamics, a source of public information from state, federal, and Census datasets, on employees and employers in the United States

Lenape: The Lenni-Lenape are an Indigenous people whose ancestral homeland included the Delaware Valley and the greater Philadelphia region.

L&I: Philadelphia Department of Licenses & Inspections

LIHTC: Low-income housing tax credit. A federal program which subsidizes the construction of Affordable Housing by reducing the tax obligations of investors in developing low-income housing.

Location quotient: This figure is a measure of an industry's concentration within a region, compared to a larger geographic area. If the location quotient is <1, the industry is in decline locally compared to the larger area. If it is >1, the industry is growing relative to the larger area.

MDC: Manayunk Development Corporation, a nonprofit organization that manages, promotes, and supports the Manayunk business district.

MEP: Mechanical, Electrical, and Plumbing systems

MNC: Manayunk Neighborhood Council, a neighborhood civic organization that represents local residents and participates in zoning and development review discussions.

MSSD: Manayunk Special Services District, a special services district that helps fund district services such as cleaning, maintenance, and public-space improvements in Manayunk.

Neighborhood Trust: An organization that acquires land, properties, and other neighborhood assets to be held in perpetuity for benefits to the community instead of speculation. Assets can be leased out to satisfy needs of local community, but assets remain in perpetual ownership of the neighborhood trust. Ownership and decision-making powers are typically held by community members, keeping wealth within the neighborhood. For a related model, see "*community land trust*."

Non-relational households: Also referred to as a nonfamily household, where the householder is either living alone or shares their home with other people who they are not related to.

OTIS: Office of Transportation and Infrastructure Systems, a Philadelphia City department that coordinates transportation and infrastructure planning and project delivery across agencies.

Parcel: A specific piece of land associated with a particular land use and ownership.

Pilot program: small-scale, short-term experiment or trail used to test the feasibility, time, cost, and risks of a project before a full-scale implementation.

PCPC: Philadelphia City Planning Commission

PEMA: Pennsylvania Emergency Management Agency

PennDOT: Pennsylvania Department of Transportation

PHDC: Philadelphia Housing Development Corporation

Pluvial flooding: Pluvial flooding is flooding that occurs as a result of significant rainfall.

PWD: Philadelphia Water Department

QCEW: Quarterly Census of Employment and Wages, conducted by the Bureau of Labor Statistics

RCO: Registered Community Organization, A community group registered by the Philadelphia City Planning Commission that is concerned with physical development in its area and participates in zoning and development review processes.

RDC: Roxborough Development Corporation

Regional Rail: A commuter rail network operated by SEPTA, which connects Center City Philadelphia to various suburbs and commuter neighborhoods in the region.

Repetitive loss: This is a technical term from FEMA used to describe properties or structures that are covered under the National Flood Insurance Program and that have had two paid flood losses of over $1000 within a 10-year period of time since 1978.

RFP: Request for Proposals. An RFP is a process used by local governments or other organizations to advertise a large project or contract to professionals in a given industry. Interested parties may then prepare and submit a proposal for a project or contract. The RFP generally includes details such as the intended project budget, project criteria, or other project guidelines that the submitted proposals should consider or follow. Each entity using the RFP process typically has a method for reviewing the proposals submitted and selecting a final candidate for the project or contract. Government entities may have additional requirements by law that guide their use of RFPs and how a vendor or contractor is selected.

RPCA: Ridge Park Civic Association, A volunteer-led civic association serving parts of Roxborough and Manayunk, with work that includes cleanups, tree

planting, historic preservation, and zoning-related community involvement.

Schuylkill Navigation Company: A private company chartered in 1815 to build canals, dams, and slackwater pools along the Schuylkill River, helping drive the early industrial growth of places such as Manayunk.

SEPTA: Southeastern Pennsylvania Transportation Authority

SFHA: Special Flood Hazard Area. See "*100-year floodplain*" and "*FEMA floodplain*."

Speculation: In the context of real estate, this means holding onto a piece of vacant land or property in hopes that it can be sold at a higher price later, as opposed to real estate that is being used and occupied productively.

SS4A: Safe Streets and Roads For All, a grant program through USDOT.

TCDI: Transportation and Community Development Initiative, a funding opportunity provided through the Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission.

Thematic Historic District: A group of properties united by their connection a specific historic theme. For the City of Philadelphia, they are also added to the Philadelphia Register of Historic Places.

USDOT: United States Department of Transportation

Venice Island: A piece of land in Manayunk bounded by the Manayunk Canal and the Schuylkill River; historically an industrial area, it is now partly used for recreation and stormwater infrastructure.

Zoning: The land use regulations which decide what can and cannot be built in a certain place. Zoning districts in a zoning code define a specific category and what uses and activities are permitted in that zone. The zone district is often abbreviated as an acronym followed by a number. The number indicates the level of density allowed for that use, with higher numbers indicating higher levels of density permitted. Common zoning districts used in Philadelphia include but are not limited to:

- **CA:** Auto-Oriented Commercial
- **CMX:** Neighborhood Commercial Mixed-Use
- **I:** Industrial
- **ICMX:** Industrial Commercial Mixed-Use
- **IRMX:** Industrial Residential Mixed-Use
- **RM:** Residential Multi-Family
- **RMX:** Residential Mixed-Use
- **RSD:** Residential Single-Family Detached
- **RSA:** Residential Single-Family Attached
- **RSD:** Residential Single-Family Detached
- **RTA:** Residential Two-Family Attached
- **SP-CIV:** Civic, Educational, and Medical
- **SP-PO:** Active Parks and Open Space

Endnotes

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